The Ideas Page: Crackdown on Jantar Mantar 2.0, amid other closures, calls for redemocratisation 9

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Happening today

- **PM NARENDRA** Modi will inaugurate the 9th G20 Parliamentary Speakers' Summit, during which the Pan-African Parliament will take part for the first time.
- **THE FIRST MEETING** of the home ministers of BIMSTEC grouping will be held to strengthen security cooperation among member states across South and Southeast Asia and the Bay of Bengal region.

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY





2026 NOBEL PRIZE ECONOMICS



ROBERT E HALL



MICHAEL WOODFORD

Using policy tools to 'stabilise' economy P 13

IN LETTER TO RAHUL & KHARGE, CJI FLAGS SEPARATION OF POWERS, ETHICS AND JUDICIAL PROPRIETY

Opp leaders put up united front, march to SC, file joint petition

No parallel protests, all one protest: Rahul; SP, TMC, RJD, CPM join march

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, October 12

ESCALATING THEIR campaign seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and scrapping of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, Opposition parties, led by the Congress, drew thousands of workers and supporters to the streets of Delhi for a march to the Supreme Court. Senior Opposition leaders, who were part of the march Monday, also filed a joint petition at the apex court, raising these issues.

Earlier, addressing a press conference, Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, said that "all protests (against Kumar) are part of just one protest".

"There are no parallel protests, there is one protest... We do not care who you are, which formation you come from... If you are protecting the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



During a protest march by Opposition leaders on Barakhamba Road, New Delhi, Monday. ABHINAV SAHA

Pure theatrics, Cong leadership at fault for its losses, says BJP

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 12

AS THE Opposition leaders marched to the Supreme Court on Monday to file a petition against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, the BJP hit back at Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi and the Congress, labelling the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Over 60% of 33 lakh SIR cases in Delhi disposed of, shows CEO data

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, October 12

THE CASES of 20 lakh electors — more than 60% — out of the 33 lakh who had received notices to prove their eligibility to stay on the electoral roll in Delhi have been resolved, the office of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) said Monday.

The CEO's office still has more than 50 days until December 4 to publish the final electoral rolls for Delhi. The deadline for the publication of the final rolls was revised for the fourth time on September 26.

The process of disposal of notices and objections progressed slowly in the first 30 days with only 4 lakh notices disposed — until September 29 —

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Delhi Police denotifies Jantar Mantar as protest site

2 of 3 new venues over 20 km from Central Delhi

Sakshi Chand, Alok Singh, Amaal Sheikh & Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 12

DELHI POLICE on Monday denotified Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site and notified three other venues instead, two of which are at least 20 km from Central Delhi.

The order came after the Congress-led INDIA Opposition bloc, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), and the Left parties called for protests at various places in Central Delhi, including Jantar Mantar, over the past week to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Over the past three days, Delhi Police have deployed thousands of personnel to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

WHAT COURTS HAVE SAID ON PROTEST SITES P 13

MORE REPORTS, PAGES 4, 5

DAYS AFTER RATE HIKE, PRESSURE ON RBI

Rising food prices push retail inflation to 5.54% in Sept

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 12

DAYS AFTER the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) increased interest rates for the first time in over three-and-a-half years, government data released on Monday showed that headline inflation rate surged from 4.83% in August to 5.54% in September, driven mostly by high food prices.

While there was a month-on-month increase in overall prices, an unfavourable base effect also played a role in pushing up the headline inflation rate.

In a sign that price pressures are spreading, core inflation rose from 4.1% in August to 4.3% in September. Core inflation measures how the price of the household consumption basket has changed, after excluding food and fuel items whose prices can move sharply, tending to have an outsized influence on the overall inflation rate. As such, economists like to narrow down on the core inflation rate to understand underlying price pressures.

According to data released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) on Monday, food inflation rose sharply from 5.97% in August to 7.74% in September,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

In Rajasthan, former BJP MLA beaten to death by villagers

Parul Kulshrestha
Jaipur, October 12

FORMER MLA of Bayana in Rajasthan's Bharatpur district and BJP leader Atar Singh Bhadana, 68, was beaten to death by a group of 70-80 people at his stone-crusher plant on Sunday evening. His aide, Gagan Sharma, was left seriously injured in the attack.

The attack happened in Bhonda village of Bharatpur,



Atar Singh Bhadana

while Bhadana was visiting his unit, and was allegedly the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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Beyond anti-submarine warfare, INS Mangrol can conduct underwater surveillance, low-intensity maritime operations, and mine warfare tasks. EXPRESS

Navy inducts INS Mangrol, to help detect and counter underwater threats

Manish Kumar Pathak
Mumbai, October 12

INS Mangrol, the third vessel in the Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) series, was commissioned at the Naval Dockyard in Mumbai Monday, strengthening the Indian Navy's ability to detect and counter enemy submarines in shallow coastal waters.

Designed to operate in shallow and confined waters where larger warships may face limitations, the indigenously built vessel will help protect ports, harbours, and coastal approaches against underwater threats.

Built by Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), Kochi, INS Mangrol is equipped with advanced sonar, lightweight torpedoes and other anti-submarine systems that enable it to detect, track, and counter hostile submarines. With more than 80 per cent indigenous content, the vessel also reflects the Navy's push to strengthen domestic capabilities in warship construction and defence technology.

Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Western Naval Command, commissioned the ship.

During the commissioning ceremony, Vice Admiral Vatsayan said the Navy had commissioned 10 ships in 2026, with another eight expected to enter service by the end of the year.

"Our fleet currently comprises 151 platforms, including 131 ships and 20 submarines," he said.

"We currently have 42 ships under construction at Indian shipyards, while Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) has been accorded for another 69 ships, six submarines and 120 Fast Interceptor Craft. With these additions, our fleet is projected to grow to more than 170 platforms over the next few years, with a new ship being commissioned every 40 to 50 days. By 2034, approximately 60 per cent of our platforms are expected to be less than 10 years old on average," Vatsayan said.

The induction of the Mahe-class vessels is part of the Navy's efforts to bolster its coastal anti-submarine warfare capabilities and replace the ageing Abhay-class corvettes, which entered service between 1989 and 1991.

Their shallow-water design is intended to address the specific challenges of detecting and responding to submarines operating close to the coast, including around strategically important ports and maritime infrastructure.

INS Mangrol is equipped with the Abhay hull-mounted sonar, lightweight torpedoes, an indigenous anti-submarine rocket launcher and the Mareech Advanced Torpedo Decoy System. Together, these systems help the ship detect and track underwater threats, engage hostile submarines, and deploy countermeasures against incoming torpedoes.

Powered by three diesel engines and fitted with waterjet propulsion, the ship has high manoeuvrability, making it suitable for operations in shallow and confined waters. Beyond anti-submarine warfare, it can conduct underwater surveillance, low-intensity maritime operations, and mine warfare tasks.

It can also work alongside maritime patrol aircraft, helicopters and other naval vessels to strengthen surveillance and anti-submarine operations.

INS Mangrol has been built under the Centre's Make in India and Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiatives. It is named after the coastal town of Mangrol in Gujarat's Junagadh district.

Out on bail in SUV crash that left one dead, son of Odisha builder held in fresh road-rage incident

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, October 12

THREE MONTHS after allegedly killing a youth in a high-speed SUV crash, a 20-year-old builder's son was arrested again on Monday for allegedly attempting to run over a *dhaba* owner, staff members and a biker during a road-rage incident.

The law student was allegedly under the influence of alcohol, according to a medical test. Police rescued him from an angry mob early Monday morning. The accused, identified as Soumya Ranjan Rath, was booked under four sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), including those dealing with attempt to murder, rash driving and mischief causing property damage.

According to police, Rath had spent the night drinking at a *dhaba* before getting into an argument with its owner and staff over an unpaid bill early Monday. Following the altercation, he allegedly got into his SUV and tried to run over the owner, staff members and pedestrians nearby. The incident was captured on CCTV. At least three people were injured, while seven motorcycles, including some parked along the road, were damaged.

As locals chased his vehicle and began hitting it with sticks, Rath allegedly tried to escape by boarding a bus. The crowd intercepted and assaulted him before handing him over to the police.

Abhimanyu Nayak, Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP), Zone IV, Bhubaneswar, said Rath had intentionally used his vehicle as a weapon in an attempt to kill the *dhaba* owner and staff members by ramming into them.

In July, Rath had allegedly caused a similar accident near Shastri Nagar in Bhubaneswar, killing a youth. He was arrested and sent to jail in connection with the case but was subsequently granted bail by a court. The Regional Transport Office (RTO) had also cancelled his driving licence.

Police said Rath had violated his bail conditions by allegedly committing a similar offence again, and were exploring legal options to seek cancellation of his bail.

Describing Rath as a habitual offender, police said they were considering invoking additional provisions in the FIR. They also recovered an identity card belonging to a senior police officer from his vehicle, which they said they were verifying.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Opp

Constitution, as we are... we are with you, we will support you, we will help you, we will protect you. And, we expect the same from you. This is an expression of our love for the Indian people," Gandhi said.

The "Chalo Delhi" protest called by the Congress witnessed a major show of Opposition unity, with almost the entire top leadership of the INDIA bloc taking part — from Gandhi and Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge to SP's Akhilesh Yadav, TMC's Mamata Banerjee, RJD's Tejashwi Yadav and CPM's M A Baby. Monday's march followed days of street protests, first by the Opposition and on Saturday by the CJP seeking the resignation of CEC Kumar.

The march also came after an unsuccessful bid by Opposition leaders to meet CJI Surya Kant to raise the Government crackdown following their meeting last week with President Droupadi Murmu.

Gandhi and his counterpart in Rajya Sabha Kharge had earlier written to the CJI seeking an audience to raise issues regarding "the Chief Election Commissioner/ Election Commission of India, the arbitrary arrest of several students, the closure of metro stations; and the cancellation of trains, among other issues".

The CJI, however, declined to meet them making it clear that the issues referred by them "are already sub judice before the Supreme Court of India". He wrote that "convening a meeting to discuss pending cases would wholly contravene the principle of Separation of Powers, an intrinsic facet of the basic structure doctrine of the Constitution of India, and would be incompatible with the established ethics and judicial propriety".

"In this vein, I also wish to remind you that within our constitutional framework, the Supreme Court of India is not endowed with any administrative powers to deal with the issues highlighted in your letter. However, in the exercise of our jurisdiction under Article 32 of our Constitution, along with other plenary powers, including that of judicial review, we are duty-bound to consider on the judicial side the gravamen of issues affecting the citizens of India," the CJI said in the letter to Gandhi and Kharge.

The CJI also reiterated the commitment of the court to "preserve and protect the Fundamental Rights of every citizen of India" who are "entitled to seek enforcement of such rights at all hours through the procedure known in law". He told Gandhi and Kharge that "it would thus be more appropriate on your part to invoke the judicial powers of the Supreme Court of India, instead of submitting a memorandum on the administrative side".

Apart from Kharge, those who signed the petition in the apex court on Monday are TMC MP Saugata Roy, SP chief Akhilesh, RJD leader Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, NCP-SC's Supriya Sule, Shiv Sena-UBT's Sanjay Raut, CPI's D Raja, JMM MP Mahua Majhi, CPM's M A Baby and IUML's E T Mohammed Basheer.

The petition was filed after protesters marched through the streets of central Delhi along with Opposition leaders, including Raja, Sule, Raut, CPI-ML (Liberation) leader Dipankar Bhattacharya, Congress MPs Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Abhishek Manu Singhvi, Shashi Tharoor, Sachin Pilot and Mukul Wasnik, and TMC leader Sagarika Ghose, apart from activists Yogendra Yadav and AISA chief Neha Bora. Almost all the top leaders were seen atop a vehicle, which wound its way through the streets of the capital.

At his press conference earlier, Gandhi asked the CEC to "turn approver" and resign as the Opposition's fight was against the "bigger powers" that were behind him. "Resign, turn approver; you (Kumar) have made a mistake but you are not the mind behind the mistake... We know Gyanesh Kumar is unable to sleep at night; I am telling him directly 'you will not survive as CEC'," Gandhi said.

Noting that there was resistance earlier, too, but it had not spilled over into the streets, he said this fight will continue. "This is like Shiva's dance and anyone can join Shiva's 'baraat' (wedding procession)," he said. Gandhi also claimed that 200 officers of the government were "in touch" with his side and providing information.

"Why is CEC Gyanesh Kumar not giving his resignation? Opposition leaders were detained for exercising their right to protest. This happened because we have asked the same question as two Election Commissioners asked," Gandhi said.

He was referring to the findings of an investigation by *The Indian Express*, published on September 23, that two Election Commissioners in the three-member ECI objected on record 14 times in 10 months to steps taken by the Commission under the CEC -- from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names.

Gandhi did not mention the CJP but reiterated that there are "no parallel protests". "...there is one protest, the protest is to remove Gyanesh Kumar and then after that remove Mr Prime Minister, Mr Amit Shah, remove these people. We are not going to stop," he said.

In the evening, after the conclusion of the march to the Supreme Court, Gandhi took to X and extended his gratitude to "every single person" who joined the protest. "Today was a very important day because we needed to show the government that the people of India are not going to be intimidated. You cannot beat us, threaten us, frighten us. We will not accept being bullied," he posted.

INDIA bloc leadership will meet at Gandhi's Sunahari Bagh residence at 4 pm Tuesday for tea. The leaders will also address a press conference.

Delhi SIR

after the draft rolls were published on August 31.

But in the next 12 days, approximately 16 lakh notices — or 1.33 lakh notices per day — were disposed of, the figures made available on Monday show.

The 20 lakh notices that had been resolved until Monday include cases that have been verified and will be included in the final electoral roll, as well as those that have been rejected. The process of disposal of notices and objections can continue until November 30.

The office of the CEO Delhi stated on Monday that a proactive campaign had been initiated to resolve the notices.

Officials attributed the dramatically quickened pace of resolution over the past couple of weeks to relaxed procedures, the involvement of more officials, and strict targets for Booth-Level Officers (BLOs), the local government officials appointed by the Election Commission of India (ECI) to act as grassroots custodians of the electoral roll for each polling station.

Delhi had around 1.45 crore electors before the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls began on June 30. Among them, 97.5 lakh were included in the draft electoral roll that was published on August 31.

Around 47.5 lakh electors — almost a third of the pre-SIR number — were classified as "uncollectible" after BLOs found them to be absent, or to have moved or died, or to have duplicate entries. These names were struck off the roll.

Of the 97.5 lakh electors who did make it to the draft roll, around 33.1 lakh — almost 34% — were sent notices asking for proof that would make them eligible to be included in the final roll as well.

While 13.79 lakh electors were marked because they could not link themselves to the electoral roll of the last SIR of 2002, as many as 19.33 lakh electors were flagged for "logical discrepancies" in their enumeration forms.

Initially, in most constituencies, electors who had been flagged were required to visit the local Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) at their designated hearing time with one of 13 prescribed documents to have their notices resolved.

However, in its meeting held on September 26 — the first since *The Indian Express* reported on September 23 on the deep divide within the ECI — the poll panel greatly simplified the procedure for the conduct of hearings.

In a statement, the Commission said that electors who had been issued notices for "logical discrepancies" and for being "unmapped" would no longer be required to attend hearings at the local office to establish their eligibility. Instead, BLOs would go from house to house to collect documents from those who had been issued notices.

Facilities for online hearings were strengthened, and it was announced that members of the families of those who had received notices would be able to appear on behalf of the elector.

Also, the portal for EROs to approve electors for inclusion in the electoral roll was changed. Since September 30, EROs have been able to dispose of notices without conducting a hearing — just a letter by the BLO saying they were satisfied with the elector's details now suffices.

An official said that BLOs have been given a target of conducting at least 10 hearings every day. Several BLOs claimed that disposals have become faster since they are now well versed with the way the portal works.

The CEOs of at least eight other states and UTs — Jharkhand, Mizoram, Sikkim, West Bengal, Bihar, Puducherry, Uttarakhand and Gujarat — have also posted on X about ensuring that no eligible voter is left out of the electoral roll. These CEOs too have highlighted that a "proactive campaign" and "special camps" are being held across all booths to ensure this.

Rajasthan: Former BJP MLA beaten to death

result of a long-standing dispute over it, police said.

Circle Officer (Bhusawar) Neeraj Bhardwaj told *PTI* that Bhadana and Sharma were attacked with sticks and stones.

Bharatpur Superintendent of Police Rajesh Meena said the family had filed a complaint against 35-40 people. "Around 12 people have been detained, and several others are being investigated," Meena told *The Indian Express*, adding that the spot where the incident happened is very remote.

Bhadana and Sharma were taken to a local hospital in Weir first, before the former MLA was moved to SMS Hospital in Jaipur around 11.30 pm Sunday. Bhadana was declared dead on arrival. Sharma is at a hospital in Bharatpur.

On Monday, after the post-mortem, his body was handed over to the family, which took it to Pali, his ancestral village in Haryana's Faridabad district, for his last rites.

As per the *PTI* report quoting police, villagers have long accused Bhadana of encroaching on land meant for grazing and carrying out illegal mining. His stone crusher unit had been closed for about a year, and he was reportedly trying to restart it.

PTI said villagers had been sitting in protest for 10-15 days at the site, when Bhadana arrived with around 40 to 50 people on Sunday evening and tried to allegedly remove them. Villagers claimed that the BJP leader's men also attacked them.

Bhadana suffered serious head injuries, fractures in his hands and legs, and injuries on several parts of his body. An office comprising two rooms near the crusher site was also allegedly vandalised.

Assistant Superintendent of SMS Hospital Pradeep Sharma said there was no pulse by the time Bhadana reached the hospital. "He had multiple fractures all over his body."

Many senior leaders arrived at the SMS mortuary as news of the incident spread. Former MLA Pralhad Gunjal said the "mob lynching" showed that law and order in Rajasthan had worsened under the BJP government.

Former chief minister Ashok Gehlot posted on X that the murder had taken place in CM Bhajan Lal Sharma's home district. "When 70-80 people surround and beat a former MLA to death... then in this regime, God himself is the protector of the common man."

The dispute leading to the attack on Bhadana had reportedly been ongoing for nearly two years, Gehlot said. "What were the police and administration doing for two years? When the warnings were clear, why was no action taken?... A government in which even its own former MLAs are not safe, how can it assure the public of security?"

Bhadana entered electoral politics in Rajasthan in 1998, contesting the Bayana Assembly seat on a BJP ticket, and losing. He won the seat in 2003, becoming an MLA for the first time. In 2008, he contested the Nagar Assembly seat on a Congress ticket but lost.

Later, he rejoined the BJP and served as president of the Rajasthan unit of the party's Kisan Morcha.

One of Bhadana's daughters, Kiran Bhadana, took over as the Deputy Commissioner of Lahaul-Spiti in April 2025, becoming the first woman to hold the post. Earlier, the IAS officer was Director of Public Relations and Information in Himachal Pradesh.

Jantar Mantar

secure the heart of Lutyens' Delhi and detained several thousand people to ensure that they do not protest at Jantar Mantar.

The venue was the site of massive protests and hunger strikes organised by the CJP and other outfits in June-July demanding accountability over the NEET paper leak, which finally ended with the resignation of then Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

Leaders of the CJP, who had gone to Parliament Street police station on Monday to seek permission to protest at Jantar Mantar, said the denotification was unacceptable and an "assault on people's fundamental right to protest and peaceful assembly".

The three alternative venues named by police — Ramlila Ground, Burari Ground and CBD Ground in East Delhi — seek to take demonstrations away from the central administrative area around Parliament.

While Ramlila Maidan is in Central Delhi, Burari Ground lies to the northwest and CBD Ground to the east. Burari Ground is approximately 16 km from Jantar Mantar, and CBD Ground is more than 26 km to the northeast of the monument.

Ramlila Maidan is around 3.4 km from Jantar Mantar, making it closer to the former protest site than the other two venues. It has a long history of hosting political rallies and public movements, including Jayaprakash Narayan's rally in 1975 and the anti-corruption protests of 2011-12.

However, Ramlila Maidan is frequently booked weeks or months in advance. A PTI report quoting officials said the 12-acre ground that can accommodate 50,000 people is available for only three days this year – from December 29 to 31. It costs Rs 50,000 per day to book the Maidan, apart from a Rs-55,000 refundable security deposit, the report said.

Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar said in a standing order that revised SOPs governing protests, including the procedure for seeking permission, at the three venues would be issued separately.

The order, dated October 11 and made public Monday, said that the new arrangement follows the recommendations of a committee constituted by the MHA to examine alternative venues for protests, and partially modifies an earlier standing order dated April 28, 2022.

Earlier in the day, CJP leaders Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, along with their lawyers, met the Delhi Police to seek a date and time for holding a protest at Jantar Mantar.

Das said, "You (police) asked us to seek permission at least 10 days in advance to hold a protest at the designated site. We have come here to ask the police to inform us of the date and time."

After the meeting that lasted half an hour, the CJP members came out and said they had given the police 24 hours to respond to them. "We will decide our next course of action accordingly. If the police fail to inform us within 24 hours, we will decide when to return to Jantar Mantar," Ranka said.

Das said it was unacceptable to denotify Jantar Mantar as a protest site.

"Why is (Prime Minister) Narendra Modi scared of Jantar Mantar? The Jantar Mantar belongs to the people of India. Did the Ministry of Home Affairs consult with the people of India? Were any stakeholders consulted? Were any organisations consulted?" he said.

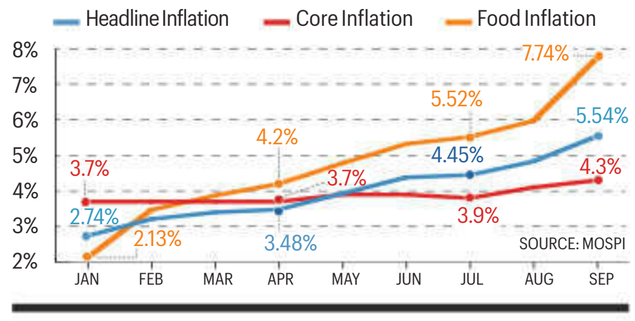
"Take it in writing — just how they are denotifying people's Jantar Mantar, the Prime Minister will soon denotify democracy in India. This move is a step towards that. We do not accept this arbitrary decision. It is an assault on people's fundamental right to protest and peaceful assembly. *Ab poora desh Jantar Mantar ban raha hai.* (Now the whole country will become Jantar Mantar.)"

In its 2018 ruling in Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India, the Supreme Court had considered the submission of the petitioners that Ramlila Maidan was too far from the "concentration of power" in New Delhi, and such a setup would impact the effect of these protests on the very authority the slogans were raised for. While the court accepted that contention, it said there was a need to balance the right of protesters with those of the residents, and held that "while regulating such demonstrations in public interest, particular areas can be earmarked".

The court allowed a limited portion of Jantar Mantar Road to remain open for regulated demonstrations by smaller groups, noting the site had been used for protests for a considerable period. On Monday, Delhi HC refused a plea to urgently list a petition for hearing on the matter. Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambre said it will be listed Tuesday, adding the SC was already dealing with protest-related litigation in which the Centre had been asked to respond.

Retail inflation

Household inflation moves closer to 6%



driven by higher prices of vegetables, fruits and sugar-related items. According to ICRA Chief Economist Aditi Nayar, of the 71-basis-point increase in inflation in September, 62 bps was because of the rise in prices of items from the 'food and beverages' category.

Food apart, prices of consumer electronics also kept rising, reflecting the shortage in memory chips, a key input in manufacturing these goods.

The latest inflation print of 5.54% is the highest in the new series which has data starting from January this year. If the old series, which had 2012 as the base year, is also taken into account, then the September inflation rate is the highest in almost two years, with the previous high being 6.21% in October 2024.

Economists now see headline inflation crossing 6% in October, data for which will be released on November 12.

The RBI is legally mandated to keep the headline inflation rate at 4% in a band of 2-6%. However, this is the fourth month in a row that inflation has come in above 4%. The central bank, which last week raised the policy repo rate by 25 basis points (bps) to 5.5%, expects CPI inflation to average 4.9% in July-September, 6% in October-December, 5.7% in January-March 2027, and 5.6% in April-June 2027.

While the average inflation for July-September is 4.9%, in line with the RBI's forecast, the "challenge" will be in October-December, said Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at Bank of Baroda. "Our view still holds that December will warrant another rate hike," he said.

A key area of concern for policymakers will be how more parts of the household consumption basket are seeing higher prices and increase in inflation, called "generalisation of inflation" by economists. In September, 11 of the 12 major categories of the CPI saw higher inflation, which Devendra Pant, Chief Economist at India Ratings & Research, said is indicative of this phenomenon.

A sub-category that captures the spread of higher prices in the wake of the West Asia war is 'restaurants and cafés'. From 2.73% in February, the consumer inflation reported by 'restaurants and cafés' has risen to 9.39% in September, reflecting higher cooking gas prices and other inputs.

While price index of the overall CPI basket was 0.7% higher in September as compared to August, the index for 'restaurants and cafés' increased by 1% month-on-month. Month-on-month, or sequential, increases are indicative of momentum in prices and watched closely by policymakers.

Sabnavis of Bank of Baroda warned that producers are yet to fully pass on higher costs to consumers. "Industries like durables, FMCG, automobile have announced an increase in prices and should get reflected in the CPI over the next few months. The state of kharif crop is important as food inflation will be largely driven by them. As of now, higher inflation is mainly due to depletion of earlier stocks as we head to the new season. Crop arrivals are hence important."

BJP

march as "pure theatrics". Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan accused the Congress of blaming the Election Commission (EC) for its defeats instead of its own "visionless leadership" for the electoral setbacks.

"The Congress seeks to mislead the public by questioning institutions such as the judiciary, the Election Commission, and the Armed Forces, while also relying on external forces to advance its political agenda. It has already lost credibility in the eyes of the people and is facing continued political decline," Chouhan said at a press conference at the BJP headquarters.

"The Congress's electoral defeats have continued unabated. Everyone is aware of the outcome of the recent by-elections. Congress's position in Assam has also been evident to all. The party suffered electoral defeats in Tripura and the local body elections in Rajasthan, as well as in Himachal Pradesh before that. Losing one election after another and venting its frustration on the streets through protests has become the Congress's fate," Chouhan alleged.

"By blaming Constitutional institutions for its electoral defeats, the Congress is committing a sin. The reason for the Congress's defeats is not because of the EC, but because of the Congress's own 'vichar shunya' (visionless) leadership, which is devoid of ideas," he said.

Targeting Gandhi over the march to the Supreme Court for a meeting with CJI Surya Kant — who turned down the Opposition party's request — Chouhan said everybody knows the LoP's stance on the judiciary and his views about a former CJI.

"Nevertheless, even meeting the CJI involves a specific procedure. You cannot simply write a letter and show up whenever you feel like it. This is just a drama, pure theatrics, nothing but theatrics," he said.

Chouhan also criticised Gandhi for calling the Congress and its anti-CEC protest "Shiv Ki Baarat", saying, "Those who oppose Ram are talking about Lord Shiv. It is not Lord Shiv's 'Baraat' but a mob of unruly elements attempting to spread anarchy on the streets."

In a post on X, Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said, "Protest is the right of every citizen but brazenly abusing constitutional authorities is deplorable. Congress Party is direction-less now. But they can improve their numbers if they have a matured and committed leader who doesn't enjoy spending 200 holidays in a year!"

"I had said it earlier, next target of the Congress Party is judiciary. Congress wants to destroy all the constitutional and democratic institutions of India. All anti-India gangs are joining hands. All patriotic Indians will also come together," he said in response to a post by the Congress's Kerala unit that was later deleted. Former Union Minister Anurag Thakur said, "They only know how to create anarchy, instability..."

JNU sexual harassment complaint: Congress MP Akoijam alleges 'witch-hunt' as FIR filed

Sakshi Chand & Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, October 12

DELHI POLICE has registered an FIR against Congress Lok Sabha MP Angomcha Bimol Akoijam, a former Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) professor, over allegations of sexual harassment at the varsity.

Last Friday, JNU had dismissed Professor Akoijam of the School of Social Sciences following an inquiry by the university's internal committee into the allegations.

Akoijam, however, has accused JNU Vice-Chancellor Santishree D Pandit of lying about the internal inquiry against him.

Officials said that around 10-12 students from the Centre for Study of Social Systems had filed a sexual harassment complaint against Akoijam, the Congress Lok Sabha MP from Inner Manipur.

The FIR, dated October 11, was registered at Vasant Kunj North police station under



Congress Lok Sabha MP and former JNU professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam.

charges of sexual harassment, making sexually coloured remarks, and word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman, on a complaint by JNU's Chief Security Officer. The FIR names Akoijam in connection with the allegations; police said the investigation is underway.

It follows a communication the same day from JNU's Chief Security Officer to the Station House Officer of Vasant Kunj North, forwarding documents submitted by the university's Internal Committee and requesting legal action.

Internal Committee report

As per the FIR, the university's Internal Committee assessed the allegations after examining complainants accounts, witness statements, defence witnesses and other material on record.

The letter from the JNU official flagged the committee's cumulative assessment, which stated it does not consider the above incident in isolation, but 'a recurring pattern of inappropriate personal interaction, sexually suggestive conduct, and unwelcome physical contact'.

The committee's assessment, as cited in the communication, also referred to an "intimidating and hostile learning environment" and "inadequate professional boundaries in interactions with female students".

As per the FIR, the alleged incidents took place between July 2025 and May 2026 at the Centre for Studies of Social System, School of Social Sciences, JNU, and other places.

JNU V-C lying, says Akoijam

Meanwhile, on Sunday Akoijam wrote on X: "... VC of JNU tells a blatant lie, saying that I have not produced any witness! And IC had written 43 mails, which I had responded to. And VC says on media, IC/JNU had written 300 mails! Shame!"

Akoijam wrote that he had responded in writing to the allegations on May 31 and deposed before the inquiry committee on July 16, and "yet VC says I didn't co-operate!"

"A false and malicious allegation, pursued by abusing an institution as a 'Khap Panchayat' to affirm it, and leaking out identity as well as concocting non-existent allegation and paddling [sic] the same through "media trial" to tarnish reputation is at the heart of the ongoing witch hunt," Akoijam said.

BJP holds protest, demands action

New Delhi: The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) Mahila Morcha on Monday protested outside the Congress headquarters in Delhi, demanding immediate action against Inner Manipur MP Angomcha Bimol Akoijam, who was sacked from JNU over allegations of sexual harassment at the varisty.

Mahila Morcha President Roopkumari Choudhary led its women MPs, MLAs, councillors and members of the Andhra Education Society School as they took part in a 'Nari Shakti Hunkar Andolan' over what the party termed a "serious case of sexual misconduct" involving 11 female students of JNU.

The protesters demanded that the accused MP be handed over to the police.

Choudhary said that Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, and the Congress party leadership should be "ashamed" for allegedly shielding an MP involved in the "criminal act of '#SexforMarks' by providing him with political protection". "The Congress party's talk of women's rights is merely a sham; in reality, their mindset is anti-women," she alleged.



During the protest march on Monday. X/@ROOPKUMARIBJP

Choudhary asked when the Congress would break its silence on the issues of women's dignity and justice and called for an impartial investigation into the allegations, accountability and justice for the young students from the end of Rahul and the party leadership. The party's women's wing underlined there was a contrast between Congress's "rhetoric on women's rights" and Rahul's claims of smashing the patriarchy, and their actual conduct. **ENS**



X/@GUPTA_REKHA

CM Rekha Gupta interacts with children in New Delhi on Monday.

CM inaugurates, launches projects for students, youth

New Delhi: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday inaugurated high-tech Centres of Excellence at three Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) in Jahangirpuri, Dhirpur and Narela.

The centres will provide training in industrial automation, robotics, digital manufacturing, CNC machining, 3D scanning and green energy technologies. Gupta said the government was prioritising education, skills, innovation and self-reliance to prepare young people for employment opportunities.

She also inaugurated a senior secondary school in Dwarka's Sector 16B. A hostel accommodating 120 women students was inaugurated at NSUT. She also laid the foundation stones for G B Pant Integrated College and Polytechnic in Okhla. **ENS**

DELHI METRO SEAT ROW ENDS IN MAN'S DEATH; FORMER IAS OFFICER, SON ACCUSED OF ASSAULT

'Died in front of me': Mother recalls man's assault

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 12

"MY SON died in front of my eyes, and I could not do anything," said Durga as she struggled to speak. Every horrific moment is still playing out in her mind in vivid details, she said, grieving the loss at her home in Yamuna Vihar of Northeast Delhi. She was surrounded by her daughter-in-law Anjali, grandchildren and acquaintances who had come to console Sharma's death on Monday.

Durga and her son, Pawan Sharma, 46, were returning home on October 8 when an argument over a senior citizen's seat on the Delhi Metro turned deadly and a former IAS officer and his son allegedly assaulted him. Identified as Sanjay Pratap Singh, the former IAS officer and his son were arrested a day later.





Deceased Pawan Sharma; (left) his mother. AFSHANA ALI BHAT.

Durga, in her 70s, broke down as she recalled what happened. "I was sitting next to my son when someone shook him and asked him to get up. All my son said was, 'Why talk like that?' I said the same thing. My son got up and gave up his seat. I got up too. That was when the man became aggressive and hit him. When I intervened, the man held my hands and pushed me back. Things went ugly from there," she said.

What followed, she said, was a brutal assault. "All I saw was my son being beaten up. I was shouting... no one came forward to help. At one point, I saw him getting choked, after which he just fell to the ground. People poured water on him, pressed his chest, but he did not get up," she added.

Pawan would have turned 47 on November 2. "They hit him the way boxers punch. This is how educated people who were once a part of the bureaucracy behave" she rued.

On the day of the incident, Durga and Pawan had gone to visit her younger son, Deepak, who was unwell, at his Gurugram home. After the visit, Deepak dropped them at the Dwarka Sector 21 Metro station around 4 pm. About an hour later, he received a call from his mother, who said, "Sab barbaad ho gaya" (Everything is over)."

Deepak immediately left for Delhi and reached LNJP Hospital, only to learn that his brother had been declared dead. "My brother was soft-spoken. He never picked a fight with anyone. He had a small social circle, and was devoted to his family," he added.

At Pawan's Yamuna Vihar home, his wife, and their daughter, Anishka, who is in Class 10, were shocked into silence. The couple's son, Divyansh, a student of Delhi University, said, "We want justice. Those who killed my father can't be out on the streets. They can do this to anyone else too," he added.

Accused former IAS officer was arrested earlier over corruption

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 12

FORMER IAS officer Sanjay Pratap Singh, who has been arrested over the killing of a 46-year-old man in Metro, has had a brush with law earlier too, according to police records. He has been arrested at least twice earlier.

A 1984-batch officer of the AGMUT cadre, Singh had served as a bureaucrat for nearly three decades. He eventually rose to become Principal Secretary in the Delhi government's Department for the Welfare of Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and Minorities.

As per official records, he was arrested in December 2015 along with his personal assistant, Ramesh Kumar, in a bribery case, which was investigated by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI). The central agency accused the two of accepting a bribe of Rs 2.2 lakh from a contractor whose firm provided manpower to Singh's department. The contractor had alleged that money was sought to clear pending bills.

The agency's searches also yielded 31 gold bars weighing 3.20 kg from a bank locker linked to Singh, along with cash, expensive watches and other assets, according to reports published by *The Indian Express* at the time.

Decades earlier, sources told *The Indian Express*, Singh had been arrested in 1991 while serving as the Collector in Daman. He was arrested again in the Capital several years later. Details of those earlier cases and their outcomes could not be independently established from the material available, but sources mentioned that it was related to corruption.

Both Singh and his son were arrested in the Delhi Metro assault case on October 8.

The police registered a case on October 9 under Section 105 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which deals with culpable homicide not amounting to murder, and Section 3(5), relating to common intention.





‘Beaten with lathis, kicked’: Protesters say they were assaulted in detention

Sakshi Chand, Sophiya Mathew & Drishti Jain
New Delhi, October 12

AT LEAST three men detained by Delhi Police in connection with the CJP protests have alleged that they and others, who were bundled into buses and taken to detention centres, were “assaulted” at makeshift detention facilities.

Medical records document injuries ranging from bruises and abrasions to a fracture in one man’s right elbow.

On Sunday evening, Nihal Alam (36), a resident of Kishanganj, Bihar, was allegedly visiting his sister in Bawana. Believing the CJP protests had ended on Saturday, he took the metro to Janpath and walked towards Connaught Place to buy clothes.

However, police picked him up and took him with others to a detention centre at the community centre in Pandwalan Khurd, Dwarka.

Alam alleges that police personnel beat the detainees with sticks inside a bus fitted with iron-barred partitions. “I told them my upper right arm was hurting, but they did not listen,” he said.

A medico-legal certificate (MLC) from a government hospital records a radial head fracture following an X-ray of his right elbow. The doctor also advised further imaging to assess the bones and joint structures, records show.

Alam said he was picked up around 5 pm in a roadways bus, taken to Janpath after about an hour, detained further and then shifted to what he described as jail cells. After reaching the detention centre, he requested first aid but received an injection and painkiller only after more than an hour.

“The doctors at RML told me I have a fracture in my upper right arm and that a rod will be inserted, which will cost Rs 20,000,” said Alam, who runs an eatery in his village. He returned home early Monday and said he would ask his family for money.

Arjun Unnikrishnan, a 30-year-old law graduate and researcher, who was also taken to the community centre in Pandwalan Khurd alleged assault.





Security stepped up in wake of protests(top); Nihal Alam ,one of the injured detainees. EXPRESS

Unnikrishnan claimed that personnel inside struck people across their bodies, kicked them in the “chest and back, and hit them in their private parts” The cramped conditions left the detainees with little room to move away, he said, adding that he reported injuries to his face, chest and back.

“I headed directly to a hospital after my release to secure the MLC, since I wanted documentary evidence of the physical harm I had suffered,” he says.

His MLC says “assault by unknown police personnel at 4:15pm near Rajeev Chowk”. He was prescribed medicines and some painkillers, according to the MLC.

Protesters who were detained in the police station also alleged that they were assaulted.

Fidal Tom, a 26-year-old Delhi-based lawyer detained by Delhi Police during Saturday’s protest-related detentions, alleged that police personnel beat him at the Sanjay Colony police post under Maidangarhi police station. Police held him there with other detainees before releasing him around 2 am on Sunday, he said.

His MLC prepared in the early hours of October 11 in Madan Mohan Hospital in Malviya Nagar records multiple injuries, including swelling on the left side of his face, an abrasion above his left eye, injuries on both arms and multiple contusions and abrasions on his back.

The examination noted that the injuries were most likely caused by multiple blunt-object trauma, according to the MLC.

Tom said he was detained at INA around 2 pm on October 10 and taken to the Sanjay Colony police post an hour later. Around 6 pm, he alleged, police personnel grew irritated when an AISA student discussed democratic rights with fellow detainees. About 20 students were being held in a room and beaten by a man in civilian clothes, he alleged.

When Tom questioned the man’s authority to beat detainees, noting that he was not in uniform, the man allegedly dragged him into a small bathroom, “where around 10 police personnel beat him with lathis”.

Tom said he identified himself as a practising advocate and showed his Bar Association ID card, also mentioning his appearance in court with senior advocate Kapil Sibal on October 9. The assault stopped after he disclosed these details, he alleged.

When reached out, a senior police official said : “We have not received any complaints on these allegations. However, if we receive a complaint, action will be taken under relevant provisions of law”.

‘How can you enter his house’: HC raps police on activist’s confinement

HC sought status report from police in two weeks

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 12

IN A relief for activist Nadeem Khan, the Delhi High Court Monday sought the Delhi Police’s response to allegations that he was illegally and unauthorisedly confined in anticipation that he would participate in protests against the SIR exercise.

A bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambre and Justice Sanjay Sharma also expressed consternation at the Shaheen Bagh police station, orally inquiring, “How can you enter the house of this man? You’ve your right to conduct duties, how can you do it in such a way?”

Last week, Khan, president of the civil rights advocacy group Association for Protection of Civil Rights (APCR), had sought an urgent hearing in the HC after he was informed by the police on October 8 that he was likely to be detained the next day and remain under house arrest until October 10.

Prior to this, he was confined to his house and office, both part of the same compound, on September 29. He was not provided any order for his detention or confinement, Khan had pointed out. Advocate Shahrukh Alam, representing Khan, said the police visited the activist’s house and office” on September 29, arriving at 9.30 am and staying till 5.30 pm.

“They asked for lunch and tea, which I provided... they were not able to show any order (warranting the confinement)... Since then, there has been repeated surveillance.”Alam added that on October 2, when Khan was leaving his home to visit his ailing mother, the police called him at 7.30 am to inquire about his whereabouts. “They did not stop me but there was constant surveillance... one police official identified himself as Inspector Nishant... This is harassment...”

The court issued notice to the police, seeking its status report in two weeks.

After Jantar Mantar closure, High Court likely to hear plea on protest site today

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 12

THE DELHI High Court is likely to hear on Tuesday two pleas related to the ongoing protest against alleged irregularities in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise and concerns over protest sites.

Both petitions had requested urgent listing for hearing on Monday but the request was refused by Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambre, who instead said the two pleas will be listed Tuesday, citing the litigation related to the protests already being pending before the Supreme Court.

One of the petitions flagged that no alternative protest site was designated after Jantar Mantar was closed for protests by police. However later in the day, the Delhi Police issued a standing order, denotifying Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site and instead designating three other venues: Ramlila Ground, Burari Ground and CBD Ground as the designated protest sites. However as of now, no detailed SOP has been issued on how protests are permitted at the three sites.

Over the past week, the CJP and Left student groups and parties, as well as Opposition leaders, have been staging protests around Central and South Delhi demanding CEC Gyanesh Kumar’s resignation over alleged irregularities in the SIR of electoral rolls.

The Delhi Police had imposed stringent curbs while denying permission to protest at Jantar Mantar, detaining hundreds who turned up for the protests including students, opposition leaders and advocates.

The advocate, requesting that this plea be heard Monday, said, “The right to free speech has been quelled to a great extent... Jantar Mantar has been closed and no alternate site has been designated for today to protest. This is absolutely going to be a black day, we faced this in 1975 (when then PM Indira Gandhi had imposed Emergency)...”

Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambre said the Supreme Court was already dealing with protest-related matters

ACJ Sambre also refused to list another plea by NSUI president Vinod Jakhar for Monday and said it will be listed Tuesday for hearing.

The plea is seeking a "fair, independent and time-bound probe into a series of assaults committed in broad daylight" by “anti-social elements” on October 10 at Connaught Place and near Jantar Mantar.

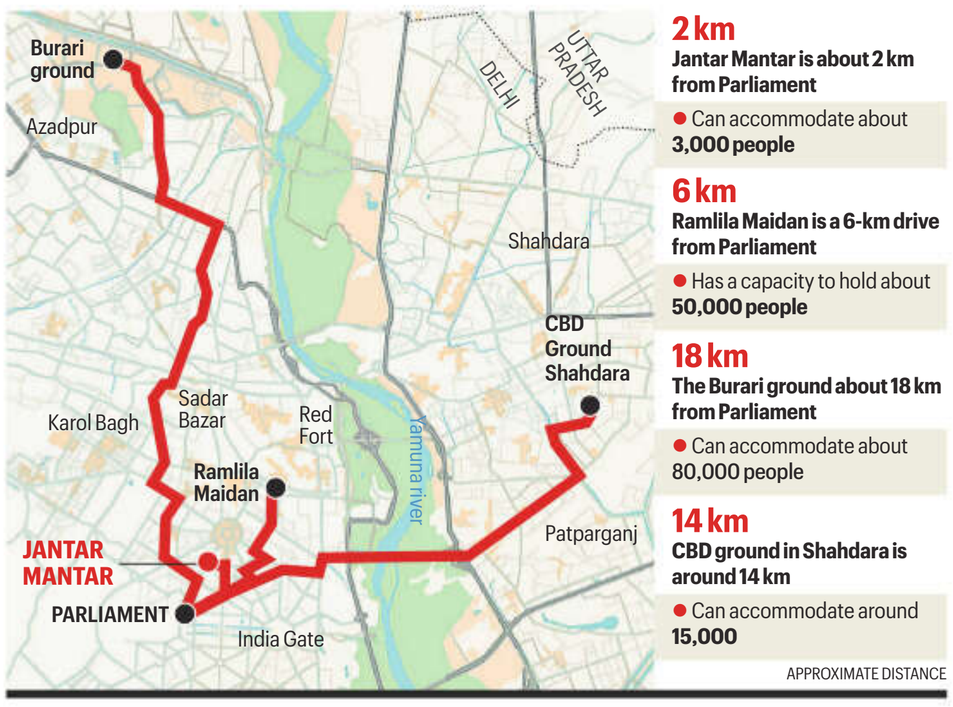
Another bench will also hear a plea by Indian Youth Congress president Uday Bhanu Chib challenging denial of permission to protest at Jantar Mantar. ACJ Sambre however said, “See, the Supreme Court is equally seized of the matter... Now when the SC is seized of it, to what extent can we (issue directions/intervene)?... so let’s see first (the SC proceedings).”

Meanwhile, at the SC, senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan Monday requested hearing of a plea over the anti-CEC protests in Delhi, highlighting that there are no prohibitory orders under BNSS Section 163 available in public domain and “senior advocates are being dragged through streets”.

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant has listed the plea for Tuesday.

CAPITAL’S NEW PROTEST SITES

● Protests no longer allowed at iconic Jantar Mantar



2 km
Jantar Mantar is about 2 km from Parliament
● Can accommodate about **3,000 people**

6 km
Ramlila Maidan is a 6-km drive from Parliament
● Has a capacity to hold about **50,000 people**

18 km
The Burari ground about 18 km from Parliament
● Can accommodate about **80,000 people**

14 km
CBD ground in Shahdara is around 14 km
● Can accommodate around **15,000**

APPROXIMATE DISTANCE

Burari Ground

Burari, also known as Nirankari Ground, is situated on land owned by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA). Spread across around 50 acres, it can accommodate 80,000-1 lakh people. It is around 22 km away from Parliament and lies along the Delhi-Chandigarh Highway near the well-known localities of Burari, Timarpur and Jahangirpuri. The ground has hosted large-scale political rallies and religious congregations. The Sant Nirankari Mission leases the ground for a few days every November for its annual congregation. Local residents also use the ground for cricket matches, driving classes, etc. In March, the ground hosts national-level kite-flying competitions. According to a police officer, the ground is preferred for large gatherings partly because vehicles can be parked on the roadside. However, such events often lead to traffic congestion on the highway, which could pose a challenge for the authorities if it is used as a long-term protest site. During the farmers’ agitation against the three farm laws in 2020-21, the ground served as one of the protest sites where hundreds of farmers camped for months.

CBD Ground

The CBD Ground is owned by the DDA and can accommodate around 15,000 people. Spread across 12 acres, it is around 13 km away from Parliament, in the heart of Shahdara district. The ground is surrounded by localities such as Vishwas Nagar, Krishna Nagar, Jagatpuri and Anand Vihar. The venue is primarily used for Ramlila performances and wedding functions. Three Ramlila events are currently underway here. It has also been used by political leaders to address public gatherings during election campaigns. Cross River Mall, Unity One Mall and several banquet halls are located in the vicinity. The office of the Joint Commissioner of Police, Eastern Range, is also situated nearby. The Karkardooma Court Metro station is around half a kilometre away. The route to the ground from Central Delhi passes through ITO and follows Vikas Marg, crossing Laxmi Nagar and Preet Vihar. The traffic congestion during Ramlila performances and wedding functions is already a major concern. B S Vora, Federation of East Delhi RWAs president, protests and confrontations with the administration might be easier to manage in central Delhi, but CBD Ground lacks the necessary infrastructure to accommodate such activities.

Ramlila Maidan

Spread across 12 acres, Ramlila Maidan has a capacity of around 50,000 people and is located about 5 km from Parliament. The ground has a rich historical and political legacy, having hosted significant public gatherings and political movements. In 1952, Syama Prasad Mookerjee led a Satyagraha against Article 370 here. Former prime minister (PM) Jawaharlal Nehru addressed large gatherings at this venue in the 1950s. In 1971, then PM Indira Gandhi addressed a rally here. The ground became a prominent centre of the 2011 anti-corruption movement led by activist Anna Hazare. It hosted events associated with the formation of AAP and oath-taking ceremony of AAP Ministers in 2013. The ground is surrounded by densely populated localities, including Turkman Gate, and is close to Asaf Ali Road and Chandni Chowk's Chawri Bazar. On one side of the ground lie roads leading towards New Delhi Railway Station, while Zakir Husain Delhi College and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s (MCD’s) Civic Centre are located on the other side. The area sees a heavy traffic flow throughout the day. With its neighbourhoods densely populated, traffic management could be a significant concern when large gatherings are held. The ground falls under the jurisdiction of the MCD, which charges Rs 50,000 per day for bookings. It hosts two major Ramlila events during Dussehra. - **Alok Singh**



In 2011 and 2012, yoga guru Ramdev led two protests at Ramlila Maidan against alleged corruption under the UPA government. FILE

Protests at Ramlila Maidan will affect business, say traders

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, October 12

JANTAR MANTAR is no longer the default address for protests in the Capital.

The Delhi Police's order to shift the designated venue to other sites — Ramlila Maidan, Burari Ground and CBD Ground — in the city, has evoked mixed reactions from the traders.

Even as the New Delhi Traders Association (NDTA) said the move to shift protests away from Jantar Mantar has brought relief to traders in Connaught Place and nearby areas during the festive season, two other trade bodies have expressed apprehensions.

The Chamber of Trade and Industry (CTI) and the All India Motor and Goods Transport Association (AIMGTA) have urged the Centre and Delhi Police to exclude Ramlila Maidan from the list, citing the potential disruption to wholesale markets, transport networks and emergency services.

‘Business worth Rs 2,000 crore hit’

In a statement issued on Monday, CTI chairman Brijesh Goyal said markets within a five-kilometre radius of the Ramlila Maidan include Sadar Bazar, Chandni Chowk, Chawri Bazar, Khari Baoli, Bhagirath Place, Kashmere Gate, Paharganj, Daryaganj, Kamla Market and Lajpat Rai Market.

He said business worth hundreds of crores of rupees is conducted daily through these markets, which supply goods across the country and abroad.

“If protests are held at Ramlila Maidan, barricading is done and Metro stations are closed, then the business of all these markets will be badly affected, especially in this festive season,” he said.

The association also issued another statement, claiming that protests held in Delhi on October 10 had affected business worth approximately Rs 2,000 crore across retail, hospitality, transport, tourism and other service sectors.



Chandni Chowk market is in proximity to Ramlila Maidan FILE

The statement added that the restrictions had deterred customers from outside Delhi as well as local shoppers from visiting the markets.

With Navratri festivity and the Diwali shopping season underway, the association has written to Chief Justice of India B R Gavai's office, requesting that protests be held outside Delhi until Diwali.

‘Emergency services could be hit too’

AIMGTA president Rajinder Kapoor, in a letter to Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar on Monday, also sought the removal of Ramlila Maidan from the designated venues. Kapoor also cited the proximity of hospitals, including, Lok Nayak Jai Prakash Narayan Hospital and Maulana Azad Hospital, arguing that congestion could hamper access during emergencies.

Meanwhile, NDTA president Atul Bhargava said the move had brought relief to traders after several days of disruption.

● JANTAR MANTAR BECAME THE CAPITAL’S DESIGNATED PROTEST SITE AFTER THE BOAT CLUB WAS SEALED OFF UNDER PROHIBITORY ORDERS IN 1993

From Irom Sharmila’s fast to NEET stir: Jantar Mantar a site of many protests

Sukrita Baruah
New Delhi, October 12

WHEN JANTAR Mantar first emerged as the Capital’s new ‘designated’ protest site in the mid-1990s, academic-activist Shaswati Mazumdar recalls, she felt activists like her had been “pushed into a corner.”

The site, next to the 18th-century astronomical observatory off Parliament Street, became the seat of protests closest to Parliament after the Boat Club Lawns, the earlier site, was sealed off under prohibitory orders in 1993.

According to historian Sohail Hashmi, the Lawns, a large open field next to Krishi Bhawan and Rajpath, was the first post-Independence "protest site."

"It was within earshot of Parliament. I remember a couple of demonstrations in which I had participated, MPs had come to receive memorandums from protesters. That was the city's protest site for around four decades," he said.

Over the decades, the Boat Club Lawns had been witness to protests led by figures such as Chaudhary Charan Singh, farmer leader Mahendra Singh Tikait and Jayprakash Narayan (JP). Ramlila Maidan, near Chandni Chowk, was also a major site of protest during the JP Movement in the mid-1970s.

In her paper "Spatial Language of Dissent in New Delhi: Public Space, Protests, and the National Capital (c. 1947–2022)," historian Harleen Kaur suggests two reasons for the decision to move protesters out of the prime location of Boat Club Lawns. The first was the week-long farmers' protest led by Tikait in 1988 at the India Gate lawns and Parliament Street, which "had rendered these spaces inaccessible for the ruling party rally." The second, and more immediate, was a rally scheduled by an ascendant Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) for February 1993. She writes that “there were around 200,000 policemen deployed to form a human wall to prevent protesters from reaching Boat Club" ahead of the rally.

It was after this that Jantar Mantar emerged as a protest site. On Monday, the Delhi Police denotified it as a designated protest site and named Ramlila Maidan and Burari Ground in north Delhi, and CBD Ground in east Delhi, as alternatives.



Jantar Mantar was the site of the India Against Corruption movement in 2011. EXPRESS ARCHIVE

Although Jantar Mantar has become an iconic venue, Mazumdar, who was a student activist from the 1970s and went on to become the first woman president of the Delhi University Teachers' Association, said the shift to a more sequestered space from the Boat Club Lawns was disappointing to activists, even though it was only less than 2 km away from Parliament.

"From Boat Club, we would go right up to Rafi Marg. But Jantar Mantar was a corner where nobody could see the protesters. Only those who were participating in a protest were privy to it. But the idea of a demonstration was that the public should see it, hear the slogans and what the protesters are saying. The space has acquired a new character now because of the CJP protests and of the reach of visuals from there through social media, but we always thought of it as a strange place where we were hidden in a corner," she said.

Still, like lakhs of people over the decades, she has protested at Jantar Mantar several times.

The site has witnessed several defining moments of dissent: Irom Sharmila's 16-year-long fast against the Armed Forces Special Powers Act in Manipur; the protests after the 2012 Delhi gang-rape; the India Against Corruption movement; the Narmada Bachao Andolan; the protest by top wrestlers against then Wrestling Federation of India chief and BJP MP Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh; and, most recently, the anti-NEET paper leak protest led by the CJP in July, which led to the resignation of then Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

Apart from these headline-grabbing movements, some of which even forced change, Jantar Mantar has also hosted smaller protests nearly every day over the years. At times these have involved Accredited Social Health Activists (ASHA) workers demanding better wages, and at others safai karamcharis protesting the deaths of their colleagues in sewers.

Despite its popularity, the use of Jantar Mantar as a protest site has been contentious. In 2017, the National Green Tribunal (NGT) directed that protest activities there be stopped after residents living nearby filed a petition raising concerns over noise and traffic. However, the order was reversed in 2018.

On the new venues, Hashmi said, “the Burari site is too far from the Parliament. People protest in Delhi to raise their voices and make it heard in the Parliament,” said Hashmi.

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge puts on a Batman mask in New Delhi on Monday. REUTERS

Batman Buzz

IN A bus packed with popular INDIA bloc leaders moving towards the Supreme Court, the one face that created the maximum buzz among Gen Z protesters was that of Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge in a Batman mask. Passed on by a protester, the mask reached Kharge, seated by the window in the first row, and he sportingly put it on. Soon, videos of Kharge in the Batman mask went viral on social media and became a talking point among politicians across party lines. Several MPs are learnt to have gone to Kharge and praised the adorable gesture of the 83-year-old. He also posed for photos for journalists covering the protest march.

Flight Hiccup

THE TIMING of two flights complicated the plan of INDIA bloc leaders to put up a united show of strength in the Capital on Monday. Former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee's flight to Kolkata was scheduled for 5 pm, while Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav was landing in Delhi at 2.15 pm. Discussions were held on Sunday night to find a way to ensure the presence of the two prominent leaders together during the protest march to the Supreme Court. However, as luck would have it, Akhilesh got stuck in traffic and by the time he reached the protest site, Mamata had already left for IGI Airport.

Mamata's TMC to protest in Kolkata

Kolkata: The Mamata Banerjee faction of TMC has called for a protest rally — from Rajabazar to Park Circus — in Kolkata on Tuesday against the Centre and ECI. There was, however, no clarity on whether Banerjee would join the protest. PTI



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and other INDIA bloc leaders on their way to the Supreme Court on Monday. ANIL SHARMA

Don't drag SC into politics: CJI Kant

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 12



CJI Surya Kant

CHIEF JUSTICE of India Surya Kant said on Monday the Supreme Court "should not be dragged into" the politics of the ongoing protests against CEC Gyanesh Kumar, and that nothing should impede its functioning or the movement of lawyers and litigants.

Presiding over a three-judge bench, CJI Kant made the remarks when Senior Advocate Atmaram Nadkarni and Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) President Pradeep Rai mentioned petitions regarding the alleged detention of lawyers during the CJP protests against the CEC. Agreeing to take them up on Tuesday, the CJI said, "All these democratic activities should take place, but at least in Supreme Court functioning..."

Nadkarni said his petition is by an independent lawyer expressing genuine difficulties.

"I have appealed to protesters also... But the Supreme Court should not be dragged into any kind of this. (Protest) peacefully. There should not be any impediment or obstruction in the functioning, in the movement of the lawyers, movement of the court staff, movement of the litigants," the CJI said.

Rai said, "I have made a statement in this regard that they should not bring the court into all this and they should also be responsible political parties".

The CJI's remarks assume significance as they come on a day the Congress has called for an Opposition march to the apex court after Justice Kant turned down its request for a meeting, citing the pendency of cases and the court's inability to address such grievances through administrative channels.

Led by Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, the delegation will seek a halt to the SIR of electoral rolls and demand the CEC's resignation.

Meanwhile, hearing a request to take up a fresh plea against the detention of lawyers in Saturday's protests, CJI Kant said, "Every lawyer, every member of the bar has the right to be a part of the peaceful protests, wherever the identified locations are there..."

Senior Advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, who mentioned the plea, said lawyers were "dragged through streets". Sankaranarayanan said prohibitory orders passed under BNSS Section 163 were not available in the public domain. "We have also challenged the vires of one section. Our senior advocates are being dragged through streets. Mr Shadan Farasat was dragged through streets. It was most unseemly. It shouldn't have happened," Sankaranarayanan said.

The CJI said he does not want to say anything as of now.

"At some point, the bench will come to the rescue of the Bar and the citizens of the country, and send a strong message to police. They think they can get away with anything," Sankaranarayanan said.

The CJI then said that he will list the matter for Tuesday, along with other similar petitions challenging the alleged detentions and restrictions on public utilities.

Opp to SC: Probe EC decisions, audit of SIR voter deletions

Petition refers to alleged exercise of ECI's collective powers by CEC without nod or knowledge of two other Commissioners

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, October 12

SEEKING THE Supreme Court's intervention in the alleged "unilateral and arbitrary exercise of the collective powers of the Election Commission of India", Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, Rajya Sabha Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge, and other leaders of the INDIA bloc parties filed a joint writ petition before the Supreme Court on the legitimacy of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

"The present petition arises from serious allegations concerning the functioning of the Election Commission of India during the implementation of the SIR, including the alleged exercise of the Commission's collective powers by the Chief Election Commissioner without the knowledge, approval or concurrence of the other Election Commissioners; the absence of a recorded decision of the Commission authorising the nationwide SIR; the unlawful modification of the statutory Form 6 without amendment of the applicable Rules; the centralised and opaque functioning of the ECINET and ERONET electoral-roll databases; and the large-scale exclusion of electors without adequate notice, hearing or an effective mechanism for restoration," the plea argues.

The petition refers to "the alleged exercise of the Commission's collective powers by the Chief Election Commissioner without the knowledge, approval or concurrence of the other Election Commissioners; the absence of a recorded decision of the Commission authorising the nationwide SIR; the unlawful modification of the statutory Form 6 without amendment of the applicable Rules".

The plea also cited *The Indian Express*'s investigative report of 23 September 2026, which reported that the two Election Commissioners had recorded objections on at least 14 occasions over a period of ten months. The petition records the Commission's response that "the reports present only one part of the picture, that differences of opinion are normal in deliberative processes, and that its decisions were unanimous".

The opposition plea said that it "does not seek to prejudge these competing positions" and that the "central question" of whether these decisions in question were "taken in accordance with the Constitution, the governing statute and the law declared by this Hon'ble Court" can only be answered upon examination of the relevant records of the Commission.

The petition states that it does not seek to reopen the question of the validity of the SIR as such. The SC, in a judgment on 27 May in 'Association for Democratic Reforms vs Election Commission of India', stated that the EC had the power to conduct the SIR process.

On Punjab, it states that the draft electoral roll published on 13 August 2026 "reportedly reflected a reduction of approximately 20.66 lakh names from the electorate of about 2.14 crore recorded in June 2026". It adds that "the final electoral roll was scheduled for publication on 12 October 2026".

Among the prayers, the petitioners seek a direction to the Election Commission of India "to place on record the complete files, agendas, minutes, notings and objections recorded by the Election Commissioners in respect of each of the disputed decisions relating to the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls".

They also seek to "constitute an independent committee headed by a retired Judge of this Hon'ble Court and assisted by technical experts and other citizens of eminence, to conduct, within a fixed time, an independent audit of the deletions and modifications made during the Special Intensive Revision".

The plea also sought a direction to the EC "to publish, boothwise, the names of all electors deleted during the Special Intensive Revision, together with the reasons for each deletion and a breakdown of deletions by gender and age". They also sought "an interim direction suspending the ongoing SIR exercise across States of the Union, pending consideration and adjudication of the issues raised in the present petition".

SC: No adjudication on new Form 6, neither approved nor disapproved

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 12

CLARIFYING ITS remarks from last week on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, the Supreme Court said Monday that it had neither approved nor disapproved the "new" Form 6, used to enroll new voters, which included an additional declaration.

The clarification was made by a three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and including Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, while issuing notice on a fresh petition questioning the functioning of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Appearing for the petitioners, Advocate Narendra Mishra referred to remarks made by the CJI during a hearing on October 5 that the Supreme Court had not approved the "new" Form 6. "On October 5, it was already declared by this court, Form 6 is not approved by the Court. But the ECI (Election Commission of India) said it was approved by the Supreme Court," Mishra told the bench.

Justice Bagchi said, "...there is no adjudication on the new Form 6. That is all we have said. Whether approved or not approved...."

Expressing displeasure at the reference to his remarks, suggesting they were selectively interpreted, the CJI said: "Don't pick up words like this..."

Justice Bagchi said, "What the Hon'ble Chief Justice said was that when the Bihar SIR judgment was delivered (in May), new Form 6 was not there. That does not either say it is approved or disapproved by the Supreme Court. We will examine it." He was referring to the judgment upholding the Constitutional validity of the SIR in Bihar.

The court tagged the plea with petitions already pending before it seeking similar relief and scheduled for hearing on October 27.

On October 5, the CJI, while responding to a petition arguing that a "modified" Form 6 was used for the SIR, had remarked orally that the court had not approved any "modified" version of Form 6, and would examine ECI records to know whether any change had been made and, if so, by whom.

The CJI's remarks had come days after the ECI issued a statement on September 26 in which it said, "The declaration attached to Form 6 for SIR has been upheld by the Hon'ble Supreme Court. For non-SIR period, the Forms applicable as per Rules (the Registration of Electors Rules 1960) will be used."

The ECI was responding to the findings of an investigation by *The Indian Express*, published on September 23, that two Election Commissioners in the three-member ECI objected on record 14 times in 10 months to steps taken by the Commission under CEC Gyanesh Kumar — from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names.

The CJI's remarks of October 5 were picked up by Opposition leaders, including Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, who accused the CEC of having lied in the press statement.

On July 12, *The Indian Express* had first reported that the online Form 6 on the ECI's ECINet portal had an additional declaration asking applicants whether they, or their parents or grandparents, were on the electoral roll of the last SIR — and that the form could not be submitted without an answer.

Kerala Assembly passes resolution seeking CEC removal

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 12



Chief Minister V D Satheesan at the Assembly on Monday. ANI

THE KERALA Legislative Assembly on Monday passed a resolution seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar amid a raging controversy over the SIR of electoral rolls.

The resolution — perhaps the first such in the country — was moved by state Chief Minister V D Satheesan in the 140-member House where the ruling Congress-led alliance has a strength of 102. The Left, which has 35 members, also supported the resolution, leading to its unanimous passing.

"The right to vote is the foundation of our democracy. No institution can be allowed to undermine the Constitutional rights of our citizens. Our stand is unequivocal. The right to vote must be protected. The Constitution must be upheld. Democracy must prevail. Keralam stands firmly for free and fair elections," he said. "Keralam makes history. For the first time, the Keralam Legislative Assembly has passed a resolution seeking the removal of the CEC. The integrity of our electoral process is non-negotiable."

The resolution contended that there were serious concerns regarding the voter roll revisions, disenfranchisement of eligible voters, and impartiality of the Election Commission of India, all of which "cannot be ignored".

The resolution sought to address the alleged irregularities in the SIR of electoral rolls and immediate restoration of the voting rights of all eligible voters who have been wrongfully excluded. It also sought initiation of proceedings to remove the CEC, saying his impartiality has come under serious question in view of the allegations against the SIR.

Additionally, it also sought reconstitution of the Election Commissioners' selection committee to include the Prime Minister, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, and the Chief Justice of India — "to ensure the independence and credibility of the institution".

MPSC chairman goes on leave, aspirants call off 11-day strike

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, October 12

MAHARASHTRA PUBLIC Service Commission (MPSC) chairman Vivek Bhimanwar on Monday said that he chose to go on leave without any political or external pressure and the decision was taken after listening to his "moral conscience".

"As a committee has been announced that has the purview over the functioning of the MPSC and conduct an inquiry, I don't feel it right to be on the post as the chairman for the time period. I listened to my moral conscience and decided that I will go on leave for this period," Bhimanwar said.

Apart from chairman Bhimanwar, MPSC has five more members — Dr Abhay Wagh, Dr Satish Deshpande, Satish Waghole, Rajeev Nivatkar and Dr Dilip Patil-Bhujbal. When asked if the members will also go on leave to avoid conflict of interest, Bhimanwar said, "I can't comment on others. They have to take a decision for themselves."

The Indian Express contacted all five members of the MPSC on Monday. Wagh and Bhujbal did not reply to repeated phone calls. Deshpande, Nivatkar and Waghole said that they are unaware about the formation of the panel and have no knowledge about Bhimanwar's decision. All three members said they do not want to comment on the protests and demands of students as it will not be appropriate for them to speak to the media.

When asked if there was any order from the CMO, former transport commissioner Bhimanwar said, "The decision was entirely mine."

MPSC aspirants, who had been protesting in Pune for the past 11 days over alleged malpractices in government recruitment exams and demanding the removal of Bhimanwar, called off their agitation after the state accepted their demands.

The inquiry committee will review the Commission's functioning, identify flaws, and suggest improvements, and submit its report to the state within two months. Former Chief Justice of Bombay HC Justice Dilip Bhosale will be appointed its chairperson, which will have state FDA commissioner Tukaram Mundhe as secretary.

A new chief, an old feud: UP Cong faces early test with office clash

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, October 12



A screengrab of the scuffle at the party office in Lucknow, Sunday

AN ALLEGED confrontation at the Uttar Pradesh Congress office involving women functionaries and former state president Ajay Rai's supporters has put the party's efforts to promote women in leadership and expand its Dalit outreach under scrutiny ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections.

The incident on Sunday — which saw abuses being directed at women functionaries and footwear being hurled — has caused unease within the party. The controversy comes as the Congress seeks to project organisational change under its new state chief Aradhana Misra Mona and broaden its social base through leaders such as All India Congress Committee in-charge Rajendra Pal Gautam.

As per party leaders, the reported confrontation took place before Misra and newly appointed working chief Imran Masood reached the office to formally take charge. The visuals also show people accompanying Rai speaking aggressively during an exchange with Masood, who appeared to be trying to calm the former state president.

The episode has acquired added significance as Mamta Chaudhary, chief of the state Mahila Congress's central zone and a Dalit leader, was at its centre. Party leaders said Chaudhary had served as a corporator for four terms and has had run-ins with Rai in the past.

"Even if there was some provocation from some women workers, the situation could have been handled differently rather than hurling abuses at women, especially when it was known that cameras were recording the incident," a party leader said. "With elections approaching, the episode has given fresh ammunition to the BJP. Many BJP-affiliated social media accounts have been posting the video. We will certainly have some explaining to do, considering that she (Chaudhary) hails from a Dalit community."

The AICC has constituted a fact-finding panel headed by former UP Congress chief Brijlal Khabri, a prominent Dalit leader, to probe the incident. Khabri, a former BSP leader, told *The Indian Express* that the committee would submit its report within a week. Khabri said he would begin the inquiry at the Pradesh Congress Committee office and speak to those present during the confrontation, particularly those considered neutral. The report, he said, would be based on these interactions.

"We will prepare a neutral report and submit it to the Pradesh Congress Committee. We are not concerned with who is involved or what position they hold. We will mention the names of those found responsible for the mistakes. Taking action against them is the party's responsibility," he said.

Even as the committee prepares to establish the sequence of events, leaders close to both sides have accused each other of orchestrating a "planned" move, bringing factional divisions within the state unit into sharper focus. Khabri's appointment to head the committee is significant given the social and political dimensions of the controversy. The findings, and the action that may follow, could provide an early test of the new state leadership's ability to manage factional tensions and establish accountability in the organisation.

The challenge is particularly daunting in UP, where the Congress has two MLAs in the 403-member House. After improving its performance in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections as part of the INDIA bloc, the party is seeking to translate that recovery into a durable political presence ahead of the 2027 Assembly polls.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Khandesh Bahuuddeshiya Sanstha's College of Engineering & Technology,
North Maharashtra Knowledge City, Jalgaon
(Approved by AICTE, Recognized by DTE Mumbai (Government of Maharashtra) and Affiliated to Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University)
(Accredited by NAAC & ISO 9001:2015)
Gat No.166, Bambhori, In Front of K.B.C. North Maharashtra University Main Gate, N.H.6, Jalgaon-425001 (M.S.) Website: www.nmkcj.org.in
Email id : nmkcj5396@gmail.com Contact Number: 9665492414
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RECRUITMENTS

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The detailed about the vacant positions, reservations, Education Qualifications, Experience and other requirements, pay Scale, terms and conditions and the procedure for application is available on the college website **(www.nmkcj.org.in)** and university website **(www.dbatu.ac.in)**.

Place : Bambhori, Jalgaon
Date : 12/10/2026

President,
Khandesh Bahuuddeshiya Sanstha, Jalgaon

Namibian cheetah cub found dead in Kuno park

Express News Service
Bhopal, October 12

AN EIGHT-month-old cub born to a Namibian cheetah was found dead at Madhya Pradesh's Kuno National Park on Monday, after it went missing during morning monitoring, officials said.

Aasha, one of the cheetahs brought from Namibia to India under the country's cheetah reintroduction programme, had five cubs earlier this year.

On Monday, forest officials found it with only four during morning monitoring and launched a search for the cub.

The cause of death remains unknown, and officials said further details would be available after the post-mortem examination.

The death comes amid a period of renewed breeding success at Kuno, where successive births have strengthened the effort to establish a self-sustaining cheetah population in India. In less than a month, the national park in Madhya Pradesh has witnessed two baby booms.

Citing 50% cap, Karnataka HC strikes down law to hike quota for SC/ST

Reservation in excess of the cap would breach the equality clauses: Division bench

Express News Service
Bengaluru October 12

THE KARNATAKA High Court on Monday struck down Sections 3 and 4 of Karnataka Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Reservation of seats in educational institutions and of appointments or posts in the services under the state) Act, 2022, declaring them as "unconstitutional".

The Act came into effect retrospectively from November 1, 2022, during the previous BJP government under Basavaraj Bommai.

A division bench of Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru and Justice K S Hemalekha passed the order and said, "Section 3 of the Act, insofar as it takes the aggregate reservation beyond the ceiling of 50%, is struck down as it violates Articles 14 and 15 of the Constitution. Section 4 of the Act is also struck down as unconstitutional, as it violates Articles 14 and 16 of the Constitution."

The government had in 2022 hiked quotas for SC communities from 15 to 17 per cent, and for ST communities from 3 to 7 per cent, in educational institutions and in appointments or posts in the services under the state, taking the state's total reservation to 56 per cent and exceeding the Supreme Court-mandated 50 per cent ceiling.

Petitioners Mahendra Kumar Mitra and others had challenged the provisions of the Act, citing that it is contrary to the law laid down by the Supreme Court in the 'Indra Sawhney and others vs Union of India' case.

Further, they said the National Commission for Scheduled Castes and the National Commission for Scheduled Tribes were not consulted as required under Article 338 (9) and 338-A (9) of the Constitution.

The state government had relied on Nagamohan Das Commission Report, the Adi Committee Report and the Report on Backwardness, Inadequacy of Representation and Administrative Efficiency in Karnataka dated 05.05.2017, prepared by the committee headed by the then Additional Chief Secretary K Ratna Prabha to contend that an increase in the reservation in favour of SCs and STs is necessary to ensure their adequate representation in the services.

"Over 90% of the population of the State belongs to the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes and the other backward classes, and that the reservation should be to the extent of the said percentage of population," the committee had observed.

The bench rejected the state government's contentions, saying: "The subjective opinion of the state government that a backward class is not adequately represented in proportion to its population does not enable the state to exceed the limit of 50% (ceiling reservation), but only to provide for reservation within the said limit... Any reservation in excess thereof would breach the equality clauses, which would be impermissible."

In the Indra Sawhney case, the 50% reservation ceiling under Articles 15(4) and 16(4) of the Constitution was firmly established by a nine-judge bench of the Supreme Court. The bench in its order made it clear that this is not an elastic limit to be assessed on a case-to-case basis, or one dependent on the population of the backward classes or the extent of their backwardness. However, the Supreme Court left room for an exception in extraordinary situations.

The High Court order, referring to the Supreme Court judgment, reiterated that it is neither apposite nor feasible for it to exhaustively set out the circumstances that may be considered extraordinary enough to warrant a breach of the 50% ceiling.

The bench in the order held: "A subjective opinion that the reservation in favour of an identified backward class ought to be a few percentage points higher is not extraordinary enough to trigger the exception to the 50% rule. Such an opinion does not constitute an extraordinary situation warranting a breach of the 50% limit, which reflects the balance between the equality clauses and breaching the said limit would effectively undermine the principle of equality, one of the values on which the Constitution is founded."

The court also underscored that providing reservation for certain backward classes does not preclude their members from competing for the remaining pool of appointments.

Underlining that the government wrote to the Commissions nearly three years after the Act was enacted in 2022, the bench said: "Consultation, to be meaningful and effective, must precede the decision. The contention that consultation is mandatory only if the policy adversely affects any Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes is unmerited."

BRIEFLY



CM Pushkar Singh Dhami during the launch event on Monday

UTTARAKHAND

State launches Haridwar Kumbh '27 logo, website and theme song

WITH PREPARATIONS underway for the Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027, the Uttarakhand government on Monday launched the official logo, website and theme song for the event. The design was selected from hundreds of entries submitted by people across Uttarakhand following an invitation by the mela administration. A selection committee shortlisted 13 designs before choosing the entry submitted by Madhu Sharma, a resident of Haridwar. An official theme song, *Kumbh Ka Parv Aa Gaya*, was also released. It is written, composed and sung by Raghav Raja. The logo, website and theme song were unveiled by CM Pushkar Singh Dhami at the Mela Control Building in Haridwar, in the presence of Cabinet ministers and senior officials. ENS

Week-long heavy rain forecast in 4 south states

IMD MONDAY warned of prolonged wet spell over most of southern India with the onset of the northeast monsoon. With the commencement of the season announced on Monday, heightened rainfall activity is forecast along with gusty winds, thunder and lightning activities over Kerala, coastal and southern Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Mahe, Karaikal and along the coastal belt of Andhra Pradesh till October 18. The 2026 northeast monsoon has made the earliest onset over the southern peninsular India since 2020, per IMD records. ENS

Assistant prof held for sexual harassment

AN ASSISTANT professor at a university in Jodhpur has been arrested for allegedly sexually harassing female students, police said. The accused was produced in court on Monday and sent to two days' police remand. He had been teaching at a college for over three years on a temporary basis. According to the police, a female student had lodged a complaint alleging that the accused had been subjecting her to obscene behaviour, stalking her and sexually harassing her since January. The student also submitted WhatsApp messages, police said. ENS

Ensure hospitals prominently display treatment charges: Govt to states, UTs

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, October 12

THE UNION Health Ministry has asked all states and Union Territories to ensure that hospitals and clinics prominently display the charges for their services and facilities, in a move aimed at improving transparency in billing.

In a letter to the states and UTs, Union Health Secretary Punya Salila Srivastava urged authorities to review whether healthcare establishments were complying with existing rules and taking steps to ensure their effective implementation. "I would request you to kindly advise the authorities concerned to review compliance with applicable provisions relating to display of rates and take appropriate measures to ensure their effective implementation," Srivastava said in the letter.

The Ministry said displaying charges clearly would help patients and their attendants understand the likely financial implications of treatment, make informed decisions and plan their healthcare expenditure. It could also reduce confusion and disputes over bills, while building greater trust in the healthcare system.

The directive comes amid growing concerns over high hospital bills, including expensive bed charges and large markups on medicines and medical consumables, particularly in the private healthcare sector.

The Centre has urged the 19 states and UTs that have implemented the Clinical Establishments Act to enforce its provisions on displaying treatment charges. The information must be put up in a prominent place, in the local language as well as English. For states and UTs where the Act has not been implemented, including Delhi, the Health Ministry has asked authorities to use their existing regulatory frameworks to ensure that hospitals disclose their charges.

The Ministry has also called for hospitals, wherever applicable, to display the package rates they offer foreign patients visiting India on medical or Ayush visas. This, the letter said, would help international patients compare costs and make informed decisions. It could also reduce complaints related to pricing and billing. The Ministry said the move would further strengthen India's position as a trusted destination for medical and Ayush care.

The government's push for greater transparency comes as activists have questioned the profits made by corporate hospital chains. They have pointed to several factors that they say are contributing to rising treatment costs, including the growing flow of private and foreign capital into healthcare and the consolidation of services under the same corporate group. Such vertical integration can mean that a single company owns a hospital, pharmacies, diagnostic centres or even insurance businesses that pay for patients' treatment.

EXPRESS special

Back with Asiad gold, women hockey captain's SOS: Out of coverage area

Salima Tete's village lacks mobile network connectivity

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, October 12

ON OCTOBER 2, Indian women's hockey captain Salima Tete led the team to a historic Asian Games gold medal, ending the nation's 44-year-long wait for the title.

Eight days later, as she set off for her village in Jharkhand's Simdega district, she sent out a message to several people to let them know she wouldn't be reachable on her mobile phone.

This has been a standard practice for Tete for as long as she can remember because her village, Barki Chhapar, lacks mobile network connectivity.

Tete, whose village falls under the Pithra Gram Panchayat, told *The Indian Express* that the lack of mobile connectivity makes it difficult for her to stay in touch with officials, organisations and others when she is home. "I often have to inform people in advance that my phone will not be reachable," she said.

On Monday, Tete submitted a letter to Simdega Deputy Commissioner Kanchan Singh seeking mobile network connectivity and drinking water facilities in the village.

She lamented that despite the glory she brought to her village, basic necessities still elude it. "Despite being in such a significant position, I have to tell people that in case of an emergency, they should contact other people," Tete said.



Women's hockey captain Salima Tete (right) and activist Augustina Soreng at her home in Jharkhand's Simdega district. EXPRESS

"This is an extremely painful and emotional issue for me. You play on such a big platform, you represent India, and there is not even a mobile network in your village. I definitely feel sad about it," she said.

Tete said she has often missed important emails and messages due to the issue.

Anil Oraon, Mukhiya of Pithra Gram Panchayat, acknowledged that the lack of facilities is a concern. "Tete is from a village that falls under my panchayat. She is bringing glory to our village, our block, our district, our state of Jharkhand and the whole country, but it is a matter of sorrow that her own village lacks facilities. There is a huge network problem here," Oraon told *The Indian Express*.

Oraon said that although a mobile tower stands in his panchayat area, it does not provide coverage up to Barki Chhapar, leaving residents unable to make even basic phone calls or use the internet. "The tower is located outside the village's coverage range. Tete's father Sulakshan has even offered to provide land for the installation of a mobile tower, but no action has been taken on it so far," Oraon said.

Oraon, who also flagged the road condition in the area, said better connectivity would "encourage more children from the area to take up sports".

Augustina Soreng, a tribal community activist who visited Tete's village, said, "Ever since she became the captain (in 2024), Tete has been repeatedly raising this issue with the administration. If we send her a message at night, she is able to see it only the next morning (after moving towards an area which gets some signal)."

Soreng called it an instance of discrimination against the Adivasi community.

Simdega District Sports Officer Manoj Kumar said he was not aware of the specific complaint. "Simdega is a hilly area, and network connectivity is a problem in several places. There is a committee under the chairpersonship of the Deputy Commissioner to look into network-related issues in the district, including those concerning BSNL. We will have to check whether there is a tower near her village and what can be done about the problem," Kumar told *The Indian Express*.

He said he would convey the issue to the officials concerned: "We want the best possible facilities for our players."

On mobile connectivity, Deputy Commissioner Singh said the district administration had taken up the issue with the Central government, which has jurisdiction over BSNL services, multiple times in the past.

"The village is a little outside the mobile network coverage area... We have also raised the issue with the MP of the area during a meeting," she said.

Khunti Member of Parliament Kali Charan Munda could not be contacted for comment.

On drinking water issue, Singh said, "We have taken the matter into consideration and initiated the necessary official procedure."

Simdega MLA Bhushan Bara said he was unaware of the issue. "But now that I have received the information, I will personally look into the matter," said the Congress leader.

Powerful IED blast in PoK village near LoC triggers security alert on Indian side

Express News Service
Jammu, October 12

A POWERFUL blast in a forward village in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir along the Line of Control (LoC) in Poonch district on Monday evening prompted heightened security on the Indian side.

Sources said four PoK residents were killed in the blast, suspected to have been caused by an Improvised Explosive Device (IED), in the Satwal-Naki area in PoK's Hajira tehsil, opposite Krishna Ghati area of Poonch.

The explosion reportedly occurred when some villagers were laying water pipes along the Pakistan side of the LoC, the sources said, identifying the deceased as Faizan Sagheer, Waqas Sharief, Ishtiaq and Asim Rafiq, all residents of Batal Mandhol village in PoK.

There is no clarity on the circumstances leading to the explosion, but it is suspected that the villagers activated the IED while laying water pipes, causing the explosion.

The blast prompted the Indian security forces to sound an alert across the sector and intensify vigilance along the LoC to assess the situation and prevent any possible security breach, officials said.

In a separate development, Indian Army troops on Monday detected two rusted landmines near the border fence in Basoni area of Mendhar sector.

The landmines were spotted during track construction at 8.25 am and 12.10 pm, officials said, adding that both explosive devices were later destroyed by experts in a controlled explosion.

Red, pink, yellow and orange — Kolkata roads adorn new colours in BJP govt's first Puja celebrations

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, October 12

FROM ROADS and intersections to flyovers and bridges – Kolkata is being adorned with colours of all hues and shades this Puja. Patches of black tarred roads now look like slices of rainbow, with red, pink, yellow and orange lanes, while the city's busy crossings have turned into floral motifs.

The new BJP government in West Bengal is busy beautifying the Capital. Cabinet Minister Agnimitra Paul was seen on Sunday making *alpona*, the traditional art of painting the floors and walls with rice flour, at the busy Park Circus Crossing.

"This represents the road of love and brotherhood. This shows the trust people have in us after they brought us to power with a huge mandate," Paul, who is in charge of the Urban Development and Municipal Affairs departments, was heard saying after making the *alpona* at Park Circus Crossing.

The artwork beneath the Park Circus connector is among the prominent elements of the beautification drive, which also covers Gariahat bridge and the Garia More junction.

Paul said similar work had been undertaken at Red Road, while the ghats along the Hooghly were also being decorated ahead of the festival.

"If time permits, we will also decorate the Rashbehari and Park Street crossings," she said.

This is BJP government's first Durga Puja, and it is leaving no stone unturned to make it grand and colourful.

On Mahalaya, which precedes the 10-day-long festival, the government had organised a mega event to mark the advent of Puja at the iconic Eden Gardens stadium.

There were fireworks, laser shows, and cultural performances.



A flyover in Kolkata painted ahead of Durga Puja. EXPRESS

However, the Opposition Congress and the Left Front are not impressed with the government's beautification drive, calling it a waste of taxpayers' money and "misplaced priorities".

"They are doing drama with people's tax money. This has to be stopped," state Congress president Subhankar Sarkar told *The Indian Express*.

"A minister's work is to provide services and make plans for the city's development. This drama will finish the state and the country," he added.

CPI(M) leader Sujan Chakraborty described it as the BJP government's misplaced priority. "Is it being done with BJP's own money or the taxpayers' money? Are they getting funding from elsewhere? If taxpayers' money is being used, it should be for education and employment. That should be the priority. If it isn't, then it is unfortunate," Chakraborty told *The Indian Express*.

Neither Mamata Trinamool Congress MLA Kunal Ghosh nor party spokesperson Pradeepta Mukherjee responded to the calls.

In the previous TMC government, chief minister Mamata Banerjee painted the city blue. All government buildings, flyovers, roadside railings and even taxis were painted light blue. Mamata, in fact, had vowed to transform Kolkata into a London, something her opponents have scoffed at.

'Eat biryani from Hindu shops': Posters ahead of Puja in Siliguri

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, October 12

A MONTH after chief priest of Madhya Pradesh's Bageshwar Dham, Dhirendra Krishna Shastri, kicked up a row in West Bengal by appealing to people to avoid non-vegetarian food near Durga Puja pandals, another row has erupted over posters across Siliguri urging people to buy biryani from Hindu shops.

Hundreds of posters, put up across the town by Hindu Jagran Manch, an RSS-affiliate, bear appeals to eat Biryani or buy Puja items from Hindu shops. '*Biriyani Khete Baron Kora Hocche Na. Biriyani Khan. Kintu Hindu Dokan Theke* (No one is forbidding you from eating Biryani. Eat Biryani but from a Hindu shop), '*Pujar Samagri Hindu Dokan Theke Kinun* (Buy Puja items from Hindu shops), '*Hindu Dokan Theke Mangsho Kinun*' (Buy meat from Hindu shops) are among some of the posters.

Leaders of the organisation defended the move saying that their appeal is aimed at ensuring Hindu traders and shopkeepers benefit during Durga Puja. In some areas, the Hindu outfit has also asked Puja committees to only allow Hindu shops around the pandal.

"We will obviously have non-veg during the Pujas. But we are appealing to eat Biryani from Hindu shops. We have also appealed to buy Puja items from Hindu shops. We are not against any community, but we think that Hindu traders should benefit during the Puja," said Prasanta Sarkar, a leader of the outfit from Siliguri.

"There is a huge economy which runs around the Durga Puja. Why shouldn't Hindus benefit from the Puja? We have also held meetings with some community puja committees in South Bengal, where we have appealed to allow only Hindu shop and stall owners around pandals," said Nilanjan Panda, another leader from Sonarpur.

While the Opposition CPI(M) and TMC hit out, calling the move a direct attack on the secular fabric of the state, the BJP has sought to distance itself from the row.

"There are many sides to this new phenomenon. BJP has come to power in Bengal after a long wait. Whatever is now happening is part of a greater Hindutva agenda running in other parts of the country. Secondly, it is an attempt to grab the Puja economy. Thirdly, when the nation is protesting against EC and BJP, such moves are a bid to shift focus from it. However, in Bengal, which is the land of Lalan Fakir, Chaityanya Mahaprabhu, Swami Vivekanada, people will not accept this," said Abhas Roy Chowdhury, CPIM central committee member.

RSS Pracharak alleges assault in custody in Rajasthan; six cops suspended

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, October 12

SIX POLICE personnel have been suspended in Rajasthan following allegations that an RSS functionary was assaulted in police custody at Narena police station in Jaipur rural.

In his complaint, RSS pracharak Krishna Avtar alleged that he was stripped, assaulted on his private parts and subjected to physical abuse while in police custody. According to the FIR lodged on Sunday, the personnel also allegedly made insulting remarks about Avtar's family and his association with the RSS, telling him that "*Sangh ne desh ko barbaad kar diya hai* (RSS has ruined the country)."

The Jodhpur prant of Vishwa Samvad Kendra, the official media arm of the RSS, described the alleged incident as "extremely shameful". In a post on X, it said the alleged beating and assault of an RSS pracharak "is a resounding slap on the cheek of every volunteer". Avtar is in charge of Sambhar.

"The loyal pracharak of the very same RSS — from whose womb leaders who now sit on chairs have emerged — is lying bloodied and admitted in SMS Hospital," it said.

Asked about the alleged assault, Investigating Officer Anupam Mishra, said probe had just begun, and Avtar's statement was being recorded.

According to the FIR, lodged on a complaint by Anurag Aagiwal, the incident occurred around 9 pm on October 10, when Avtar was allegedly taken to the Narena police station "without reason".

According to the complaint, when Avtar told the personnel that he was a pracharak, they allegedly continued the assault and said: "*Aaj iski pracharaki utar do*".

Following reports of the alleged assault, former BJP MLA Ramlal Sharma and others staged a protest on Sunday, demanding action against the police personnel. Six police personnel, including Narena police station SHO Umrav Singh, have been suspended.

EXPRESS special

China looming, Arunachal hydel project under fresh protest shadow

Security beefed up, stringent law invoked to arrest protesters, as tribal community fears for loss of livelihood, way of life

Jay Mazoomdaar
New Delhi, October 12

NEARLY A month after columns of security personnel moved into the Ugeng-Komkar area of the Siang valley in Arunachal Pradesh, to facilitate surveys and drilling for the prefeasibility report of the proposed 11,200-MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project, protests against it are refusing to die down.

Last week, four protesters were detained under the Arunachal Pradesh Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 2014, triggering a fresh round of demonstrations. People hit the streets in Geku, Upper Siang, demanding the release of the four, with the Youth Wing of the Siang Indigenous Farmers' Forum (SIFF) urging that government consultations on the project be boycotted.

For the indigenous Adi community that is anxious about displacement and livelihoods, as well as the loss of land that they link back to their ancestors, the deployment of heavy security and the arrests have only stoked fears.

In late September, Chief Minister Pema Khandu's visit saw an attack on a local MLA's residence by protesters, who also torched a police vehicle. Fresh clashes erupted on October 4, amid allegations of arson by protesters and excessive force by security personnel.

In a sign that the Centre was watching, on October 8, Union Minister Kiren Rijiju, who belongs to Arunachal, called for dialogue with senior members of the Adi community. "If we sit down and talk, technically, everything will be clear. We have to talk. We have to move forward," he said. However, the impasse has a long history.

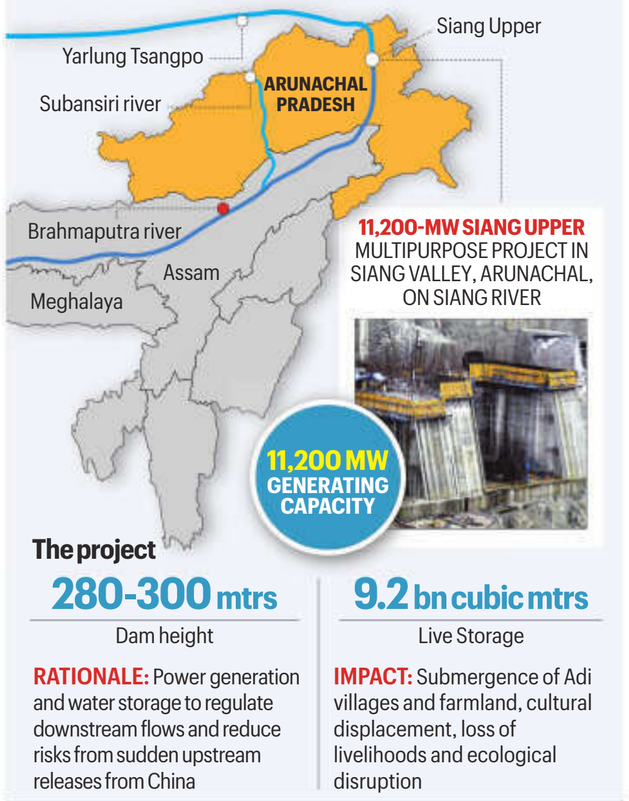
The ferocious Siang barrels through the Himalayas until it approaches the Assam plains, where it becomes the braided Brahmaputra. Its political journey, however, is marked by diversions.

In August 2010, when the Congress was in power in Arunachal, the Itanagar residence of then chairman of the Siang Peoples' Forum and firebrand anti-dam activist Ojing Tasing was raided by police. Following this, Tasing met the then UPA government's Environment Minister Jairam Ramesh in New Delhi, demanding that hydropower projects in the Siang basin be scrapped.

Soon after, the UPA government held a public consultation in Guwahati and Ramesh wrote to then Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, acknowledging that his arguments about the projects' strategic significance had not convinced everyone. "There were some NGOs from Arunachal Pradesh who... said we should not make Arunachal Pradesh a pawn in the race between India and China," he wrote.

Resistance to big dams elsewhere in Arunachal also found a voice in the opposite camp, in Tarun Vijay, former editor of the RSS mouthpiece *Panchajanya* and then a BJP MP. In May 2012, Vijay told the Rajya Sabha: "Government ministers tell me: 'Tarun ji, do not concern yourself with this; perhaps people from China are instigating them.' Is that a responsible thing to say? If people from China are indeed instigating an agitation... the Government has an even greater responsibility to send a Union minister to speak to those people."

Campaigning in Pasighat in February 2014, before he became the Prime Minister, Narendra Modi also acknowledged the local opposition to large dams and spoke of harnessing hydropower through smaller projects while protecting the environment.



The tables turn

In a memorandum submitted this July, Arunachal Congress president Bosiram Siram argued that concerns over China's upstream activities should not override free and informed consent of local tribal communities. In September, Indian Youth Congress national general secretary Tarh Johny described the approach of the BJP government as "dictatorship", calling for transparency and meaningful consultation with the affected people.

Now leading the charge for the Siang Upper project is Chief Minister Khandu. On September 21, he said he had instructed the Chief Secretary to act against government employees opposing the project.

The biggest U-turn is by Tasing, now among Khandu's most vocal lieutenants and Arunachal Rural Development and Panchayati Raj Minister. The activist now says: "If we don't construct our dam, what will be the impact on us if China uses its dam as a water bomb on India?"

Attempts to approach him over his changed position were unsuccessful.

The argument

Underlining the political reversals is a strategic argument that remains consistent: India must develop its downstream water resources as China expands its hydel capacity on the Yarlung Tsangpo, as the Siang is known in upstream Tibet.

Initially, the China factor was not dominant when India proposed to harness the Siang and Subansiri rivers back in 1982. As Chinese plans on Yarlung Tsangpo emerged, New Delhi and Beijing agreed on a mechanism in 2002 for China to provide flood-season hydrological data.

In 2003, India launched a nationwide initiative to develop 50,000 MW of hydropower, with around 27,000 MW envisaged from Arunachal Pradesh, setting off a flurry of agreements with developers in Itanagar.

In 2011, the government told Parliament about a Chinese run-of-the-river project upstream of Siang and stressed the need for Arunachal Pradesh and Assam to harness the Brahmaputra's waters. In 2013, India raised concerns over additional Chinese projects on the Yarlung Tsangpo and asserted its interests as a downstream user.

In 2017, with BJP governments at the Centre and in Arunachal, NITI Aayog proposed replacing the Siang Upper Stage-I and Stage-II projects with a single large storage project. The proposal has since evolved into the 11,200-MW project now at the centre of the protests.

China's plans have also advanced. Beijing approved its 60,000-MW lower Yarlung Tsangpo hydropower project in December 2024. Comprising five cascade hydropower stations, the project seeks to harness the river's steep descent near the Indian border — a drop of nearly 2,000 metres over a 50-km stretch. This has sharpened concerns in India about downstream flows and sudden releases of water, reinforcing the case for storage on the Siang.

But not everybody is convinced. "There is no realistic prospect of establishing the so-called 'first user right' in international jurisprudence. Instead, India should demand project information and possibly assert our right to joint impact assessment to ascertain the risks posed by the dams," says Himanshu Thakkar, coordinator of the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People.

Six states get new Governors, Arlekar goes to Tamil Nadu

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 12

PRESIDENT DROUPADI Murmu on Monday appointed Keralam Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar as the Governor of Tamil Nadu, while Sikkim Governor Om Prakash Mathur will be the new Governor of Keralam.

According to a communique from the Rashtrapati Bhavan, four former parliamentarians will assume the gubernatorial roles — Dushyant Gautam (Sikkim); Braj Mohan Ram (Odisha), Sudha Yadav (Karnataka), and Dhal Singh Bisen (Uttarakhand). These appointments will take effect from the dates they assume charge of their respective offices, it added.

The formal placement of Arlekar in Tamil Nadu replaces a period of dual-charge management and aims to install a steady, experienced hand in a state that has experienced frequent friction between the state government and the gubernatorial office.

Braj Mohan Ram will succeed incumbent Governor Hari Babu Kambhampati in Odisha. Dhal Singh Bisen will succeed Lt Gen Gurmit Singh (retd) as Governor of Uttarakhand. Sudha Yadav will succeed Thaawarchand Gehlot as Governor of Karnataka.


RV Arlekar


OP Mathur


D Gautam


B Mohan Ram


Sudha Yadav


DS Bisen

In March this year, the President effected a major reshuffle of Governors and Lieutenant Governors across several states and Union Territories, including Delhi, Ladakh, Telangana, Maharashtra, Bihar, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Himachal Pradesh, and Nagaland.

17 women from Punjab govt-run coaching centre clear NDA exam

Mohali: As many as 17 cadets of Mai Bhago Armed Forces Preparatory Institute (AFPI), Mohali, have cleared the National Defence Academy (NDA) written examination. The institute has claimed this is the highest-ever tally of women candidates clearing the exam from a government institution in the country, including Sainik Schools and Rashtriya Military Schools.

The successful cadets are Tanvi, Urvi, Simranpreet Kaur, Komalpreet Kaur, Pahuljeet Kaur, Jasmeet Kaur, Muskanpreet Kaur, Garima, Anisha, Pranya Kargwal, Jashandeep Kaur, Samridhi, Arshkiran Kaur, Sehajpreet Kaur, Japneet Kaur, Khushi and Jasleen Kaur. The achievement is significant in a system where women account for 6 per cent of NDA seats, compared with 94 per cent for men.

Congratulating cadets, Punjab Employment Generation, Skill Development and Training Minister Aman Arora said: "I am immensely proud of the 17 cadets of Mai Bhago AFPI. This is not just a victory for the women but a historic moment for Punjab. Clearing an exam in a system where 94% of seats are for boys requires exceptional determination and merit, our daughters demonstrated both." ENS

DAY AFTER STUDENT MOWS DOWN THREE IN KOCHI

Three more persons arrested as victims' families push for harsher punishment

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 12

THE 19-YEAR-old accused in the Keralam Mini Cooper crash that killed three youths was lodged at the state's borstal school after a judicial magistrate court remanded him to 14 days in judicial custody.

Suhail Sajeev, who was driving the Mini Cooper, allegedly after drinking, is accused of ramming a scooter from the rear in the early hours of Sunday near Kochi International Airport, killing all three riders, aged 21.

The victims – Iyas, a native of Sullia in Karnataka, Gopika, of Palakkad, and Devika, of Wayanad – were returning on the scooter after having tea. The three, who were pursuing various courses after graduation, worked part-time at an antique shop in Thrikkakara to earn a living. The crash occurred as they were returning home after the day's work.

After allegedly hitting the scooter and dragging its riders for more than 100 metres, Suhail reportedly told local respondents that his father (bappa) would handle the case.

On Monday, police arrested three other occupants of the Mini Cooper – Ninav, Ameer and Joyal – who had allegedly fled after the accident. They were booked for allegedly abetting Suhail to drive the car under the influence of alcohol. Ninav had been with Suhail since noon, when they allegedly began drinking.

"After the accident, these three persons had escaped. We arrested them from Alappuzha. The probe is going in an exemplary manner. Soon after the accident, we collected evidence. We could prove that the accused had driven the car under the influence of alcohol," said B K Arun, inspector at the Kochi airport police station.

Police claimed Suhail and his friends had visited three bars from noon onwards. After spending time at two bars in Kochi until evening, Suhail allegedly moved to a bar near the airport. "We have collected evidence from the bars, including CCTV visuals. Police claim the car was speeding at the time of the accident, around 1.45 am. "He was heading to the airport to pick someone," Arun said.

Sajeev's mother runs a prominent design studio and brand in Kochi and Alappuzha. In a Facebook post, she had said she was gifting the Mini Cooper to her son for his birthday. That video went viral after the accident on Sunday.

Meanwhile, the families of the deceased demanded that the accused be booked under Section 101 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), which deals with culpable homicide, instead of Section 105, which is generally invoked in cases of death caused by negligence.

Devika's uncle, Sandeep, told the media in Wayanad, "We strongly believe that it was a deliberate act. We are pained to hear that Suhail was sent to borstal school instead of a normal prison. How can a 19-year-old killer be treated in such a manner, rubbing salt into our wounds? Devika was the only hope of her four-member family. She was planning to fly abroad after completing the ongoing aviation course. We want justice from the government."

Prison department officials and police said the decision to send Suhail to the borstal school was taken by the court. The facility houses accused persons aged between 18 and 21. At present, 106 people are lodged at the state's only borstal school in Ernakulam.

Keralam is among the few states that still have borstal schools, while most such institutions have been replaced by homes functioning under the Juvenile Justice Act, 2000.

'Mohan ji became CM due to their votes': Shivraj on razing of tribal homes in MP

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, October 12

UNION AGRICULTURE Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Sunday publicly confronted the Mohan Yadav-led government in Madhya Pradesh over the demolition of tribal families' houses in a village in Sehore district, questioning why people who had voted for the BJP in the Lok Sabha and Assembly elections had been targeted.

The demolition reportedly affected 12 families belonging to the Barela tribal community in Kosmi village of Budhni — Chouhan's former Assembly constituency. Their crops were also damaged, and a well was filled with soil.

According to the Forest Department, it undertook the operation to remove alleged encroachments.

"This is a conspiracy by some officials to malign the party. We win because of their votes, and Mohan ji became chief minister because of their votes. This is truly very painful for me," Chouhan said.


Their dreams crushed, their hard work destroyed, and they have been rendered homeless: Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Chouhan — who represented Budhni for several terms — said that he would inform Yadav about the families' distress, the destruction of their crops, and the demolition's impact on their future.

"I will tell the chief minister about this injustice, their sobs, the tears in their eyes, their crushed fields and their ruined future. This seems to me to be a conspiracy to malign the chief minister as well," he said.

Chouhan described the destruction of the families' homes as the crushing of years of hard work by poor tribal farmers. He said JCB machines demolished their houses, and broken roof tiles lay over the remains of their belongings.

"Their dreams have been crushed, their hard work destroyed, and they have been rendered homeless," he said, accusing Forest Department officials of the "height of oppression and injustice".

He also questioned whether the officials would accept similar treatment of their own children, mothers, and wives.

The incident drew a response from the Congress, with Leader of Opposition in the Madhya Pradesh Assembly Umang Singhar alleging that tribal families were bearing the consequences of friction within the BJP government.

"Mohan Yadav ji, when your own former chief minister is raising questions, you too must clarify when the government will take concrete steps. Is the internal power struggle within the government overshadowing even questions of public interest?" Singhar asked.

Thorny roofs, hired guard & claims of mass killings: A Chhattisgarh village's langur issue

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, October 12

AS HE watches his toddler son play in the courtyard of his house in Devgaon village in Chhattisgarh's Bemetara district, Bhagwat Prasad Jaiswal's eyes keep darting to the thorny, twig-covered roof meant to keep marauding langurs at bay.

It's been raining all day, and save for the lowing of the cows in the cowshed, it's been quiet: no loud clanging from the metal roof, no chattering and squealing, and no assault on kitchen. "For the last 4-5 years, monkeys keep clambering onto our roof. They even broke a wall. We've laid this thorny fence of sorts to try and stop them," he says.

For a decade or so, Devgaon's 600-odd residents have been dealing with what they call a langur menace. As per villagers, hundreds descend on Devgaon on an average day, hanging from rooftops, blocking roads and raiding kitchens and fields.

This week, the problem took another dimension: a viral video from the village showing two dead langurs led to claims that 22 had been shot dead. A Forest Department inquiry is underway against a man whom the village claims to have hired as a "hunter" for 2 kg of rice per month from every household.

Grey langurs are protected under Schedule II of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972. Hunting, capturing or harming them is strictly prohibited and constitutes a criminal offence.

Contradicting claims that 22 langurs were killed, Santosh Sinha says, "How can we do this? Langurs represent Lord Hanuman. We told the guard categorically that he shouldn't use a gun, and if any monkey is harmed, we will discontinue his services."

Even forest officials concede that the langur menace affects 50 villages in Bemetara-Nawagarh block, about 100 km from Raipur. Devgaon residents say the problem has worsened in recent years. "Nothing's safe in the kitchen. One person sits there all day with a stick to guard the food," Sinha says. "The monkeys also know when to enter: they do it after the men have left for farms. They don't fear women. I often get frantic calls from my wife, and I have to rush home to chase them away."

Two months ago, 65-year-old Chaitabai Chandrakar twisted her foot while trying to escape langurs that had entered her house. Her son Suknandan Chandrakar says she has difficulty walking, adding, "We can't put clothes out to dry outside. At night, they jump on the roofs. They also push children."



While many found stop-gap solutions like laying thorny twigs across rooftops, the village decided to hire a 'guard' to patrol the lanes from 8 am-5 pm and drive away langurs — for 2 kg of rice. EXPRESS

Experts say habitat loss is one reason langurs are straying into villages. "Over the past few years, agricultural fields have increased in size, reducing the number of field bunds that traditionally separated plots. As trees along these bunds have been cut, the monkeys have lost their natural habitat. The only effective way is to provide monkeys safe habitats," says Mansoor Khan, a lawyer and member of the Centre's Project Elephant Steering Committee.

While many residents have found stop-gap solutions, like laying thorny twigs across rooftops, the village decided three months ago to hire a "guard" to patrol its lanes and drive away the langurs — the second time in 10 years. Accordingly, Kalam Pardhi, who belongs to a neighbouring village, was hired to patrol from 8 am to 5 pm.

"Our only solution was to keep a guard," sarpanch Sonbai Dhruv says. "No other village of the five villages in our Gram panchayat has kept a guard, but we've been facing the problem for some time and something had to be done."

Then came the video — and claims that 22 langurs had been killed in the village. In the video, villager Jagdish Manikpuri is seen standing in an open ground and gesturing to two langurs lying lifeless beside him. "For 2 kg of rice, a hunter has been hired, but he should have the sense not to kill a mute animal. Look here, innocent animals have been shot dead. Who gave you the right? Your job was to chase them away. These 22 monkeys have been killed. If I am wrong, hang me; if he (the hunter) is wrong, hang him. No one has the right to take a life."

Manikpuri tells *The Indian Express* that he was "informed" of the deaths of two langurs and went to the spot. "I saw the (guard) with his gun. I also saw two dead monkeys, and informed the Forest Department." On his claim that 22 langurs had been killed, he admits he has "no evidence to back this up", but he has "seen monkeys being shot in the last few months and their bodies floating in the river".

While other residents deny the allegations outright, Jaiswal says he can't be sure that "1-2 langurs did not die while they were being scared away".

Forest officials said Pardhi's firearm had been seized and the two carcasses sent for post-mortem examinations. They also acknowledged receiving frequent complaints from villagers about langurs. "Usually, when we get a complaint, we reach the spot, capture the monkeys and release them in the forest... Also, several villagers keep guards but don't seek our permission for this, nor do they inform us," an official says.

"This has been going on for 10 years. Who do we go to for a solution? No one pays us attention," says one Daulal Jaiswal.

WEB EXCLUSIVE
Countering Houthis should not require turning Mecca's sanctity into a political cause — *Bhopinder Singh*
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WORDLY WISE
When tillage begins, other arts follow.
—Daniel Webster

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INVOLVES US ALL

Unregulated use of GM: A cautionary tale

A QUARTER or more of India's cultivated area under cotton comprises genetically modified (GM) hybrids incorporating "unapproved" herbicide-tolerant (HT) and *Bacillus thuringiensis* (Bt) traits, according to a seed industry-commissioned study. This isn't surprising. Cotton farmers today face problems of labour scarcity for manual weeding and pink bollworm insect attacks. They would be inclined to plant hybrids that enable them to spray chemical herbicides and provide protection against a broader spectrum of bollworms and sucking pests. The existing "approved" GM Bt hybrids do not contain genes conferring tolerance to weed killers such as glyphosate or control against pink bollworm. The study shows the presence of unapproved HT and next-generation Bt genes in over half of the seed/leaf samples collected from farmers' fields across 16 districts of Maharashtra, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan.

The study's findings are a clear demonstration of farmer acceptance of HT technology. For cotton growers, this isn't about ideology. Manual weeding costs, even when labour is available, come to Rs 12,000-15,000 per acre now, whereas it is only Rs 750-850 for 2-3 rounds of glyphosate application. The same goes for hybrids harbouring the Vip3A Bt gene. While derived from the same soil bacterium as the Cry1Ac and Cry2Ab genes present in the "approved" Bt hybrids, it has a different mode of action that is effective even against the pink bollworm. Neither the glyphosate tolerance nor the Vip3A Bt gene traits have, however, been officially authorised for insertion into cotton plants for commercial cultivation. Farmers are, then, growing their hybrids via sourcing of seeds from illegal channels. That includes traders and breeders who have undertaken introgression of the traits, bypassing the government's biosafety and regulatory approval system.

The loser is not just the organised seed industry. Sales of "legal" Bt cotton hybrid seeds have fallen from 59.6 million to 46.3 million packets between 2022-23 and 2025-26. This, even as the unauthorised HT-Bt seed market has grown to an estimated 8.2-8.8 million packets. A bigger loser is the farmer, who is being denied the benefits of deployment of the advanced GM traits in the hybrids of genuine research-backed seed companies, as opposed to fly-by-night operators. The blame for this — widespread farmer demand-led, yet unregulated adoption of advanced GM technology — lies solely with the government. By blocking commercialisation and field trials of GM crops, based more on ideological positions than empirical regulatory science, it has turned India from a leading producer and exporter to a net importer of cotton.

Starlink's promises and risks call for a fine balance

LAST WEEK, in a social media post, Elon Musk blamed "certain oligarchs" for blocking the entry of Starlink in India. While the process of regulatory approvals and clearances in satellite communications appears to have moved slowly, the allegation does not hold up. "Security assessment as part of this process is currently underway in respect of all the three licensees," the Union government has said, and currently all three entities, Starlink, Jio Satellite Communications, and Eutelsat OneWeb, "are at broadly the same regulatory stage". Moreover, last year Starlink had entered into agreements with telecom majors Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel in order to offer its internet services in the country, both of whom have themselves been at odds on the issue of spectrum.

There are compelling security issues on satellite communications that need to be assessed carefully. Legitimate concerns over the enforcement of local laws and rules need to be addressed. It is not difficult to imagine scenarios where connectivity can be possibly restricted or denied when required, or allowed when the situation warrants differently. What played out in Ukraine is instructive. During the Russia-Ukraine conflict, Ukraine came to rely on Starlink for communication. There are reports, however, of alleged interference in Starlink's services in the region during the conflict.

There are significant gains to be made from the deployment of satellite internet, especially in far flung areas across the country that have poor connectivity. But there are also issues of affordability, which is perhaps why Musk, in a social media post, has said, "obviously, if Starlink is too expensive in India, no one will buy it, so SpaceX will need to make pricing affordable". For widespread adoption, pricing for equipment and monthly fees will need to be in line with the country's average broadband revenue per user. As India moves ahead, it must be mindful of the risks, strike a balance between safeguarding national interests and ensuring a transparent regulatory process, while enabling technological innovation and spurring competition.

How to keep economy on even keel

ROBERT E Hall of Stanford University and Michael Woodford of Columbia University have shared this year's Nobel Prize in Economics for "microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation". Stabilisation, here, refers to policy measures by governments and central banks to reduce fluctuations in an economy. A government's decision to provide a tax break or a central bank choosing to raise or cut interest rates are common examples of such decisions. The contribution of Hall and Woodford is to provide a better understanding of how and when to take decisions for ensuring that an economy does not swing between prolonged periods of slow or stagnant growth and high and persistent inflation.

At the heart of their work is the idea provided by John Maynard Keynes: That governments can intervene and help reduce fluctuations in an economy. Keynes's insight helped economies learn from the Great Depression. For a while, his recipe seemed to work quite well: Whenever an economy started to slow down, policymakers intervened by cutting taxes and interest rates to boost growth, and when an economy experienced high inflation, interest rates were cut. But the repeated oil price shocks during the 1970s saw many economies, especially the US, witness high unemployment and high inflation both at once. The Keynes remedy failed to provide a solution and, in fact, many started seeing government intervention as the problem, not the solution.

Hall and Woodford's work has demonstrated "how economic models could be reconstructed to revitalise stabilisation policy". They studied how individuals made their consumption decisions (Hall) and how businesses fixed prices (Woodford) — covering the demand and supply sides of the puzzle — to provide a more robust understanding. This has helped governments across the world avoid mistakes of the past.

The internet in a sachet — this idea's time has come



R S SHARMA

INDIA HAS done what no other country has: Made digital payments free, instant, and universal, and leads the world in mobile-data use. Yet, in one adjacent field we remain a laggard. Public Wi-Fi — the cheap, shared, last-mile connectivity that lets a citizen buy a little internet wherever she is — has barely taken root. India has around 4 lakh public hotspots. France, with a population a fraction of ours, has more than 13 million; the world has over 600 million. For a nation that prides itself on its digital public infrastructure, this is a gap worth explaining — and closing.

The idea was born in April 2016, in an email from Nandan Nilekani. Any consumer, he wrote, should be able to walk up to any Wi-Fi hotspot and connect with a single click — "like an Uber for hotspots" — and anyone with a spare connection could sell a little of it to a passer-by. At TRAI, we built exactly that: An open, interoperable architecture with no central gatekeeper, in which anyone could set up or aggregate a hotspot, and a single app would discover the nearest one, verify the user, take his few rupees through any wallet, and connect him seamlessly across every provider.

We called the retail outlet a Public Data Office, or PDO, and the analogy we kept returning to was the humble PCO — the public call office that put a telephone within walking distance of nearly every Indian by turning a shopkeeper into its keeper. The PDO was the PCO reborn for the internet: The corner shop or tea stall selling connectivity by the sachet, a rupee's worth at a time. That is why I have always thought of it as the internet in a sachet — for the genius of the Indian market is that the poor do not buy the bottle; they buy the sachet.

TRAI issued a consultation paper in July 2016, submitted formal recommendations in March 2017, and piloted the idea with eight entities running some six hundred hotspots. The pilot worked: One-time registration, interoperability, easy payment — all proven. The Prime Minister himself was shown the system in June 2018 and was greatly taken with it; he wanted it launched within weeks. Yet it was not until December 2020 that the framework was finally approved by the Union cabinet, as PM-WANI — the Prime Minister's Wi-Fi Access Network Interface.

Five years on, the promise remains largely unfulfilled. Why? The single biggest reason is the cost of backhaul: A small PDO is made to pay more for the very same fibre broadband that a household buys cheaply, which destroys the shopkeeper's economics before he has sold a single sachet. Add to this a persistent official tenderness towards incumbent telecom operators, never enthusiastic about a million small competitors selling connectivity outside their control.

The commonest objection now is that mobile data is so cheap that nobody needs Wi-Fi by the sachet. It is plausible, and wrong. Data now comes bundled in fixed monthly plans priced from a couple of hundred rupees, which the poorest cannot always afford, and which are of little help to a student joining an online class when the family's one data plan is on someone else's phone. The sachet has not become unnecessary; it has merely been abolished by the operators' tariff design, even as demand has exploded — online education, telemedicine, government services — precisely where mobile signal serves worst.

> What it requires is resolve — the government's willingness to back a consumer-first, open network against the pull of powerful incumbents

There is a strategic case too. Public Wi-Fi runs on unlicensed spectrum, sparing congested mobile networks the costly spectrum they buy at auction. Leaving a billion-plus people's connectivity entirely to two or three mobile companies, besides, is a dangerous dependence on a duopoly. A dense, open, independent Wi-Fi layer is a strategic de-risking of the nation's digital life — an alternative no single commercial interest can switch off.

What makes the delay especially galling is that the missing piece is already lying in the ground. BharatNet, begun in 2011 to carry optical fibre to every one of India's 2.5 lakh gram panchayats, has absorbed more than Rs 48,000 crore — more than five times what Aadhaar cost — and reached over 2 lakh of them. Yet it returns almost nothing, for a great trunk of bandwidth with no retail distribution is a pipe with no taps. Even a fully monetised BharatNet will leave gaps in hilly, forested terrain fibre may never reach — and that is where Starlink and the other satellite-broadband entrants see a market; Reliance Jio, too, could plausibly carry backhaul, subject to regulatory clearances still being worked through.

The two failures are each other's cure. BharatNet is a big pipe without a last mile; PM-WANI is a last mile starving for a cheap, big pipe. Converge them — let BharatNet act as a common carrier, selling bandwidth on fair, transparent terms to the small PDOs and aggregators, much as a power-transmission company carries electricity to its distributors — and you have, at a stroke, cheap rural broadband, a real alternative to the duopoly, and at last a use for the taxpayer's fibre. It needs two things the state has withheld: A capped, transparent wholesale price, and enforceable service guarantees. TRAI's June 2025 tariff order, capping what a PDO is charged for retail fibre, is a welcome first step that must be followed through.

None of this requires new invention: The architecture was sound from the first, the fibre is in the ground, and the need has only grown. What it requires is resolve — the government's willingness to back a consumer-first, open network against the pull of powerful incumbents. The day a student in a small town, or a labourer far from home, buys a few rupees of the internet from the shop on the corner and thinks nothing of it will have been worth the wait. It is time to bring the internet in a sachet to every Indian.

The writer is a former chairman of TRAI and former secretary, Government of India. Views are personal

Police must protect individual rights, not political interests



YASHOVARDHAN JHA AZAD

DELHI WITNESSED an extraordinary mobilisation of state power on October 10 to prevent a public mobilisation. Over 7,000 people reportedly detained, more than 250 railway services cancelled and closure of 45 Metro stations: These were measures one might associate with a grave public-order emergency. Numbers alone cannot determine risk, but what specific threat justified restrictions affecting the entire Capital? The spectacle handed the Cockroach Janta Party a publicity victory. The state prevented a gathering but magnified its message.

A useful comparison comes from London. In November 2023, Metropolitan Police Commissioner Sir Mark Rowley resisted political pressure to prohibit a pro-Palestinian march on Armistice Day. He explained that the intelligence did not meet the threshold under Section 13 of the Public Order Act, 1986: Serious public disorder that could not be prevented through lesser measures. The principle was straightforward: Political displeasure cannot substitute for a professional assessment.

Why could Delhi not adopt that approach? A police commissioner brings decades of experience in handling demonstrations. Without disclosure of reasons, sweeping restrictions invite the suspicion that professional judgement has yielded to political wishes conveyed by a compliant bureaucracy.

The police repeatedly become the target of public anger over grievances directed at governments and institutions. Their first responsibility should, therefore, be to open channels of dialogue, assess risks and negotiate workable arrangements. A designated site, limited hours, agreed attendance, volunteer marshals and clear conditions against violence or damage could have provided a practical framework. It would also have placed responsibility on organisers to honour their commitments. Body cameras, videography and liaison officers could document misconduct by protesters and police alike. Identifiable offenders could then face targeted action.

The explanation that the application arrived only three days before the protest is insufficient by itself. Police deployed tens of thousands of personnel. If such extensive preparations were possible, why was a negotiated demonstration impossible?

Protests in India are an age-old tradition. Jumping over barricades, marching in human chains or lying on the ground to resist arrest should not be condemned but celebrated as the ritual dance of democracy. Stone-pelting, assault and destruction are different: They demand lawful action. Professional policing must distinguish between the two. Its public face should be that of a facilitator protecting rights while enforcing reasonable limits, and not the face of the ruling party.

Unfortunately, political parties discover police accountability when they are in the Opposition. Few press for implementation of the Supreme Court's police-reform directions or for institutions that protect professional decision-making.

A credible State Security Commission would help establish policy, evaluate performance and curb unwarranted interference. Operational autonomy must come with accountability in the form of recorded reasons, independent scrutiny of excessive force and transparent review of restrictions.

Training matters equally. Negotiation, de-escalation, behavioural skills and proportionate use of force cannot be improvised at a barricade. Constant deployment leaves too little time to develop these capabilities.

The Home Ministry's bureaucratic layer also deserves scrutiny. Its task should be to support professional policing, test the necessity of extraordinary restrictions and advise ministers candidly. When it merely transmits political messages, it adds hierarchy without adding judgement. There is a strong case for an experienced internal-security professional as home secretary, capable of articulating operational realities and constitutional obligations to the executive.

October 10 has again shifted attention from the original grievance to police conduct. That is an avoidable failure. But ultimately the ruling establishment will have to take a call on the cost of allowing a Chief Election Commissioner to continue against continuing opposition and a massive deployment of state resources. The government must explain why restrictions of this scale were necessary and consider whether dialogue would have served the public better.

Another protest lurks around the corner. Hopefully the lesson is learnt that a capital kept quiet by closing all its gates is no proof of a democracy kept secure.

Azad, a retired IPS officer, is the author of Policing The Republic *and has served as special director, Intelligence Bureau*

> Negotiation, de-escalation, behavioural skills and proportionate use of force cannot be improvised at a barricade

India's science problem is not talent, but priorities



KAMINI WALIA

EVERY OCTOBER, the Nobel announcements trigger a familiar conversation in India: Why does India, with its enormous pool of scientific talent, rarely feature among them? Perhaps the more useful question is: What are the countries that produce transformative science doing differently and what holds our scientists back?

The answer is not simply money, though money matters. The US spends about 3.4 per cent of GDP on research and development, Germany over 3 per cent, Japan more than 3.5 per cent and South Korea over 5 per cent. China is approaching 2.7 per cent. India's gross expenditure on R&D is only about 0.64 per cent.

But the more revealing statistic is who funds research. In India, business contributes around 40 per cent of R&D expenditure, compared with roughly three-quarters in the US and China. Our research ecosystem therefore has both a scale and a private-sector participation gap. There is also increasing pressure on scientists to "develop technologies", "build products", "commercialise research" and "deliver solutions". These are legitimate national priorities but technology cannot be produced on demand. We are emphasising the last few stages while underinvesting in the first.

A diagnostic platform, for example, may require years of work on disease biology, pathogen behaviour, host response, biomarkers and molecular mechanisms before a product becomes possible. Basic science is the landscape from which innovation emerges. This is where India needs a rethink. First, government and research agencies should create a protected basic-science funding window. A defined proportion of competitive funding should support investigator-driven, curiosity-led research, without requiring every project to promise a patent, product or technology. Second, research funding should be explicitly divided into discovery, translation and deployment portfolios, with different timelines and success metrics. Third, India needs long-duration funding, with rigorous scientific review but considerably less administrative micromanagement. Fourth, we need a national shared research infrastructure. Genomics, proteomics, advanced imaging, biobanks, structural biology, AI and computational platforms should be accessible across institutions.

Finally, we must change how we see research and evaluate scientists. Publication counts, journal impact factors, patents and grant utilisation are convenient metrics, but they do not necessarily measure discovery. Scientific assessment should reward originality, reproducibility, important questions, new knowledge, datasets, platforms, technologies and influence on science or health policy. This means building the pipeline properly.

China offers an instructive example. As its overall R&D investment has grown, it has become a major global supplier of affordable technology. China produced around 80 per cent of the world's solar PV modules and battery cells in 2024, while its share of global electric-car production reached about 70 per cent in 2025. The lesson is to recognise the importance of connecting discovery to engineering, manufacturing and markets.

India has an extraordinary natural advantage. Our population provides a vast and diverse setting for research. The ambition should therefore be to create an ecosystem which attracts young scientists who can pursue an unconventional question for 10 or 15 years, fail, change direction and try again without being penalised for not producing an immediate product. If India wants the technologies of tomorrow, it must fund the science of today. The Nobel Prize should not be the target. Building a research system capable of producing Nobel-level discoveries should be.

> Basic science is the landscape from which innovation emerges. This is where India needs a rethink

The writer is senior scientist and programme officer, AMR, ICMR

40 YEARS AGO

October 13, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS

Big-Two summit ends without any accord

11 killed in Lanka clash

Big Two summit ends

US SECRETARY of State George Shultz said the two-day US-Soviet talks in Iceland had ended with no new agreement on arms control and no date had been set for a new formal summit. Speaking at a news conference, he said the mini-summit had stalled over the issue of Reagan's "Star Wars" space defence programme.

11 killed in Sri Lanka

EIGHT TAMIL militants and three security men were killed in a battle in Sri Lanka's northwestern Mannar district, a military spokesman said. He told Reuters the fighting started when a foot patrol was ambushed and two soldiers were killed and four others wounded. Reinforcements arrived to help the patrol and eight of the militants were killed.

San Salvador death toll

AT LEAST 1,800 people are believed to have been killed in six large buildings that collapsed in San Salvador in the earthquake, a rescue chief said. "There are six large buildings which collapsed and reckoning an average of 300 people in each of them, that makes 1800 dead, not including casualties in other parts of the city," Mano Rodolfo Lopez, leader of a Guatemalan team of rescue workers, said.

Major cabinet shake-up looms

A MAJOR shake-up in the administration, including changes in the cabinet, is expected after the return of the Prime Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, from his visit to Australia and three other countries. Gandhi has decided not to accept any foreign visits for the next six months and give greater attention to pressing problems at home.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

In a world turned upside down, Mr Trump blames Volodymyr Zelenskyy for failing to cut a peace deal. — *The Guardian*

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Crackdown on Jantar Mantar 2.0, amid other closures, calls for redemocratisation



SUHAS PALSHIKAR

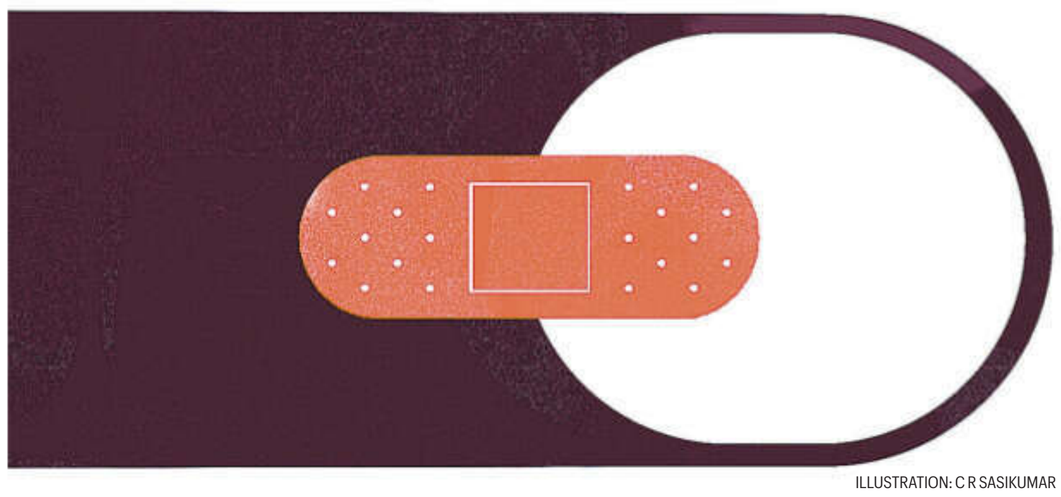


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

DELHI CONTINUES to be the battleground between protestors and the police. The government seems determined that there cannot be a Jantar Mantar 2.0. That has produced a closure — literally. But let us not forget where it all began. After months of persistent complaints over the exclusionary character of the SIR, the opposition parties, and now the CJP, are demanding the removal of the Chief Election Commissioner. This demand follows the insensitive response to complaints about the SIR and an equally unresponsive Supreme Court judgment on the issue. The judiciary and the ECI have, thus, produced a key closure over the issue of disenfranchisement. More closures stare us in the face.

Election outcomes become suspect; parties lose and elected representatives of the party are easily exported elsewhere. A closure. Maharashtra has witnessed that a party gets split and the party symbol easily goes to the breakaway faction. A closure. You challenge a law about the appointment of Election Commissioners and that faces many a curious closure.

If you are a woman protester or a woman journalist, you will be physically abused in public. Closure. You may be an MP; you will still be manhandled. You may be the leader of the Opposition; you will be denied permission to protest. You may be a group of opposition MPs — the President may give you an audience — the CEC will shoo you away. Closure.

It is in the backdrop of this barricading of practically all opposing views, ideas and actions that the closure at Jantar Mantar 2.0 has been unfolding. What has happened over the last weekend, therefore, symbolically represents the nature of the politics India is experiencing today. No space for opposing voices, no remedy for disenfranchisement, no permission to express independent views.

Isn't this a serious and clear instance of non-democracy, a case of authoritarianism, an example of miscarriage of the electoral process and an abuse of state power? Terms like electoral autocracy or competitive authoritarianism are employed to capture the moment. Both these terms assume an element of competition and a possible electoral majority. But when protests are banned, popular mobilisations are made impossible, voters are removed from electoral rolls, reported instances of *mala fide* applications for voter deletions go unpunished and unchecked — all accompanied by repeated judicial abdication, complicit civil services and a compliant media — the vestige of competition vanishes.

Systemic suppression drowns the democratic urge, diminishes people's easy access to democracy and generally disincentivises fair competition. This is where the strength of closures matters. But it is doubtful whether such suppression actually destroys citizens' urge for a free political order. That is where the limits of closures may get exposed.

> Systemic suppression drowns the democratic urge, diminishes people's access to democracy and disincentivises fair competition. This is where the strength of closures matters

As more and more closures are introduced by the regime, India finds itself at the crossroads — public opinion caving in to the closures or the public craving for fresh political air. The farmers' agitation, the quiet electoral setback of 2024, and the more recent explosion of youth energy in the Jantar Mantar protests have exemplified this tug of war between the regime-imposed closures and the more-than-a-century-old habit of being a democracy.

The modern state and modern authoritarian regimes keep finding new weapons for stabilising the closures and turning them into citizen habits. A lifestyle of a docile, obedient but conveniently aroused "national citizen" is continuously injected through the loud political discourse of artificial divisions and false unity; of imagined enemies and mythical glory. The system-imposed closures and the politics-imposed rhetoric of the obedient citizen pose a peculiar challenge for pro-democracy forces in India. While the formal frameworks of competition (elections) and institutional remedies (approaching the judiciary) will continue to be explored, moments of acute closures may also produce moments of re-democratisation.

The former — within-system push-backs — refer to democratic resilience while the latter is an unexplored territory left to the creativity of political actors. This creativity is not merely a matter of catchy slogans and flashy wars on social media. Jantar Mantar in July was an important rupture in the midst of closures because it tapped the energies born out of frustration. A few years before that, the Bharat Jodo Yatra was an early rupture because it sought to go beyond electoral appeals. These two moments, different in their composition and drivers, have had one thing in common — they sought to bypass the closures and yet irritate the architects of those closures.

Two factors constitute the glorious moment of modern India's democratisation: The long and tortuous awakening over questions of rights (originally argued by Jyotirao Phule in late 19th century) and the institutionalisation of elections and the politics of hope (through the Constitution). If today's closures push us toward re-democratisation, we can borrow from India's first moment of democratisation.

Various dimensions of that early democratisation, such as the combination of individual dignity and equality, the determination to annihilate caste, the formal establishment of political equality and the innate hope of fraternity — all need to be re-energised. At the same time, more urgent and more contemporary concerns about social harmony and better livelihoods will need to be integrated into the project of re-democratisation. For the moment, the two central themes in this project are bound to be citizen inclusion and citizen assertion — both of which speak about the culture of democracy vis-à-vis today's unresponsive institutions.

But even as this project remains hazy today, it must handle a central paradox: Jantar Mantar has created great hopes from civil society actors, but modern authoritarian regimes depend on election victories and once they lose, their institutional collaborators are only too willing to cower. Therefore, it will be critical for re-democratisation that the mainstream opposition manifests the imagination to conceptualise re-democratisation and the maturity to work together. Today's closures, thus, throw up a challenge: Is India willing to explore the path of re-democratisation?

The writer, based in Pune, taught political science

A decade of placing research and innovation at the centre



ABHAY KARANDIKAR

ON JANUARY 3, 2019, at the Indian Science Congress, Prime Minister Narendra Modi gave the call for "*Jai jawan, Jai kisan, jai vigyan, jai anusandhan*". With these words, he articulated a vision placing research and innovation as the primary agenda for economic growth, strategic security, industrial development, entrepreneurship, and citizen-centric service delivery.

The facts and figures since 2014 reflect the breadth of this transformation. India rose from 81st in the Global Innovation Index in 2015 to 38th in 2025. It ranks third globally in the volume of scientific and engineering publications. The Gross Expenditure on Research and Development (GERD) has more than tripled from Rs 79,355.89 crore in 2013-14 to Rs 2,44,767.81 crore in 2023-24, reaching about 0.84 per cent of GDP. The private sector's share of GERD increased from 32.2 to 45.2 per cent over this period.

During the last decade, a total transformation of the institutional architecture of India's research base has been initiated. The Anusandhan National Research Foundation funds new research across universities, colleges and R&D labs while encouraging collaboration amongst academia, industry and government.

The Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund, on the other hand, addresses a more difficult problem — the "valley of death", where technologies need pilot-scale demonstration and productisation just as risk and capital requirements rise sharply. The Rs 1 lakh crore RDI Fund represents a significant step towards addressing this financing gap and providing the patient, risk-tolerant capital that cutting-edge innovation requires.

In his 2023 Independence Day address, PM Modi recalled that when asked during a foreign visit whether Indian girls pursued science and engineering, he responded: "Today in my country more daughters than boys are taking up STEM." Initiatives such as Women in Science and Engineering (WISE)–KIRAN, Gender Advancement for Transforming Institutions (GATI) and Vigyan Jyoti have sought to create greater opportunities for women across the scientific and technological ecosystem.

Another pivotal step has been the transition towards building mission-mode capabilities around specific sectoral priorities for the country. The National Quantum Mission spans the full quantum stack, ranging from computing and communication to sensing, metrology, materials and devices, and supports research groups and start-up spin-offs. The IndiaAI Mission applies the same ecosystem logic to artificial intelligence, covering compute, datasets, skilling, foundational models and responsible AI. The Indian Semiconductor Mission has approved 10 projects across six states, including two fabs and eight packaging units, with Semicon 2.0 now pushing further into equipment and materials, indigenous IP, industry-led R&D and talent development.

Biotechnology is following a similar trajectory. The BioE3 Policy provides a broad foundation spanning bio-based chemicals and enzymes to precision biotherapeutics and space biotech. The bio-economy grew from about $10 billion in 2014 to roughly $195.3 billion in 2025 and is projected to reach $300 billion by 2030. The Deep Ocean Mission and Mission Mausam extend the integrated-ecosystem approach into resource and climate security.

The Indian Space Policy, 2023 and the establishment of IN-SPACe have opened the space sector to private participation across launch services, satellite manufacturing and downstream applications, with more than 400 space start-ups now operating in the ecosystem. Nuclear energy has also seen an opening, with the SHANTI Act providing a legal framework for private participation, subject to licensing, safety and regulatory requirements.

India's digital public infrastructure has been built over the decade around the JAM trinity of Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar, and mobile connectivity, and expanded through UPI, DigiLocker, Account Aggregator, and the Ayushman Bharat Digital Health Mission. In agriculture, satellites, drones, remote sensing, GIS, and AI are increasingly used to monitor crops, enable precision farming, estimate yields, and provide farmer advisories.

India's start-up ecosystem has also expanded rapidly during the last few years. Startup India, launched in 2016, put entrepreneurship at the core of the national development agenda. India is now the world's third-largest start-up ecosystem, with more than 2 lakh registered start-ups and over 130 unicorns. A wide range of schemes, such as the Seed Fund, Fund of Funds, Credit Guarantee Scheme, Atal Innovation Mission, NIDHI, BioNEST, iDEX, etc. launched since 2016 have strengthened access to incubation, mentoring, finance and markets. Under Modi 3.0, the focus has now sharpened towards emerging technologies.

As PM Modi stated, "The arms of science, technology and innovation must reach the poorest, the remotest and the most vulnerable person." The vision of science serving society lays a stronger foundation for India's aspirations, and as India moves towards Viksit Bharat 2047, the spirit of "*Jai vigyan, jai anusandhan*" captures this continuing commitment to scientific progress and innovation.

The writer is member, NITI Aayog and former secretary, Department of Science & Technology, Government of India

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Delhi lockdown

THE ELECTION Commission's credibility depends on public confidence, not merely on its legal authority ('Barricades, detentions do not fortify the ECI', *IE*, October 12). While maintaining law and order during protests is necessary, excessive restrictions and preventive detentions can create doubts about institutional neutrality. The ECI must be open to legitimate criticism and address genuine grievances transparently. Equally, protesters should act responsibly and avoid disrupting public life.

A Myilsami, Coimbatore

Arm-twisting

THE SUSPENSION OF Indian tech firms from the PERM programme reveals calculated economic arm-twisting ('US IT salvo opens new front for India', *IE*, October 12). Coupled with tariff threats over Russian crude purchases, Washington is blatantly leveraging vulnerabilities to extract trade concessions. Throttling skilled mobility imperils a $221-billion commercial engine and corrodes goodwill. India cannot treat these actions as routine regulatory shifts or compromise sovereignty under coercion. Policymakers must contest arbitrary visa barriers at multilateral forums, link talent mobility to Indo-Pacific pacts, and accelerate service diversification.

Ishita Vaghela, Jharsuguda

Wars and elections

MILITARY ACTION may temporarily rally public support, but it cannot guarantee electoral success or lasting peace ('America, Israel & an unsettled question: Can war win elections?', *IE*, October 12). Voters ultimately judge governments by economic security, public welfare and responsible leadership. Wars also impose heavy financial costs and cause immense civilian suffering. Democratic leaders must explain the objectives, likely consequences and exit strategy before committing their countries to prolonged conflicts. Diplomacy should take precedence over treating military strength as an electoral instrument.

Pon Arunkumar, Namakkal

On women's safety, move from reaction to prevention



MAYANK MAKHIJA AND NAMAN SHARMA

THE 2012 Delhi gang-rape case was supposed to redefine women's safety in India. It led to unprecedented protests, sweeping legal reforms and the constitution of the Justice J S Verma Committee, which produced one of the most significant reports on criminal justice in independent India. Many of its recommendations were implemented through the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013. New offences such as stalking and voyeurism were introduced, the definition of rape was expanded and punishments became more stringent. Yet the Committee had cautioned that legal reform without institutional reform would remain incomplete.

Recent incidents in Delhi prove the warning was justified. A 17-year-old girl was allegedly gang-raped inside a sleeper bus that travelled nearly 47 km before she was abandoned. Days later, a 16-year-old girl was allegedly raped at knifepoint in a Delhi park by three men posing as police officers. Both incidents exposed grave failures in the safety of public spaces. The problem persists beyond individual offenders. Roads, parks, buses, metro stations, subways and footbridges cannot be permitted to become dangerous spaces due to preventable administrative failures. The debate is no longer confined to punishment; it is about the state's duty to make public spaces safe.

> The problem persists beyond individual offenders. Roads, parks, buses, metro stations, subways and footbridges cannot be permitted to become dangerous spaces because of preventable administrative failures

Modern criminology offers a useful explanation through routine activity theory. A crime becomes more likely when three conditions exist simultaneously: A motivated offender, a vulnerable target and the absence of effective guardianship. Poorly illuminated parks, non-functional CCTV cameras, unverified buses and inadequate police patrols reduce that guardianship. They do not create criminals, but they create opportunities for crime. According to the NCRB 2024, Delhi registered 1,058 rape cases with a rape rate of 14 per lakh women. More disturbing is the fact that these are only the reported cases; the countless crimes buried under fear, stigma and silence never find a place in official statistics. Media reports also indicate that at least 13 cases of sexual assault were reported in Delhi during September alone. The Supreme Court's decision to take *suo motu* cognisance reflects the seriousness of the institutional breakdown.

Why do severe punishments not prevent these crimes? The answer lies in the classical theory of penology developed by Cesare Beccaria. Beccaria argued that the certainty of punishment, rather than its severity, is the real deterrent. India today has stringent rape laws, including life imprisonment and capital punishment in specified circumstances. Yet offenders often believe they can evade immediate detection because surveillance is weak, policing is inadequate and investigations are delayed. A harsh law that is rarely enforced is a weaker deterrent than a moderate law that is enforced with certainty.

The conversation on women's safety must now move from reaction to prevention. First, every identified vulnerable public space in Delhi should undergo an independent safety audit covering lighting, CCTV functionality, emergency response systems and police visibility. Second, all commercial buses must have compulsory GPS tracking and live surveillance linked to transport authorities. Third, departmental accountability should accompany criminal prosecution whenever serious offences expose failures in surveillance, licensing or patrolling.

The Justice J S Verma Committee had identified "failure of governance" as the root cause of sexual crime. It recommended the creation of Rape Crisis Cells in every district, which would be immediately notified upon registration of an FIR and provide survivors with integrated legal aid, trauma counselling and psychological support from the first stage of investigation. While the government introduced One Stop Centres (Sakhi) in 2015, the Committee's vision of an automatic, police-linked rape crisis response has never been fully implemented.

Women should not have to calculate which road is safer, which park is brighter or whether a public bus can be trusted. The burden of safety cannot continue to rest on the victim's precautions instead of the state's preparedness.

Makhija is a Supreme Court lawyer and former special public prosecutor for the ED. Sharma is a final-year student at Maharashtra National Law University, Nagpur

How India should respond to green card crackdown



ARYA ROY BARDHAN

INDIAN IT'S retreat from visa-dependent delivery predates the White House's latest IT salvo. New H-1B approvals for TCS, Infosys, Wipro, HCL and Cognizant fell 84 per cent, from 15,919 in FY2015 to 2,486 in FY2025. Their share of initial-employment approvals dropped from 14 per cent to 2.2 per cent. Over the same period, approvals for Amazon, Microsoft and Google rose from 2,860 to 7,060. Indian firms increasingly hired locally in America and delivered work offshore.

Indians received 51-58 per cent of all PERM certifications in each full year from 2015 to 2023. In June 2026, 356,360 approved Indian EB-2 petitions, counting principal applicants alone, awaited visas. India received just 3,916 EB-2 green cards in FY2024. Those with approved petitions are unaffected by this suspension. The additional barrier falls on workers still seeking certification. The US labour-market anxiety is understandable. Unemployment in computer and mathematics occupations rose from 1.9 per cent in 2022 to 3.3 per cent in 2025. Software job postings are 66 per cent below their 2022 peak. Yet restricting foreign workers does not ensure their jobs go to Americans. Firms can move the work abroad. Microsoft employs more than 22,000 people in India and has committed $17.5 billion of investment over 2026–29. Adobe employs more than 8,000. These operations offer an alternative when US recruitment and retention become harder. Any gains for American workers competing for those roles could be offset by lost investment and work moving overseas.

The economic effect would emerge through retention and future hiring, rather than an immediate loss of existing visa holders. When permanent settlement becomes less attainable, some workers may prefer employers or countries offering greater security. Firms could relocate teams or expand recruitment abroad to retain those skills. The risk for America is that restricting settlement changes where work gets done, without creating equivalent domestic jobs.

India is positioned to receive some of that work. Employment at global capability centres — the in-house operations of multinational companies — rose from 1.9 million in FY2024 to 2.36 million in FY2026. Cognizant's Indian workforce grew from 194,700 in 2018 to 256,900 in 2025, while its North American workforce shrank from 50,000 to 41,600. The shift is already underway. But more work in India does not automatically translate into more opportunities for fresh graduates. Net technology hiring fell from 445,000 in FY2022 to between 60,000 and 135,000 annually thereafter. In ICRIER's survey of 651 IT firms, 65 per cent reported cutting hiring after adopting AI, while 55 per cent reduced entry-level employment and 42 per cent increased mid-level hiring. Experienced returnees and relocated roles may fit that demand better than the 820,000 engineering graduates India produces annually. Graduate unemployment remained 11.2 per cent in 2025, against 3.1 per cent across all education levels. Offshore expansion alone cannot resolve this mismatch.

> Preserving mobility matters. But the central task is to turn relocated work into broader opportunity

There is a longer-term cost. The US supplied 27.7 per cent of India's $118.7 billion in remittances in 2023-24. Fewer Indians settling there could slow remittance growth and weaken diaspora networks. India's response should focus on capturing higher-value work through effective GCC policy, predictable tax and transfer-pricing rules, and skills that help experienced workers use AI. Preserving mobility matters. But the central task is to turn relocated work into broader opportunity. A larger offshore industry alongside a narrower American dream would otherwise leave too many young Indians behind.

The writer is with ORF

Month after Pezeshkian's visit to India, NSA Doval, Iranian counterpart speak on phone

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 12



NSA Ajit Doval (left) and his Iranian counterpart Mohsen Rezaei

NATIONAL SECURITY Advisor Ajit Doval on Monday spoke to his Iranian counterpart Mohsen Rezaei on phone. This comes a month after Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian's first official visit to India in September to attend the 18th BRICS Summit.

The Iranian Embassy in Delhi said in a social media post: "Dr Mohsen Rezaei, Secretary of the Supreme National Security Council of the Islamic Republic of Iran, held a telephone conversation this evening with Shri Ajit Doval, National Security Adviser of the Republic of India, during which they exchanged views on the latest regional and international developments and issues of mutual interest to the two countries."

The phone call between Doval and Rezaei assumes significance in the wake of the recent attacks on Indian ships in the Strait of Hormuz.

Recently, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar met Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi on the margins of the UN General Assembly session in New York and conveyed New Delhi's concerns regarding attacks on merchant vessels.

As many as 16 Indian nationals, including 10 seafarers, have been killed and another 75 injured in the West Asia conflict since February, the MEA told Parliament in July.

Deputy Secretary for Defense Affairs of Iran's Supreme National Security Council Ghadir Nezamipour also visited India on June 22 and met NSA Doval on the sidelines of the 16th BRICS National Security Advisers' meeting. Tehran and New Delhi have had regular channels of communication at various levels throughout the military conflict.

2 sailors missing

India on Monday condemned attacks on two ships with Indians on board in the Strait of Hormuz; two Indian seafarers have been missing since the attacks.

"We condemn the attacks on commercial vessels in the Strait of Hormuz region on 11 October 2026. MT PETRO DOLPHIN was reportedly struck by a drone, with two of the 11 Indian seafarers onboard reported missing. MT VALTHERA, a Marshall Islands-flagged tanker, was struck by an unknown projectile, resulting in a fire onboard. All 11 Indian seafarers onboard MT VALTHERA are reported to be safe," it said.

It said the Indian Embassy in Muscat is closely monitoring the situation and coordinating with the authorities and respective ship management companies for the rescue of missing Indians and to provide all possible assistance to the Indian crew.

"The safety and security of Indian seafarers remain a priority for the Government of India. The recurring attacks on commercial shipping in the region are deeply concerning and risk further aggravating an already volatile situation," it said. "India reiterates the need for immediate de-escalation and resolution to the ongoing conflict through dialogue and diplomacy."

CJI: Right to life includes right to enjoy pollution-free water, air

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, October 12

At NHRC's 33rd foundation day, CJI Kant urges courts and human rights panels to protect the most vulnerable

EMPHASISING THAT human rights violations require coordinated action across institutions, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant Monday called on courts, governments, and other institutions to work together to address systemic failures and protect the rights of the most vulnerable.

"Courts must intervene when constitutional rights are violated. Human rights commissions must investigate complaints, identify systemic failures and ensure that concerns which may otherwise remain invisible receive institutional attention," he said.

Addressing the National Human Rights Commission's 33rd foundation day event in New Delhi and conference on 'Water-the Elixir of Life: Advancing Human Dignity through the Right to Water', the CJI said, "A right that works for the powerful but fails the powerless is not a right in true sense... It is a privilege with better branding. The true measure of a human rights institution is therefore not only the number of cases it decides, but whether it can be heard by those who are least able to make themselves heard."

He said the Constitution's promise of dignity, equality, liberty and justice must be observed "day after day, in the field, in the lock-up, in the hospital ward and in the village at the end of the road".

He cited the commission's interventions in cases involving custodial torture, deaths, bonded labour, and rights of marginalised communities. He also said the state HRC "can hear a complaint in the language in which it is made, reach the place where it has occurred and understand local circumstances in which it has taken place".

On Article 21, he said it had evolved "into a guarantee of a life lived with dignity" and that the Supreme Court's environmental jurisprudence had recognised that the right to life includes the right to enjoy pollution-free water and air. "The constitutional question, therefore, is no longer only what the State must refrain from doing, but also what it must ensure so that people can live with dignity," he said.

Acknowledging India's efforts to expand access, including household tap connections in rural areas, the CJI said the question now is whether the water is "safe, reliable and available when the family needs it".

"A mere tap is not the same as access to water. A pipe that runs dry cannot fulfil the promise that the pipe represents. And water contaminated with arsenic, fluoride or other harmful substances is not a service; it is a threat to life and health," he said.

He also said that rights of future generations cannot be ignored. "Every aquifer depleted, every river polluted and every source of drinking water compromised, transfers a burden to a generation that had no part in creating it... If human rights are ultimately about protecting human dignity, then that protection must extend across time. We must leave the posterity not merely a Constitution that promises rights, but a country in which those rights remain possible to enjoy," he said.

NHRC chairperson Justice V Ramasubramanian, meanwhile, said that "while the world had made progress over the past century, it was also grappling with climate change and growing inequality".

SC refuses to stay CBI corruption case against Punjab CM's aide

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 12

THE SUPREME Court on Monday refused to stay the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)'s corruption case against Rajbir Singh Guman, an officer on special duty to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, and other senior officials.

Issuing notice on a plea by the Punjab government, a bench of Justices M M Sundresh and Prasanna B Varale, however, directed that no coercive steps be taken in the case. The court declined to stay the case and asked the state to cooperate with the investigation. The agency registered the FIR following a direction by the Punjab and Haryana High Court.

In a communication to the Punjab Director General of Police under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act on July 30, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) sought to register a criminal case against Guman and his alleged associates, Nitin Gohal and Bir Devinder. This was based on material allegedly indicating cash-for-transfers and postings, influence over government policies and tenders, leakage of confidential government documents, and other favours.

Hearing a PIL by advocate Nikhil Saraf, the High Court on October 5 directed the CBI to conduct a fair and transparent investigation into allegations raised in an ED communication and submit its report within two months.

The High Court noted that though the ED communication was received in the DGP's office on August 3 and was marked to the Punjab Bureau of Investigation, no FIR had been registered even after two months.

Guman, Gohal and Devinder allegedly interfered in transfers and postings of government officials, and in government work and tender processes. The agency also referred to material purportedly indicating attempts to influence postings, access confidential government documents and interfere in administrative approvals and other official processes.

Kin of beheaded Naga man refuse to accept body: 'Against traditions'

Express News Service
Imphal, October 12

THE FAMILY of a Naga man, who was allegedly beheaded by Kuki militants during an attack on Makui village in Manipur's Kangpokpi district on October 10, has refused to accept his remains.

The headless body cannot be identified with certainty, and thus cannot be accepted as per their traditions, the family said.

R Ajinpou was among three Naga men killed in the attack on Makui, a Liangmai Naga village along the Imphal-Tamenglong road (IT Road). The mortal remains of the three victims, including Ajinpou's, were taken to the mortuary of the Jawaharlal Nehru Institute of Medical Sciences (JNIMS) on October 11.

Ajinpou's elder brother R Stoneson said the family would accept the body only after the severed head is recovered. "A person's head is their identity. Without it, how can anyone identify the deceased? No one can be certain that the headless body belongs to my brother; it could belong to anyone. According to our traditions, we cannot accept the body under these circumstances. We will accept it only when the severed head is recovered."

Meanwhile, the Joint Tribe Council-Manipur's Working Committee has issued a "non-negotiable" 48-hour ultimatum to the Central and the state governments, beginning Saturday, demanding "recovery" of the missing head, which it alleged was taken by Kuki militants sheltered under the Suspension of Operations pact. The committee also demanded the arrest of the alleged perpetrators — Thangboi Kipgen, David Hangsing and Sailen Haokip (Kuki militant leaders)— and called for them to "face the full force of the law".

A video has been circulating on social media, purportedly showing armed men, suspected to be Kuki militants, displaying the severed head of Ajinpou.

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDENT, MAHARANA BHUPAL, GOVT. HOSPITAL, UDAIPUR.
BID NOTICE 42 Date 28-9-2026 (E-Tender)

On line Bids are invited from Principal Manufacturer/Authorized Dealer/Distributors for the following items (Rate Contract). The Bid documents can be downloaded from web site **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** Details of this Bid notification and pre-qualification criteria can also be seen in NIB exhibited on website **WWW.dipronline.org** as well as **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in**. Bids are to be submitted online in electronic format on website **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**

ST.	Item name	Estt. Total Cost (in Lakh.)	Submission end date	UBN No
1	Blood Bags (Rate Contract For One Year).	150.00	26-10-2026 at 5.00 PM	(GHU2627GLRC00049)
2	H3N2 & HINI (Swine Flu RT-PCR) Kit (Rate Contract For One Year)	35.00	26-10-2026 at 5.00 PM	(GHU2627GLRC00050)

DIPR/C/17513/2026 SUPERINTENDENT

उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, राजस्थान
No. :- F-2(01)Acct/Contract/2026-27/193 - 195 Date :- 07/10/2026
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या : 52/2026-27

उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, उदयपुर द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यो मय डिफेक्ट लाईबिलिटी अवधि के लिये जो कि निविदा प्रपत्र में अंकित है के लिये उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदको से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई–टेण्डरिंग के माध्यम से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है :–

निविदा कार्यो की कुल लागत	:	रूपये 3557.00 लाख (01 कार्य)
ऑनलाईन निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड / अपलोड करने की अवधि	:	09.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 13.11.2026 को सांयः 6.00 बजे तक
Online EMD, Tender Fee & Processing Fee जमा कराने की तिथी	:	09.10.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 13.11.2026 को सांयः 6.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की तिथी	:	16.11.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे (तकनीकी बिड)

विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाईट **urban.rajasthan.gov.in/uitudaipur**, **www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** व **www.s ppp.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।
UBN No. : ITU2627WLOB00332
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता - द्वितीय उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण
राज.संवाद/सी/26/11641

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat
Tender Notice
Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)

On behalf of President of India Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, office at:- Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work:-

NIT No.	353922R
Name of Work and its location	"Operation of Coach Shot Blasting, Bogie Shot Blasting, and Paint Line with Paint and Shots (As per Scope of Work)"
Approx Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 132008529.43/- including GST@18% (Rupees Thirteen Crore Twenty Lakh Eight Thousand Five Hundred Twenty-Nine and Forty-Three Paisa only)
Earnest Money	Rs 2640200/-
Completion period of work	36 months (03 Years) from date of issue of Letter of acceptance
Cost of Tender document (In Rs.)	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Up to 12:00 hrs on 31/10/2026 Opening of Tender at 12:15 hrs on same day.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Tender No. 353922R Dated: As Signed 3531/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat
Tender Notice
Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)

On behalf of President of India Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, office at:- Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work:-

NIT No.	377776
Name of Work and its location	Repair and modification of Wheel set earthing Equipment of LHB Bogies at RCNK/SNP for a period of one year (As per scope of work)
Approx Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 4444697.40/- including GST@18% (Rupees Forty-Four Lakh Forty-Four Thousand Six Hundred Ninety-Seven and Forty Paisa only)
Earnest Money	Rs 88900/-
Completion period of work	12 months from date of issue of Letter of acceptance
Cost of Tender document (In Rs.)	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Up to 12:00 hrs on 31/10/2026 Opening of Tender at 12:15 hrs on same day.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Tender No. 377776 Dated: As Signed 3530/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, P.H. CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR.
13001/2152/2627
Mobile No: # -9437704019/7008499980
E-mail: sephbbsr@gmail.com

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB) NO.ACECPHBBSR-03/2026-27 Dt.09.10.2026

01	**No of the work**	:	01 No (One no work) Establishment Water Testing Labs at various WTPs and in the ULBS having no WTP to ensure good quality drinking water under State Plan SUJALA
02	**Estimate cost**	:	Rs.624.76 Lakhs
03	**Period of completion**	:	06 (Six) Months
04	**O & M Period**	:	01 (One) Year
05	**Class of contractor**	:	Agencies / Firms having experience and expertise in Establishment of Water Testing Laboratories acceptable as per the NABL guideline
06	**Date & Time of availability of bid document In the portal**	:	From 11.00 AM of Dt.16.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of 30.10.2026
07	**Last date / time of receipt of bids in the portal**	:	5.00 PM of 30.10.2026
08	**Last date & time of seeking clarification**	:	5.00 PM of 26.10.2026
09	**Date & Time of opening of bids**	:	At 12.30 PM of 31.10.2026
10	**Name and Address of the Officer Inviting Bid**	:	Additional Chief Engineer, P.H. Circle, Bhubaneswar

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal "**https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in**"

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer
P.H. Circle, Bhubaneswar
OIPR-13001/13039/1/26-27/0003

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, बिजीखोरवा
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–01SBD/2026–27
राष्ट्रीय स्पर्द्धा निविदा आमंत्रण
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
बिहार सरकार

1. कार्य का विवरण :–

क्रम सं0	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रू0 लाख में)	अग्रधन की राशि (ऑन लाईन अथवा फिजिकल /मैनुअल मोड में भुगतेय) (रू0 लाख में)	परिमाण–विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0	बेलट्रॉन को देय "बीड प्रोसेसिंग फी" (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रू0	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि।
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिजीखोरवा अंतर्गत बदुआ डैम पर अवस्थित सिंचाई निरीक्षण भवन का जीर्णोद्धार कार्य।	396.47594	7.93000	10,000/-	11800/-	18 महीना

2	विज्ञापन दाता का नाम	:	कार्यपालक अभियंता, सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिजीखोरवा
3	निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि	:	दिनांक:–08.10.2026
4	निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि	:	दिनांक:–31.10.2026के 10.00बजे पूर्वाहन सेदिनांक:–04.11.2026के03.00 बजे अपराहन तक।(केवलवेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
5	प्री–बीड मीटिंग का समय, स्थान एवं तिथि	:	दिनांक:–02.11.2026को अपराहन 03.00 बजेमुख्यअभियंता, सिंचाई सृजन, जल संसाधन विभाग, भागलपुर के कार्यालय कक्ष में।
6	तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	:	दिनांक 06.11.2026के अपराहन 03.30बजे(केवलवेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)।
7	वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	:	सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर घोषित की जायेगी।
8	निविदा खोलने का स्थान	:	केवल वेबसाईटwww.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
9	निविदा की वैद्यता अवधि	:	120 दिन
10	विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु	:	वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in / www.wrd.bih.nic.in /www.state.bihar.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिजीखोरवा
मो0 :–7463889330
PR- 013486 (WRD) 2026-27
विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA POLICE HOUSING CORPORATION, PANCHKULA	PROVIDING ESTATE ELECTRICAL SERVICES (TRANSFORMER, DG SET AND HT LINE ETC.) IN NEWLY CONSTRUCTED WOMEN POLICE STATION BUILDING/ POLICE STATION, SECTOR-13/17 AT ANSAL CITY, SECTOR - 19, DISTT. PANIPAT + 25 WORKS	09.10.2026 16.10.2026	33,83,85,991/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in & www.hphc.org.in	9463200487 dhpanchkula@yahoo.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50110/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, ROHTAK	ANNUAL MAINTENANCE OF STREET LIGHTS INSTALLED IN CITY ROHTAK (2026)	09.10.2026 19.10.2026	2,63,51,538/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, ROHTAK	RE-CARPETING OF ROAD NEAR CANAL REST HOUSE CHOWK TO CHOTU RAM DHARMSHALA , WARD NO. 16, M.C ROHTAK. + 1 WORKS	09.10.2026 19.10.2026	1,62,91,688/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50105/HRY

मध्यप्रदेश राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम मर्यादित
पर्यटन भवन, भदभदा रोड, भोपाल-462003
फोन नं. : +91 755-4027100, 2774340,42, www.mpstdc.com
क्रमांक : 491/यांत्रिकी/पविनि/26 दिनांक : 12.10.2026
निविदा सूचना 352/2026_STDC_542671_1

मध्यप्रदेश राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम भोपाल द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ऑनलाइन (Online) निविदा प्रपत्र APPENDIX 2.10 पर म.प्र. लोक निर्माण विभाग में उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से आमंत्रित की जाती है। **कार्य का नाम:-** मुरैना स्थित शनिचरा मंदिर में विकास एवं सौंदर्यीकरण के कार्य आंतरिक एवं बाहरी विद्युतीकरण सहित। (18 माह)। कार्य की अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 2843.49 लाख
वेबसाइट पर ऑनलाइन भुगतान कर निविदा प्रपत्र (टेण्डर डाक्युमेंट) वेबसाइट के माध्यम से क्रय किये जा सकते हैं। निविदा प्रपत्र ऑनलाइन क्रय करने की **अंतिम तिथि 02.11.2026 समय सायं 05:00 बजे तक** निर्धारित है। कार्य का विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।
म.प्र. माध्यम/128530/2026 **कार्यपालन यंत्री**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW TOILET BLOCKS IN CIVIL HOSPITAL AT RATIA IN FATEHABAD DISTT. (EXCLUDING GST).	09.10.2026 21.10.2026	26.20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, KAITHAL	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FOR LINKING PUNDRI RAJOUND ROAD WITH RAJOUND KAITHAL ROAD (ROAD ID 6924) AND SERDHA TO KUKARKANDA ROAD (ROAD ID 6907) UNDER NABARD SCHEME RIDF XXXII IN KAITHAL DISTRICT	CLOSING DATE 16.10.2026	490.16 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eepd-kaithal@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, KAITHAL	IMPROVEMENT OF KAITHAL DHAND ROAD MDR-119 (KATHWAR VILLAGE JUNCTION) TO RAWANHERA VIA KEORAK, TEEK, KAITHAL DHAND ROAD MDR-119, KHANODA (ID 9893, 9413, 7134 AND 7135)(UNDER NABARD RIDF-XXXII) + 4 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 21.10.2026	3208.03 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eepd-kaithal@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, KAITHAL	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM TITRAM MOR TO AMBALA ROAD UPTO BYE PASS (NH-152) AT KAITHAL (ROAD ID 10821) UNDER NABARD RIDF - XXXII	CLOSING DATE 27.10.2026	1473.44 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eepd-kaithal@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, NARWANA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PDG. WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF ROAD FROM GIRLS GURUKUL TO CHATTER ROAD IN JIND DISTRICT (ROAD ID 11981)	09.10.2026 19.10.2026	480.08 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7599999782 pwdnarwana@gmail.com
6	PWD B&R, JIND	WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF KINANA TO VILLAGE PINDARA TIRATH VIA ANOOPGARH BIROLI AND RADHANA ROAD IN JULANA CONSTITUENCY IN JIND DISTT. (ROAD ID 10123) (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 19.10.2026	945.65 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8398098075 pwdeepdjind@gmail.com
7	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	DEVELOPMENT OF LANDSCAPING WORK OF NEW 6 BAYS BUS STAND AT BARWALA IN HISAR DISTT.	08.10.2026 27.10.2026	20.19 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9717214202 zilesinghhort@gmail.com
8	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	ANNUAL MAINTENANCE OF LANDSCAPING WORK OF NEW MINI SECTT. AT CHARKHI DADRI IN DISTRICT CHARKHI DADRI FOR THE YEAR 2026-2027 (FROM 01.11.2026 TO 31.03.2027) (05 MONTHS) AND 2 OTHER WORKS	12.10.2026 22.10.2026	20.69 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9717214202 zilesinghhort@gmail.com
9	PWD B&R, KARNAL	WORK OF 3 NOS ROADS (1) STG. WITH 30MM BC AND WBM PLUS RELAYING OF CCB AND 80MM IPB ON BERM ON KARNAL KAITHAL ROAD TO SHINGRA BHOJPURA ROAD (ID 7286) FROM KM 0.00 TO 4.60. (2) STG. WITH 30MM BC AND RELAYING OF CCB ON TARAORI TO TAKHANA ROAD (ID-8879) (ODR) IN KM 0.00 TO 0.870 (3) STG. WITH 50MM DBM PLUS 40MM BC AND WBM PLUS NEW / RELAYING OF CCB ON NIDANA TO PAKHANA ROAD (ID-8880) IN KM 0.00 TO 2.470 IN NILOKHERI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (UNDER ODR WP 2026-27).	10.10.2026 23.10.2026	315.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
10	PANCHAYATI RAJ, BHIWANI	COMPLITION OF GENERAL CHOUPAL VILLAGE -JAMALPUR BLOCK -BAWANI KHERA MP LAD + 1 WORKS	10.10.2026 16.10.2026	47.20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664243927 prexeeng.bhw@hry.nic.in
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ,KARNAL	CONST. OF ILPB RASTA FROM GT ROAD TO MUBARKABAD ROAD VIA HEROS WAR MEMORIAL SCHOOL PART - 2 AT VILLAGE BASTARA + 2 WORKS	07.10.2026 14.10.2026	60.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896202019 prexeeng.krl@hry.nic.in
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA,FATEHABAD	REPAIR OF RAMP OF BRIDGE AT RD 83645 SIRSA MAJOR DISTY	CLOSING DATE 16.10.2026	1.86 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466751554 xenwsdivisionfbd@yahoo.com
13	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (INJECTION SURFACTANT 5ML) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	13.10.2026 21.10.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
14	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, BAHADURGARH	INTERNAL CLEARANCE OF BARAHI SUB MINOR FROM RD 0 TO 27000 TAIL FOR THE YEAR 2026-27 + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 14.10.2026	10.03 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01276-298418 wsdivisionbgarh@gmail.com
15	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA,SIRSA	INTERNAL AND OUTER CLEARANCE OF PEERKHERA MINOR FROM RD 0-13000 TAIL IN SADEWA SECTION (RABI SEASON 2026-27)	CLOSING DATE 15.10.2026	1.24 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996665761 xensrs.swd1925@yahoo.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50107/HRY

INSTRUCTIONS AGREED AT LAST WEEK'S GST COUNCIL MEETING

States, Centre told to focus on data analytics, tech to widen GST base

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, October 12

DEEPER DATA analytics, leveraging technology, moving away from enforcement-led and intrusive actions, tracking taxpayers who do not pay tax in cash and using invoice matching are among the measures that central and state officers have been asked to focus on to deepen the tax base under the Goods and Services Tax (GST) regime.

Following a series of process reforms announced at the 57th meeting of the GST Council last week, tax officials have also been asked to undertake granular data analysis to identify opportunities to expand the tax base. This includes closely monitoring transactions in which retail sales may be misdeclared as business-to-business (B2B) transactions to claim input tax credit (ITC), and identifying registered GST taxpayers who report no cash tax payments and instead set off their entire GST liability against eligible ITC.

Several business-friendly measures announced at the Council meeting, including the introduction of a Rs 10,000 threshold for issuing showcause notices under GST, are also likely to be rolled out before April 1, 2027, the implementation date for other measures.

"It is very important to look at stabilising the GST system. And that's why rate rationalisation was undertaken last year and now the process reforms. The GST authorities have been instructed to use technology and data analytics to detect evasion and make efforts to deepen the tax base. Although we have a good number of taxpayers registered under GST, there is scope to widen the tax base and we have asked states to widen the base," a senior official said.

"Businesses that are registered but showing anomalies in their GST declarations can have their transactions studied, and they can be nudged accordingly to become part of the tax system," the official added.

The technology-led GST data analytics initiative is expected to follow the approach of the Income Tax Department's NUDGE (Non-intrusive Usage of Data to Guide and Enable) campaign,



Tax officials have been asked to monitor retail sales misdeclared as B2B transactions to claim input tax credit. REUTERS

which uses risk analytics, behavioural insights and information sharing through global networks such as the Common Reporting Standard (CRS) and the Foreign Account Tax Compliance Act (FATCA) framework to nudge taxpayers towards compliance.

GST authorities will also rely on the Invoice Management System (IMS) to match credit details between sellers and buyers. Under a proposed additional layer to prevent mismatch notices, buyers will be able to accept, reject or hold each invoice as it appears. Accepted invoices will flow into their returns.

"A seller who wants to reduce something he has reported does it where the buyer will see it, so the two sides stay aligned. Much else rests on this," the official said.

Linking the input and output ledgers with the summary return would help identify fake credit as it arises, the official added.

To enable this invoice-matching mechanism, GST authorities will also introduce electronic invoicing (e-invoicing) as a step before the matching process. E-invoicing for business-to-consumer (B2C) transactions will be introduced from April 1, 2027, the official said, adding that the GST Network will provide the necessary support system to states for the transition. Under the existing GST e-Invoice System, businesses are required to upload B2B invoices to a government-approved Invoice Registration Portal (IRP) for validation and the generation of a unique Invoice Reference Number (IRN) and a QR code.

GST authorities are also expecting smoother movement of goods following the Council's recent decision to allow vehicles to be stopped only by tax officers from the state of the supplier or recipient, and only on the basis of "specific intelligence" and due authorisation. The measure was initially proposed only for supplier states. However, following detailed discussions at the Council meeting, recipient states were also included at the request of some states, the official said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Rupee rallies by 1%, logs biggest daily gain in six months after RBI steps

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, October 12

THE RUPEE appreciated 95 paise, logging its steepest single-day gain in more than six months, to close at 95.78 against the US dollar on Monday after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) introduced several measures aimed at supporting the domestic currency.

"The Indian rupee emerged as the strongest performer among its Asian peers, supported by the RBI's targeted measures to curb speculation and contain volatility in the forex market," said Dilip Parmar, Senior Research Analyst, HDFC Securities. A pullback in crude oil prices, driven by expectations of improving supply conditions, further aided sentiment.

However, weaker domestic equities and continued foreign fund outflows weighed on the currency, limiting its gains after the initial rise.

According to Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst, Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities, the RBI's measures are expected to ease pressure on the spot market and curb speculative dollar buying, supporting the rupee in the near term. However, a sustained recovery will depend on foreign institutional investor (FII) flows, crude oil prices and broader dollar movements.

On October 10, with the rupee inching closer to the 97-per-dollar mark and crude oil prices surging above $100 per barrel, the RBI tightened its grip on the rupee derivatives market. It introduced a package of regulatory measures aimed at strengthening market discipline, curbing excessive speculative activity and improving transparency in foreign exchange transactions.

The central bank announced restrictions on rebooking cancelled foreign exchange derivative contracts, lowered the threshold for transactions permitted without establishing underlying exposure, strengthened documentation requirements and introduced a new Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve. The changes could significantly alter how banks, corporations, financial institutions and currency traders manage their foreign exchange positions. Forex reserves fell by $12.95 billion to $734.60 billion in the week ended October 2. The rupee had remained under pressure despite inflows of more than $143 billion under the FCNR scheme.

Meanwhile, the BSE Sensex declined 0.76%, or 547 points, to 71,924.68 on Monday. The NSE Nifty fell 0.70%, or 157 points, to 22,363.35.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Banks seek relief, clarity from RBI on FX measures

Mumbai: Banks have urged the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to ease one of the key measures the regulator announced over the weekend to support the rupee and scrap the threshold above which the rule comes into effect, four people familiar with the discussions said.

Lenders have approached the central bank through a forex industry body, seeking the removal of a mandate that banks make a 20% cash deposit with the RBI for FX derivatives used to hedge current-account exposures, the people said. The people declined to be named.

The RBI's measures, announced on Saturday, are aimed at curbing corporate demand for forward dollars that have piled pressure on the rupee, which has been falling due to steep oil prices and capital outflows.

Banks have proposed the RBI replace the 20% deposit mandate with a flat charge on companies hedging current-account exposures through forward dollar purchases, or other derivatives. REUTERS

Tata Sons' IPO ambitions clouded by shareholder test, structural obstacles

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 12

TATA SONS' decision to proceed with steps towards a public listing has opened complex corporate and regulatory hurdles, with the proposed initial public offering (IPO) facing potential roadblocks involving shareholder approvals, changes in corporate structure and amendments to its Articles of Association.

"The IPO will require Tata Sons to convert itself from a private to public company and also amend the Articles of Association. These actions require prior approval of shareholders in AGM or EGM," said a top-level source in the Tata group. This means all the parties involved in the power struggle will have to settle the disputes and come to an understanding.

While there is a move for mediation to settle the disputes, it's learnt both sides have not budged from their positions so far.

Tata Sons' board does not necessarily require AGM approval merely to decide to pursue an IPO. "However, shareholder approval may be required depending on the structure of the issue and the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, SEBI regulations and Tata Sons' Articles of Association. Therefore, whether AGM approval is mandatory depends on the specific corporate actions proposed as part of the IPO," said Sonam Chandwani, Managing Partner, KS Legal & Associates.

The board of Tata Sons, the holding company of the Tata group, voted on September 17 to proceed with the listing following the Reserve Bank of India's rejection of its application to surrender its registration as a Core Investment Company. Four directors backed the listing process, while Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata opposed it.

Tata Sons has reportedly initiated preliminary talks with some banks for the IPO plan. "How will the company go for an IPO if it needs shareholder approval. Tata Trusts which hold 66 per cent of the company can easily block it. The company will have to change its status to a public limited company. Four independent directors can't alone decide whether to go for an IPO. Then the issue of Articles of Association. Tata Sons will need the support of shareholders," said an observer tracking the Tata group developments.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Lakshmi, Mallika flag unresolved Venu family asset dispute

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 12

LAKSHMI VENU and Mallika Srinivasan have said no economic settlement has been reached over the ownership and division of assets within the Venu Srinivasan family, underlining continuing differences despite the completion of a broader partition within the TVS family.

The statement comes amid a dispute between TVS Motor Chairman Emeritus Venu Srinivasan and his son Sudarshan Venu on one side, and Mallika, Venu's wife, and their daughter Lakshmi on the other.

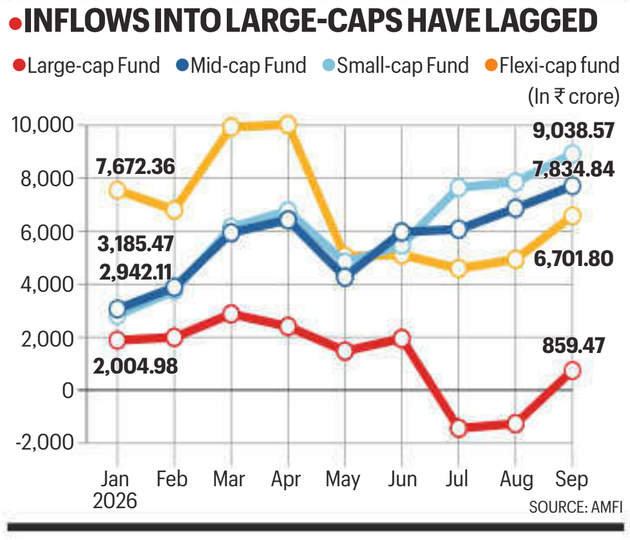
In a joint statement, Lakshmi and Mallika said the broader TVS family partition, agreed upon in 2020 and implemented implemented later, involved the relevant stakeholders. However, they said no comparable process had taken place to settle the economic interests within the Venu Srinivasan family.

"The fundamental issue is not about management positions, which have been compensated appropriately and commensurately. It is about the fair recognition of rightful economic ownership, which remains unresolved," they said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SIP inflows hit record Rs 32,490 crore in Sept

INFLOWS INTO LARGE-CAPS HAVE LAGGED



Akash Mandal
Mumbai, October 12

EQUITY MUTUAL funds continued to draw strong interest in September despite a challenging geopolitical environment and muted market returns. Retail investors remained undeterred as contributions through systematic investment plans (SIPs) hit a record Rs 32,490 crore during the month, as per the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI).

When asked whether a prolonged period of muted equity returns could dent retail investors' sustained confidence, AMFI President Venkat Chalasani emphasised that equity mutual funds are long-term investment tools, offering benefits such as averaging during periods of market weakness and compounding over several years.

"One should invest in equity funds according to their long-term investment goals, instead of investing with a time frame of 1-2 years. We have been telling people to focus on the long-term India growth story and encourage long-term investing. That's why we are encouraging people to invest in SIPs," Chalasani said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Sunil Bharti Mittal gets France's top civilian award



Sunil Bharti Mittal. BHARTI AIRTEL

New Delhi: Bharti Enterprises Founder and Chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal has been conferred the highest civilian award in France, Chevalier de l'Ordre national de la Legion d'Honneur (Knight of the National Order of the Legion of Honour), by French President Emmanuel Macron.

Established in 1802 by Napoleon Bonaparte, the Legion d'Honneur is the highest civilian award bestowed by the French Republic. Mittal has been conferred the distinction in recognition of his longstanding commitment to deepening India-France economic ties and his outstanding achievements in telecommunications and digital infrastructure, a company statement said. PTI

IMF raises India's FY27 growth forecast to 7%

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 12

THE INTERNATIONAL Monetary Fund (IMF) has raised its GDP growth forecast for India to 7% for 2026-27, up from 6.4% in July, on the back of "stronger-than-expected momentum, supported by resilient domestic demand and robust services activity". The sharp increase in the forecast for the current fiscal comes days after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) did the same. The Indian central bank now expects India's GDP to expand by 7.1% this year.

"India stands out with upward revisions, reflecting sustained momentum and growing evidence of stronger growth potential supported by favourable demographic dynamics, a large and expanding domestic market, and continued structural reforms," the IMF said in an update to its flagship World Economic Outlook report.

GDP growth in 2027-28 is also seen at 7%, up from the July estimate of 6.7%. The IMF's forecasts assume that the average price of crude oil — across Brent, Dubai Fateh, and West Texas Intermediate — will be $95.74 per barrel in 2026, up 41% from 2025. In 2027, the oil price is assumed to decline around 9% to $87.39. The sharply higher growth forecast for India is in contrast to the global economy. In 2026, the IMF now sees the world's output growing by 3.1%, only slightly higher than 3% in July. Meanwhile, global growth in 2027 is seen unchanged at 3.4%.

According to the multilateral agency, the negative supply shock from the war in West Asia is making its way through the world economy. And while the private sector has seemingly adjusted well to the conflict and trade-related shocks, the "possibility of larger economic costs" is becoming "more palpable". This is because the conflict is dragging on and buffers are becoming narrower.

Countries that are now projected to grow at a significantly higher rate in 2026 than in July include Germany (1.3% versus 0.7%) and UK (1.3% versus 1%). In fact, advanced economies as a whole are seen growing 2.1% in 2026, up from 1.7% before.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

BRIEFLY

Tata Trusts row: SDTT gets one week extension

Mumbai: The Maharashtra Charity Commissioner has given a one-week extension till October 19 to Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) for its response to the complaints filed by SDTT Vice Chairmen Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh. The Charity Commissioner earlier sought a response from SDTT by October 12. The proceedings have also affected Tata Sons, forcing the holding company to adjourn its AGM after a restraining order barred Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) from holding board proceedings. ENS

Tata, Stellantis to expand global vehicle tie-up

New Delhi: Stellantis India, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd and its subsidiary Tata Passenger Electric Mobility Ltd on Monday announced the signing of a definitive agreement to expand the scope of their long-standing partnership further into advanced technology and product collaboration. Under the agreement, TMPV and Stellantis will collaborate to develop vehicles for more than 50 global markets and manufacture them in India at Fiat India Automobiles Pvt Ltd. PTI

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
71,924.68	22,363.35	₹1,48,061	₹95.78
-547.65	-157.10	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
-0.76%	-0.70%	₹2,20,295	$124.22

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 9, 2026

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL
AHMEDABAD BENCH, AHMEDABAD

C.P. (CAA)/ 46 (AHM) 2026
connected with
C.A. (CAA)/ 29 (AHM) 2026

In the matter of Sections 230 to 232 read with other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013
and
In the matter of Scheme of Amalgamation
of
Orient Cement Limited ("Transferor Company")
with
Ambuja Cements Limited ("Transferee Company")

ORIENT CEMENT LIMITED,
a company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956, and having its registered office at Adani Corporate House, Shantigram, Near Vaishno Devi Circle, S. G. Highway, Khodiyar, Ahmedabad – 382 421, Gujarat, India.
CIN: L26940GJ2011PLC171878
... PETITIONER NO. 1/ TRANSFEROR COMPANY

AND

AMBUJA CEMENTS LIMITED,
a company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 and having its registered office at Adani Corporate House, Shantigram, Near Vaishno Devi Circle, S. G. Highway, Khodiyar, Ahmedabad, Gujarat – 382 421, India.
CIN: L26942GJ1981PLC004717
... PETITIONER NO. 2 / TRANSFEREE COMPANY

NOTICE OF HEARING OF THE PETITION

A Joint Company Petition under Sections 230 – 232 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, for Scheme of Amalgamation of Orient Cement Limited with Ambuja Cements Limited **("Scheme")** was presented by the Petitioner Companies on September 30, 2026. By an order dated October 8, 2026, the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Ahmedabad Bench **("Hon'ble Tribunal")** has fixed the hearing of the said Joint Company Petition on November 19, 2026, bef ore the Hon'ble Tribunal at 10:30 a.m. or soon thereaf ter.

Any person desirous of supporting or opposing the said Joint Company Petition should send to the Petitioner Companies' advocate at the address mentioned hereunder, notice of his intention, signed by him or his advocate, with his name and address, so as to reach the Hon'ble Tribunal and the Petitioner Companies' advocate not later than 2 (two) days before the date of hearing fixed by the Hon'ble Tribunal, i.e., November 19, 2026. Where such person seeks to oppose the Joint Company Petition, the grounds of opposition or a copy of his affidavit shall be furnished with such notice.

A copy of the Joint Company Petition will be furnished by the Petitioner Companies' advocate to any person requiring the same on payment of the prescribed charges for the same.

Dated: 9.10.2026

Sd/-
Singhi & Co.,
Advocates for the Petitioner Companies

Address:
Singhi & Co., Advocates & Notary, Singhi House,
1, Magnet Corporate Park, Near Sola Bridge,
S.G. Highway, Ahmedabad – 380 059

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL
AHMEDABAD BENCH, AHMEDABAD

C.P. (CAA)/ 47 (AHM) 2026
connected with
C.A. (CAA)/ 33 (AHM) 2026

In the matter of Sections 230 to 232 read with other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013
and
In the matter of Scheme of Amalgamation
of
ACC Limited ("Amalgamating Company")
with
Ambuja Cements Limited ("Amalgamated Company")

ACC LIMITED,
a company incorporated under the provisions of the Indian Companies Act, 1913, and having its registered office at Adani Corporate House, Shantigram, Near Vaishno Devi Circle, S. G. Highway, Khodiyar, Ahmedabad, Gujarat – 382 421, India.
CIN: L26940GJ1936PLC149771
... PETITIONER NO. 1/ AMALGAMATING COMPANY

AND

AMBUJA CEMENTS LIMITED,
a company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956 and having its registered office at Adani Corporate House, Shantigram, Near Vaishno Devi Circle, S. G. Highway, Khodiyar, Ahmedabad, Gujarat – 382 421, India.
CIN: L26942GJ1981PLC004717
... PETITIONER NO. 2 / AMALGAMATED COMPANY

NOTICE OF HEARING OF THE PETITION

A Joint Company Petition under S ections 230 – 232 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act , 2013, for Scheme of Amalgamation of ACC Limited with Ambuja Cements Limited **("Scheme")** was presented by the Petitioner Companies on October 1, 2026. By an order dated October 8, 2026, the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Ahmedabad Bench **("Hon'ble Tribunal")** has fixed the hearing of the said Joint Company Petition on November 19, 2026, bef ore the Hon'ble Tribunal at 10:30 a.m. or soon thereaf ter.

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1, Magnet Corporate Park, Near Sola Bridge,
S.G. Highway, Ahmedabad – 380 059

KREMLIN REJECTS KYIV PROPOSAL FOR A 60-DAY CEASEFIRE, SAYS IT WANTS AN OVERALL PEACE DEAL

Zelenskyy says Russia hits energy targets despite Trump ceasefire

Ukraine President says ready to call election if war ends

Reuters
Kyiv, October 12

RUSSIA HIT at least six energy targets during a night and morning of deadly airstrikes across Ukraine, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Monday, adding this showed Moscow had no interest in an energy ceasefire announced by Donald Trump.

Under pressure over high energy prices ahead of US midterm elections next month, US President Trump blindsided Kyiv and its European allies over by declaring that Ukraine and Russia had agreed not to hit each other's energy systems.

"It is increasingly evident that Russia is unwilling to accept an energy ceasefire proposed by the United States and intends to continue its terrorist air attacks against our people and communities," Zelenskyy said on X.

"This is what happens when Russia sees the prospect of higher revenues for its war machine," he added.



An injured man receives his personal belongings from a firefighter sitting in front of his house destroyed in a Russian strike on Kharkiv region, Ukraine, on Monday. AP

In comments by video link to a conference in Poland, Zelenskyy identified two of the targets as a gas facility and a petrol station, both hit by Russian drones.

Trump announced the purported energy ceasefire days after unveiling a deal to buy diesel from Russia, which Zelenskyy has criticised as a reversal of years of Western policy aimed at isolating Russia's economy. Trump, for his part, has called on Ukrainians to unseat Zelenskyy in an election, an unusually severe exchange in a relationship between the two leaders that has been strained since Trump returned to power in 2025.

Zelenskyy said Ukraine had carried out no attacks on Russian refineries and was willing to agree to an energy ceasefire, but only if Russia abided by it. He also said elections could be held in Ukraine if Moscow agreed to a full ceasefire for 60 days.

Russia, for its part, said talks were ongoing about a possible energy ceasefire, and Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said further information would be revealed in due course. But he rejected Zelenskyy's proposal for a full 60-day truce. "In Kremlin, both President (Vladimir) Putin and officials at other levels have repeatedly stated that we do not want a ceasefire," said Peskov. "We want long-term peace and are prepared to do everything possible to achieve it."

EU sanctions 1,600 Russian people, firms linked to drone, missile parts

Associated Press
Brussels, October 12

THE EUROPEAN Union imposed sanctions on Monday on almost 1,600 Russian people and companies linked to Russia's arms industry, notably targeting those suspected of involvement in making parts for drones and missiles.

In the biggest single listing of sanctions since the Kremlin launched full-scale war on Ukraine almost five years ago, the EU also targeted 77 people accused of organising, working on, or running in "sham elections" in occupied parts of Ukraine.

Announcing the sanctions, EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas said that more than half of them "address the production chain for the ballistic missiles Russia uses to kill Ukrainian civilians every day."

"'This is not the time to ease pressure on Moscow but to increase it," she said.

The EU said the companies are on a list established by the Russian government itself "that identifies them as belonging to the Russian military-industrial complex, and they are therefore entitled to receive subsidies."

NATO general threatens tough retaliation for Russian attack

Warsaw: NATO's top commander warned Russia on Monday that his forces would destroy "anything and everything" involved in any attack if Moscow was "foolish enough" to launch an assault on alliance territory.

Speaking at the Warsaw Security Forum, US Air Force General Alexus Grynkewich stressed NATO was a defensive alliance. But he outlined a three-pronged approach of blocking, blunting and breaking enemy forces to make any attack "utterly futile".

His remarks come amid heightened tensions between Europe and Russia and lingering concerns among European allies over US President Donald Trump's commitment to NATO's mutual defence pact.

In recent days, Trump has announced a deal with Russian President Vladimir Putin allowing Russia to supply diesel to global markets. REUTERS

Iran offers to mediate between Houthis and Saudi Arabia

Erika Solomon
October 12

IRAN HAS offered to mediate between Saudi Arabia and the Tehran-backed Houthi militia in Yemen, after a string of deadly attacks on the kingdom, warning that overlapping conflicts in the region had no military solution.

The Iranian foreign minister, Abbas Araghchi, made the offer to his Saudi counterpart, Faisal bin Farhan, during a telephone call on Sunday night, according to a statement posted on social media by the Iranian minister's office.

"Insisting on a military approach and ignoring a political solution will further complicate the current situation," the statement, posted on Araghchi's Telegram channel, said.

Araghchi said Iran stood "ready to provide any assistance to help initiate a dialogue" between the two sides.

The Saudi government said the two ministers had spoken, though it made no reference to any mediation offer from Iran. The call was a day after the deadliest attack on a Persian Gulf country since the start of the US-Israeli war with Iran.

On Saturday, a Houthi strike on an airport in the Saudi capital, Riyadh, killed at least 12 people, with hundreds injured. That sparked an exchange of strikes with Saudi-led forces targeting the airport in Sanaa, Yemen's Houthi-controlled capital, according reports on Sunday in local news media affiliated with the group.

The Houthi-run health ministry said that a child had also been killed in a strike on a residential building in Sanaa.

The Saudi authorities have not commented on those assertions, but reported another Houthi attack on Riyadh's airport on Sunday.

On Monday, a state-owned Saudi television channel, *Al Ekhbariya*, warned the Saudi-led military coalition in Yemen was fending off drones and cruise missiles headed toward Saudi Arabia. Officials have not commented publicly. NYT



CCTV footage shows smoke and fire after an attack at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh on Saturday. REUTERS

Saudi faces new missile, drone fire after major attacks on airports

Riyadh: Saudi Arabia said it was facing a new barrage of incoming fire on Monday and that Riyadh airport would remain shut for now, days after Saturday's deadly missile strike on a departure terminal that was claimed by Yemen's Iran-allied Houthis.

Incoming drones and missiles were reported by the Saudi-led coalition backing government forces in Yemen, though there was no news of whether they were intercepted.

The attacks have shut down parts of Saudi airspace, suspending operations at Riyadh airport, and emptying the skies over the capital even as city hosts a major energy conference. REUTERS

Security incident at RAF Fairford 'almost certainly' directed by Iran: UK's Burnham

Reuters
London, October 12



> **I can confirm our assessment that it is highly likely to have been coordinated in Iran, almost certainly directed by Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard (IRGC)"**
> **ANDY BURNHAM ,** PRIME MINISTER OF UK

BRITISH PRIME Minister Andy Burnham said on Monday that a suspected plot targeting the RAF Fairford air base in Britain was "highly likely" to have been coordinated in Iran, and almost certainly directed by the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps.

The RAF Fairfordbase in southwest England, which had been used by US bombers to carry out strikes on Iran, became the focal point for a major security response after five British men were arrested nearby in the early hours of September 27 on suspected terrorism and explosive offences.

US officials have told *Reuters* that there had been a suspected plot involving Iran to launch a drone attack, and last week US President Donald Trump said a threat linked to Iran had prompted a decision to withdraw the bombers from the base.

"I can confirm our assessment that it is highly likely to have been coordinated in Iran, almost certainly directed by Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard (IRGC)," Burnham told parliament.

Tehran has rejected any suggestion it was involved in the Fairford incident, saying it amounted to "unfounded and malicious speculations".

Details around the suspected plot remain thin. The five detained men were later released without charge on police bail "under stringent conditions", and two other arrested men, including a British-Iranian national, have also been released.

Detectives have said petrol but no viable explosive had been found in vans seized along with the five men. However, both police and Burnham have pointed towards the involvement of a foreign state.

"We will not tolerate these threats on our soil," Burnham said. "We will crack down on Iran's use of criminal networks, using our full range of powers to target them and their funding streams, and will bring further sanctions to restrict the capacity of Iran and IRGC to do us harm."

Foreign ministries from almost 30 countries including the US, Canada, France and Germany issued a statement condemning "Iran's use of violent attacks, including the acts of lethal plotting, arson, sabotage, cyber-attacks, and other hybrid activities against us and our partners".

Poland deploys 20,000 police to schools after stabbing attacks

Warsaw: A major police operation was underway in Poland on Monday to ensure security in schools after three recent stabbing attacks, as Prime Minister Donald Tusk vowed to confront what he described as a growing trend of youth violence.

Authorities have dismissed rumours that the attacks were linked to an online challenge or organised group, but Tusk told a crisis meeting on Sunday that the glorification of violence in some corners of the internet was having a damaging effect on young people. "We have observed a rise in fascination with violence, both in Poland and worldwide... we are witnessing a grim trend of violence," he said.

Interior Minister Marcin Kierwinski said over 20,000 police officers would be deployed to schools on Monday. REUTERS

Germany's fragile coalition hit by turmoil as labour minister quits

Reuters
Berlin, October 12

GERMANY'S LABOUR minister and co-head of the centre-left Social Democrats (SPD) quit unexpectedly on Monday, adding to uncertainty around Chancellor Friedrich Merz's struggling coalition after bruising state election defeats last month.

Baerbel Bas said she was resigning from both positions to deal with grief over the recent death of her stepdaughter.

She added that "public attacks against me, unfortunately also from within the ranks of our coalition partner" had made her situation unbearable.

Bas will be replaced as minister by Alexander Schweitzer, former state premier of the western state of Rhineland-Palatinate, and the whole of the SPD leadership will face re-election in a special party conference at the end of the year.



Labour minister Baerbel Bas.

While the departure of one minister was not expected to disrupt the overall government, it highlighted the turmoil facing Europe's largest economy.

Merz's coalition has been under growing pressure following victories for the far-right Alternative for Germany (AfD) in eastern Germany last month.

Bas, whose former ministry oversees large parts of Germany's welfare system, was the target of repeated criticism from some members of Merz's conservative Christian Democrats who have accused her of standing in the way of economic reforms.

Finance Minister Lars Klingbeil, who shared the leadership of the SPD with Bas, cancelled a planned trip to India and it was unclear whether he would attend a meeting of the Group of 20 finance ministers in Bangkok this week.

Senior members from both coalition partners issued a statement last week, stressing their determination to carry on to meet the "historic test" facing Germany's democracy.

However, the tone between them remains tense and Klingbeil said Bas had been subject to "unacceptable" attacks from the CDU while mourning her stepdaughter.

US immigration agents raid democrat Ilhan Omar's home

Washington: US authorities conducted a predawn raid on Monday on the Washington-area home of Democratic US Representative Ilhan Omar of Minnesota, an outspoken critic of Donald Trump who has been the target of political insults by the Republican president, as part of an ongoing investigation, the Justice Department said.

A person familiar with the probe said it is related to alleged immigration fraud, and part of probe concerns the Somali-born lawmaker's immigration paperwork, which was filled out by her late father when she was a child.

Omar wrote in a social media post that the US government is being weaponised to target a political enemy of the president. "For ten years, Trump has targeted me with baseless lies and smear campaigns," Omar said.



US Democratic Representative Ilhan Omar

"This is just the latest escalation... of political intimidation. I will not be silenced."

Other Democrats accused Trump and his administration of abuse of power. Omar, 44, is seeking a fifth two-year term in the US House of Representatives in the midterm elections.

A Justice Department spokesperson said: "Today in the Washington, DC area, Homeland Security Investigations executed a judicially authorized search warrant... This enforcement action is part of an ongoing federal investigation."

PARIS PROSECUTOR'S OFFICE SAYS 'LARGE-SCALE' ATTACK AFFECTED CONNECTED REFRIGERATORS AT MAJOR FOOD RETAILERS, CAUSING FOOD LOSSES & FIRES

When fridges turn hot: A cyberattack rattles French supermarkets

Reuters
Paris, October 12

HACKERS FORCED the temperature of many French supermarket fridges up to 50 degrees Celsius overnight, causing fires and food losses at several hundred stores across the country in a major cyberattack.

The Paris prosecutor's office said a "large-scale" attack was "affecting connected refrigerators in several major food retailers across France" and reported damage included "food losses and fires".

Meanwhile, Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu instructed France's National Cybersecurity Agency ANSSI to investigate, a person in his office said.

They said France "was coordinating with its European counterparts, as other countries may also be affected," while also investigating whether any other French firms were at risk.

Les Mousquetaires, which owns retailer Intermarche, said around 150 of its stores had been hit, with fridges heated up to 50 degrees Celsius for six hours. It had thrown all the food away to avoid any sanitary risks, a spokesperson said.

And Cooperative U CEO Dominique Schelcher said his supermarket had also been hit by the attack. "Targeting equipment essential to the preservation of fresh products and to the food supply of the French people is of extreme gravity and is unprecedented," he wrote on X.



View of the closed frozen food aisle at a supermarket near Nantes, France, on Monday. REUTERS

Carrefour said 80 of its supermarkets had been hit but that the vast majority of its 6,000 stores had not been affected.

Several other supermarket chains, including Monoprix, E.Leclerc and Auchan, did not respond to requests for comment.

Dutch supermarket operator Ahold Delhaize, which operates the Netherlands' largest supermarket chain Albert Heijn and has substantial operations in the United States, said it was also dealing with a "security issue" in its network, and had taken several systems offline to protect them.

A smartphone app for the retailer told clients that due to a "cybersecurity incident" it was unable to deliver groceries.

Online orders represent around 10% of sales for Albert Heijn. Physical stores remained open and Dutch news agency *ANP* reported that rivals had seen an influx of delivery orders. It was not clear if there was any link between the French supermarket attack and the problems flagged by Ahold Delhaize.

Ahold is fourth-largest grocery retailer in US, where websites for its Stop & Shop, Giant, Hannaford and Food Lion stores all had notices saying "site temporarily down". It was unclear if other operations were affected.

The source close to Lecornu said ANSSI had identified a vulnerability in software supplied by Danish company Danfoss.

Danfoss said it was "aware of incidents in France affecting a limited number of refrigeration management systems".

• BRIEFLY

UNITED KINGDOM

Russell Brand goes on trial over rape and sexual assault charges



Comedian and actor Russell Brand. REUTERS

COMEDIAN RUSSELL Brand arrived at a London court Monday for the opening of his trial on charges of rape and sexual assault. Brand was flanked by security guards and accompanied by his wife, Laura Gallacher, as he arrived at Southwark Crown Court for the first day of a trial that is expected to last 10 to 12 weeks. Brand, 51, has pleaded not guilty to three counts of rape, three counts of sexual assault and one count of indecent assault. The offenses relate to six women and are alleged to have taken place between 1999 and 2009. He has remained free on bail ahead of his trial. Prosecutors have said at previous hearings that Brand is accused of raping a woman in a hotel room at a Labour Party conference. AP

NIGERIA

Ambush on market-bound convoy kills 20

GUNMEN AMBUSHED a convoy of traders travelling to a market under military escort and killed at least 20 people in northwestern Zamfara state, a witness and a military source said Monday. Local resident Musa Danladi said the attack occurred around 2 pm on Saturday with the convoy en route to Nasarawa market. Nigerian civil defence corps officer were among those killed, along with 12 civilians. REUTERS

FRANCE

Two injured in school shooting, student detained

FRENCH POLICE detained a 14-year-old suspected of opening fire Monday on his middle school principal and a teacher with a hunting gun that he hid in a guitar case, wounding both in a rare school shooting, prosecutors said. A staff member at the Joseph Lakanal middle school in Aubagne, east of Marseille, disarmed the boy after he fired multiple shots while roaming on two floors of the school, prosecutors said. AP

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

NEPAL

Search and rescue ops continue for 5 missing in floods

NEPALESE AUTHORITIES on Monday are searching for five missing people as 13 more individuals have been rescued from flood-affected areas of Gorkha District after a deluge swept away homes and bridges, authorities said. A total of 95 people have been rescued by the Nepali Army from the areas in Chumnubri Rural Municipality as search and rescue operations continued, the army said. PTI

PAKISTAN

Two pilots killed after PAF training aircraft crashes

TWO PAKISTAN Army pilots were killed on Monday after their training aircraft crashed due to a technical fault, army said. "(At) midday, a Mushshak training aircraft of Pakistan Army Aviation crashed near Nawan Killi, Quetta, due to technical fault," army said. Both pilots, Major Husnain Shehzad Humayun, the instructor, and Captain Abdul Samad, a student, died in the "unfortunate crash," it added. PTI

• LAW

Jantar Mantar de-notified: What courts have said about designating protest sites

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, October 12

THE DELHI Police on Monday de-notified Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site, naming Ramlila Maidan and Burari Ground in north Delhi and CBD Ground in east Delhi as alternatives.

According to the official notification, the decision follows a recommendation by a committee constituted by the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA). The move comes amid the Delhi police's heavy barricading and crackdown on protesters in central Delhi since October 10. Protesters have gathered at several locations, including outside areas where prohibitory orders have been imposed under Section 163 of the BNSS.

The designation of protest sites is intended to regulate demonstrations while addressing concerns over traffic, public safety, and residents' rights.

Who decides Delhi's protest sites?

Article 19 of the Indian Constitution guarantees the fundamental rights to freedom of speech and expression, and to assemble peaceably, subject to reasonable restrictions — including in the interests of "public order".

Unlike other states, Delhi's police and public order fall outside the powers of the Delhi Assembly. Under Article 239AA(3)(a), the Legislative Assembly has the power to make laws for NCT Delhi except on three issues: public order, police, and land.

The Delhi Police thus function under the MHA. The police regulate demonstrations, including applications for permission and compliance with conditions governing designated sites. Organisers had to apply 10 days in advance to protest at Jantar Mantar, which had a cap of 1,000 people. Ramlila Maidan was another designated site, with a capacity of around 50,000 people.

Law and order vs 'public order'

While the police often cite law and order when regulating protests, Article 19 permits restrictions on fundamental rights on specified grounds, including "public order". The Supreme Court has treated them differently.

In the 1966 SC ruling of *Ram Manohar Lohia v. State of Bihar*, the court observed that an act may affect law and order without affecting public order. It described law and order, public order, and security of the state as three concentric circles, with public order occupying a narrower category.

"Law and order represent the largest circle within which is the next circle representing public order and the smallest circle represents security of State. It is then easy to see that an act may affect law and order but not public order, just as an act may affect public order but not security of the State," it said.

In *Re: Ramlila Maidan Incident* (2012), the court said a restriction imposed to maintain law and order "would be least intruding into the guaranteed freedom", while public order "may qualify for a greater degree of restriction" since it was of greater social concern. The court clarified that "every breach of peace may not always lead to public disorder."

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan explained that law and order issues can involve localised disturbances, such as two people fighting on a street. Public order, he said, concerns disturbances that affect the wider community, such as large-scale disruption of transport.

"Law and order is not a valid basis to limit the right to speech and expression," he said, adding that the police cannot invoke public order on their own to justify restricting fundamental rights. "The first step is a law needs to be made which gives police that power. Then the police exercise the power under that law," he said, adding that the police must identify the law under which they are exercising their powers.

Professor G Mohan Gopal told *The Indian Express* that dissent is the "lifeblood of a peaceful and law-abiding society" and democracy exists to accommodate different opinions. He added that shutting down designated protest sites and suppressing peaceful dissent under "law and order" grounds risks driving citizens to desperation, "because all the legitimate channels, democratic channels for defending the public order based on democracy have been closed".

How can protest sites be designated?

The bench in *Himat Lal K. Shah v. Commissioner of Police, Ahmedabad* (1972), held that the police could require prior permission for public meetings on streets. But it added that the State "cannot by law abridge or take away the right of assembly by prohibiting assembly on every public street or public place".

In *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India* (2018), the case pertained to restrictions on demonstrations at Jantar Mantar and moving them to Ramlila Maidan. The petitioners argued that the ground would be too far from the "concentration of 'power'" in New Delhi, and would impact the protests' goals, concerning the very authorities the slogans are raised against.

While the court accepted that contention, it underlined the need to balance the rights of protesters with those of residents and held that "while regulating such demonstrations in public interest, particular areas can be earmarked". It thus allowed a limited portion of Jantar Mantar Road to remain open for regulated demonstrations, noting that the site had been used for protests for a considerable period.

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to
explained@indianexpress.com

• TECHNOLOGY

IndiGo scare: When do power banks catch fire?

Ishika Gupta
Mumbai, October 12

A CHENNAI-BOUND IndiGo flight was forced to make an emergency landing at Hyderabad airport on Sunday after a passenger's power bank caught fire mid-air. The cabin filled with smoke before the crew extinguished the fire.

A similar incident occurred in May on an IndiGo flight. The incidents have raised concerns over the safety and potential risks posed by power banks during flights.

Why did the power banks catch fire?

Power banks typically contain multiple lithium cobalt oxide (LCO) or lithium-ion battery cells, many of which may be low-quality, poorly manufactured, or even recycled. Experts say these batteries are highly energy-dense and vulnerable to overheating and combustion under certain conditions. When substituted with low-quality counterfeit cells, power banks exhibit manufacturing defects, which might be the most probable cause of the incident Sunday, said Sagar Mitra, professor at IIT Bombay.

There are other reasons, too. "Aircraft typically experience a slight jolt during landing, which may have caused a mechanical vibration in the power bank. Combined with a fully charged LCO battery, this could have triggered an internal short circuit, eventually leading to the fire," Mitra said about the May incident.

Internal leakages between a battery's positive and negative terminals and manufacturing defects can also trigger such incidents. Certain user habits can exacerbate the risk. "Many people unknowingly overexpose their power bank to higher temperatures or overcharge their power banks or continue using damaged devices, which can make them unsafe," said Vivek Panchal, MD of battery manufacturer Powertron.

Generally, the power bank's state-of-charge should be kept at 80%. Charging it to maximum capacity should be avoided to reduce stress on the battery cells and extend their storage life.

• GLOBAL INCIDENTS

- In June 2024, a passenger's power bank exploded aboard an Air Arabia flight from Abu Dhabi to Kozhikode, triggering panic among passengers.
- A fire linked to a portable power bank in March 2025 severely damaged a South Korean aircraft before take-off.

What do the rules say?

Most airlines in India prohibit passengers from carrying power banks in check-in baggage. Such devices, however, are generally permitted in cabin baggage under prescribed limits. "Keeping them in the cabin ensures that crew members can immediately detect and contain any potential fire," said aviation expert Jai Rao. In contrast, if a battery fire were to occur in the cargo hold, it would be significantly more difficult to access, he added.

After several such incidents globally, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation in November 2025 issued an advisory prohibiting passengers from using or charging power banks during flights. It also barred passengers from storing power banks in overhead bins, citing concerns over a delay in emergency response during a fire.

What should passengers keep in mind?

Apart from combustion risks, overheating is a major issue associated with power banks. Most modern power banks are equipped with an inbuilt cut-off feature, which protects against overcharging, excessive discharge, and overheating while monitoring battery health.

Consumers should prioritise battery life cycle, cell quality, and warranty during purchase. Visible swelling, leakage, unusual odours, or excessive heating are also warning signs.



• NOBEL PRIZE IN ECONOMICS 2026

How to keep an economy stable using policy tools

The Great Depression prompted policymakers to advocate government intervention in economic crises. Hall and Woodford's work refines that idea



UDIT MISRA

THE ROYAL Swedish Academy of Sciences has awarded the Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel 2026 — commonly called the Economics Nobel — to two American economists: Robert E Hall of Stanford University and Michael Woodford of Columbia University. They will share the prize money of 12 million Swedish kronor (approximately Rs 12 crore).

What have they been awarded for?

The official citation states they have received the award "for microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation". Macroeconomic stabilisation refers to policies that governments and central banks use to "stabilise" an economy.

For instance, the Reserve Bank of India last week raised interest rates with a view to contain inflation. Inflation in India has been going up owing to a rise in crude oil prices and prices of other commodities in the wake of the US-Iran war, the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, etc. There are also worries that inflation will rise further because deficient rainfall and higher temperatures due to El Niño may hurt food production and push up food prices.

If the government and the central bank followed the dictum that the government should not intervene and that the markets will price things correctly on their own, inflation can potentially soar quite high. That would hurt most Indians, since they are not rich enough to handle such a situation. It could lead to people cutting down all other expenses to focus on the essentials, which would cause many businesses to fail and lots of job losses. The economy, as a whole, may take a much longer time to recover.

But an RBI intervention could stabilise the path in such a manner that the situation never becomes as dire as it could become if nothing was done.

Similarly, over the past few years, the Union government has been cutting taxes — both direct taxes (personal income tax and corporate tax) and indirect taxes (GST) — with a view to boost consumption by individuals and investments by companies. That's because in the years leading up to and during the Covid-19 pandemic (and resulting lockdowns), India's economy struggled.

Through tax cuts, the government tried to boost economic activity — the RBI also helped in those years by cutting interest rates. Without such interventions, a recovery might have taken much longer.

These are the examples of macroeconomic "stabilisation" policies that academics such as Hall and Woodford helped refine through their work.

To understand the "microeconomic foundations" of these macro policies, one has to understand the trigger for their work.

What is their contribution?

A crash in the stock markets in October 1929 marked the start of the Great Depression in the US. As the days and months rolled by, the US gross domestic product — the value of annual output — fell by 30% and the unemployment rate soared to 25%.

Thousands of banks and businesses went under. The crisis reverberated through the world, especially affecting Europe.

• 'For microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation'



Developed new macroeconomic models, leading to policies that reduced the economy's peaks and troughs.

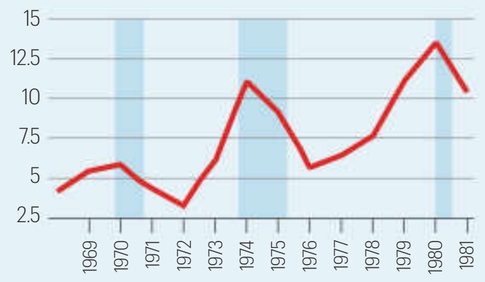


ROBERT E HALL, 83
Stanford University, U.S.



MICHAEL WOODFORD, 71
Columbia University, U.S.

Inflation, consumer prices for the US (%)



SOURCE: WORLD BANK SHADED AREAS INDICATE U.S. RECESSIONS

Unemployment Rate (%)



SOURCE: U.S. BUREAU OF LABOR STATISTICS

Demand and supply

Hall focused on the demand side of the economy: how do people decide how much they would consume, and when and how do they choose to raise or cut consumption.

•

Woodford's work focused on the supply side: how firms behaved and took decisions such as changing prices.

The dominant policy paradigm leading up to the Great Depression was that governments should not intervene, letting markets resolve through forces of demand and supply instead. But the widespread devastation made everyone rethink.

British economist John Maynard Keynes provided a solution that seemed to work: Governments and central banks should "stabilise" the economy through policy interventions. When growth is slow (and unemployment high), policymakers should cut interest rates and taxes, and the governments should spend more even at the cost of borrowing money itself and having a budget deficit, thus incentivising economic activity.

When the economy starts overheating and the inflation rate starts rising fast, the policymakers should slow down the economy by policies like raising interest rates. Thus, government intervention could save economies from suffering from wild fluctuations.

This broad policy formula worked until the experience of the 1970s. As the *charts* show, this was a decade when economies faced high inflation and high unemployment both at the same time, thanks to repeated oil price shocks. Efforts to boost a slowing economy only spiked inflation. Efforts to contain inflation further worsened unemployment. The situation became so bad (shaded areas in the *charts* show recessions) that the Keynesian recipe of government intervention was seen as the problem, not the solution.

Through their work from the late 1970s onwards, Hall and Woodford revitalised the Keynesian approach by making it grounded in research. Keynes had assumed a linear or straight relationship between variables such as inflation and unemployment, and consumption and production. Hall and Woodford started studying the ground-level data.

Hall focused on the demand side of the economy: questions such as, how do people decide how much they would consume, and when and how do they choose to raise or cut consumption. A better understanding of these, based on household data, has informed policy choices.

For instance, in 1982, he used microdata for a number of individual households to arrive at the insight that not everyone in the economy increases consumption based on income and future expectations; households that are living hand-to-mouth do not follow that assumption.

Woodford's work focused on the supply side: how firms behaved and took decisions such as changing prices. The assumption is that markets find the ideal price based on supply and demand, but businesses don't change prices everyday. He found that businesses look to the future when fixing prices. This means that expectations about future interest rates are important for inflation. In turn, this had a tremendous policy implication: Central banks must clearly convey what they intend to do, which is important for firms when they fix prices.

What is its significance?

Over the past few years, the global economy has faced an exceptional number of risks and challenges: from a global pandemic that brought all economic activity to a sudden halt, to a growing number of wars that have spiked prices of essential commodities, to policy missteps like tariffs.

And yet, far from a recession, the economic growth continues to surprise on the upside. A big reason why policymakers worldwide have been able to avoid worse outcomes is because their policies are informed by the work of academics such as Hall and Woodford.

• CULTURE

Garba in Gujarat: From dancing in villages to multi-crore enterprise

Ritu Sharma
Ahmedabad, October 12

THE NINE nights of the Navratri festival, marked by dancing the Garba to welcome the goddess Ambe Maa, began in Gujarat on Sunday.

Navratri and Garba

Garba, inscribed on the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity by UNESCO in December 2023, is the devotional ritual dance once performed only by women in their homes and in temple courtyards during Navratri. Over the past few decades, Garba has crossed geographical and cultural boundaries.

In Gujarat itself, Navratri is a multi-crore economic phenomenon that has been taking new forms every season. There are theme-based Navratri nights; there has been a resurgence of the traditional form of 'mandli' and 'sheri' Garba, "sustainable and eco-friendly" Garbas, as well as events dedicated to pet animals. The dancing happens in venues from open grounds to humongous air-conditioned domes.

While Garba can be performed at any celebration or happy occasion, the Navratri Garba is Gujarat's true community celebration. Social groups, *Yuvak Mandals*, apartment complexes, event planners, and clubs in cities all organise Garba nights. The accompanying musicians can range from a single *dholi* (drummer) to large ensembles.



Garba rehearsals in Ahmedabad on Saturday night. EXPRESS

How it started, evolved

Prof Parul Shah, former dean and head (dance), at the Faculty of Performing Arts, Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda in Vadodara, said the word '*Garbo*' or '*Garba*' comes from the Sanskrit word '*Garbhdeep*', which refers to an earthen pot with circular holes, and is popularly known as '*Garbo*'.

"There isn't a clear date for the beginning of Garba, but the celebration is associated with both the dynasties that ruled Gujarat and with the peasantry and agricultural classes. Singing and dancing with the flute and other musical instruments as part of dance forms like Garba, Garbi, and Raas, and variations such as dandia or the 'stick raas', is believed to date back to the age of Lord Krishna," Shah said.

"Then, with the establishment of the Ambaji Shaktipeeth around 700 years ago, people started worshipping the goddess through the Garba. The earthen pot is a symbol of the human body, and the lamp inside signifies the divine soul. The festival is dedicated to the worship of the feminine energy or *Shakti*," Shah, who was among the experts who prepared the dossier for the nomination for the UNESCO designation, said. "Women would do the *sthapana* (installation) of Mataji in the chowk of their village temple, do *aarti*, and dance the Garba," Shah said.

Living heritage

- Garba was inscribed on the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity by UNESCO in December 2023.

The antiquity of Garba songs is difficult to establish precisely, Shah said. In the 20th century, Garbas were mainly passed down through generations of women in families and communities, she said. The artisans who craft Garba objects also pass on their skills orally and through practice.

Ghazal singer Atul Brahmbhatt, whose father Jitu Bhagat started the Sri Jitu Bhagat Satsang Mandali in Ahmedabad in 1949, told *The Indian Express* that his father was initially criticised for participating in an activity that was traditionally the preserve of women.

Atul said Jitu was influenced by the Vallabh and Dhola brothers who are credited with having written the 118-paragraph '*Anand no Garbo*', sung even today. "My father wrote hundreds of Garbas. Since there was no recording, devotees would memorise them and go back to their villages to sing," Atul said.

Changing Garba events

"Garba has been redefined by every generation through new performative styles, contemporary lyrics, and changing fashion trends, while keeping the circle of feminine energy or *Shakti* intact. It remains a living tradition," Prof Shah said.

However, some old-timers who see Garba as essentially an expression of devotion are put off by the modern commercial dimensions the celebration has acquired.

Then there is the increasingly visible presence of communal elements who have in recent years sought to associate themselves with Navratri.

A multi-crore celebration

The Navratri Garba celebrations are a massive economic enterprise — from the owners of party plots, planners of the event, choreographers, and providers of sound and light systems, to those involved in the food industry, and the artisanal community of potters, blacksmiths, and carpenters. Then there is the cloth and jewellery industry.

Many schools and universities offer professional courses in dance and music, costume and ornament design, landscape planning, and sound and light design, which contribute to Garba creations.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



MAJ AK BHATTACHARJEE, SM

This historic day fills our hearts with pride and sorrow alike when in the highest traditions of the Indian Army, you laid down your life in general area of Dospur, Gurdaspur (PUNJAB). World is a lesser place without you but we know that you are with the gods above and even heavens have improved by your gracious presence.

FONDLY REMEMBERED BY
CO AND ALL RANKS OF 3 RAJPUT

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officers on their Balidan Diwas.



SI MURALIDHAR SENNWAL, PPMG 142 BN BSF 05.03.1952 – 13.10.2003



HEAD CONSTABLE DHIRAJ SINGH 102 BN BSF 01.01.1965 – 13.10.2003



HEAD CONSTABLE RANBIR SINGH 17 BN BSF 04.01.1971 – 13.10.2013



CONSTABLE AMIT KUMAR 115 BN BSF MARTYRED ON – 13.10.2022



CONSTABLE GURUDAYAL SINGH 128 BN BSF 02.03.1970 – 13.10.1996



CONSTABLE/ DRIVER BABU LAL 153 BN BSF 02.04.1964 – 13.10.1992



CONSTABLE TEHASELDAR SINGH, PPMG 24 BN BSF 08.06.1970 – 13.10.1992

SASHASTRA SEEMA BAL



CT(GD) Gammar Angu

"Sashastra Seema Bal" fondly remembers the bravery and sacrifice of CT(GD) Gammar Angu of the 12th Battalion, SSB, who laid down his life for the Nation. On this day, he attained martyrdom in a courageous counter attack against militants near Jawahar Market, Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir. His valour, sacrifice and dedication to duty will always be remembered and will continue to inspire the generations to come.

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)



ITBP salutes its braveheart Second-in-Command Ansuya Prasad Kuniyal of 44th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Karnataka in 2011.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Lance Naik Sukh Pal Singh **14 Bn** 5-3-1965 To 13-10-1998

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Sukh Pal Singh of 14 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering an ambush by insurgents in Tripura, on 13 October 1998. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable V. K. Rameshan **58 Bn** 21-5-1966 To 13-10-1987

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable V. K. Rameshan of 58 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 13 October 1987 after succumbing to grievous injuries sustained while valiantly countering an ambush by LTTE rebels in Sri Lanka on 10 October 1987. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Ram Niwash **75 Bn** 1-7-1969 To 13-10-1991

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Ram Niwash of 75 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while valiantly fighting against terrorists in dist. Tarn Taran, Punjab, on 13 October 1991. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable R.M. Perumal **42 Bn** 4-6-1968 To 13-10-2003



Veer Balidani Constable B. Sree Kumar **42 Bn** 30-4-1976 To 13-10-2003



Veer Balidani Constable K.S.Prakash **42 Bn** 1-1-1971 To 13-10-2003

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to three valiant troopers of 42 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice when their vehicle came under the impact of an IED blast triggered by ATTF extremists in Tripura, on 13 October 2003. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

Government of Tamil Nadu
TAMILNADU HORTICULTURE DEVELOPMENT AGENCY (TANHODA)
3rd Floor, Agriculture Complex,
O/o the Directorate of Horticulture and Plantation Crops,
Chepauk, Chennai- 600 005.

MI1/5060/2026 Dated: 09.10.2026

Invitation for Registration

The Managing Director, Tamil Nadu Horticulture Development Agency (TANHODA) Chepauk, Chennai-5 invites application for "Registration of Micro Irrigation Firms for Installation of Drip and Sprinkler Irrigation System."

For further information, the eligible Micro Irrigation Firms may visit the URL: https://tnhorticulture.tn.gov.in:8080/ and download the application form for Registration. The application with all the required documents should reach this office on or before **20.11.2026** by 5.00 PM.

DIPR / 881 / Display / 2026

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala- 147001
Phone No.-96461-18774, Email id:-scmeteringpatiala@gmail.com
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033813 **Website:** www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry No. MQP-275/2026-27/PO(M) **dated 09.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/Metering, C-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites e-tender for Procurement of LT Ring Type. Resin cast, Metering Current Transformers (CTs) of ratio 400/5A, of Accuracy Class-0.5S conforming to IS: 16227 Part-I & II.

For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 09.10.2026, 11:00 AM onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**.

No. 16083/PB **C-970/26**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. Dy CE/Br/L/AGC/ROB-1343/3 Date : 11.10.2026

PUBLIC NOTIFICATION

It is hereby informed to the General Public that the reconstruction work of the Kheria Mod Road Over Bridge (ROB 1343/3) under the Agra Division has been scheduled. For this reconstruction work, the Railway Administration will completely close all road traffic for the next 90 days, starting from **13.10.2026** at **09:00** AM. To ensure railway and public safety while maintaining smooth traffic flow during the closure, alternative routes have been arranged. Road traffic will be diverted through routes such as Arjun Nagar Tiraha to Barah Khamba Double Phatak route (L.C. 75).The general public is requested to cooperate in this highly essential work being undertaken for safety purposes.

Dy. Chief Engineer/Bridge/Line
2323/26 (PH) **North Central Railway, Agra**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
RWS&S DIVISION, JAGATSINGHPUR
Tel. No.06724-223485
mail-rwssjspur@gmail.com

25001/1309/2627

Cancellation Notice

Letter No. 2837 **Date.07.10.26**

This corrigendum has been made against this office tender invited Online vide TCN No. 29 of 2026-27 with letter No. 2495 / dt. 07.09.2026. The following Tendering works with Sl.No. 1 is hereby cancelled due to unavoidable circumstances. All other terms and condition remains unaltered.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
OIPR-25001/25024/1/26-27/0005 **RWS&S Division, Jagatsinghpur**

Office of the Superintending Engineer, Uttarakhand Jal Sansthan
Jal Bhawan Tehsil Road Near Akashwani Pauri Garwhal, 246001
E-mail:-ujs.sepauri@gmail.com Ph No:-+91-1368-222015 Fax No:-+91-1368-222015

Letter No. 485/E-Tender Notice/2026-27 **E-Tender Notice** Date 12.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID FOR: SRINAGAR RE- ORGANISATION DRINKING WATER PUMPING SUPPLY SCHEME UNDER WORLD Uttarakhand efficient Water Supply Programme (eWSP). (Through E- Procurement Portal only - www.uktenders.gov.in)

On Behalf of Chief General Manager, Uttrakhand Jal Sansthan, Pauri invites Bids from eligible Bidders for SRINAGAR RE- ORGANISATION DRINKING PUMPING WATER SUPPLY SCHEME UNDER WORLD BANK Water Supply Scheme Block KHIRSHU District Pauri, under World Bank funded Uttarakhand efficient Water Supply Programme (eWSP) through E-Procurement Portal as per the following details:

S. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs. In Lac)	Construction / Commissioning & Trial Run/O&M Period	Cost of Document
1	SRINAGAR RE-ORGANISATION DRINKING PUMPING WATER SUPPLY SCHEME UNDER WORLD BANK)	Rs.5592.37 work cost + 652.06 O&M work Total 6244.43 Lac (With GST)	18 Months (Completion Period) +6 Months (Trial & run)+84 Months(O&M) work	Rs.5000+ 18% GST Rs.900= Rs.5900.00

Note: Further detail visit E-Procurement Portal-www.uktenders.gov.in **Superintending Engineer**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA **TENDER NOTICE**

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	DHBVN HISAR	ENGAGEMENT OF AN AGENCY FIRM FOR THE UPGRADATION REPLACEMENT OF ENTERPRISE IDENTITY & ACCES MANAGEMENT IDAM SOLUTION NIT TER 16 IT IDAM SOLOUTION	09.10.2026 10.11.2026	9 CRORES (INC. GST)	www.dhbvn.org.in	01662223194 etorapdrp@dhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 50096/HRY

Reform ARC LIMITED (Formerly known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited)
Authorised Office: 2nd Floor, ICC Chamber-II, Saki Vihar Road, Near MTNL Office, Powai, Mumbai, Maharastra-400072.

POSSESSION NOTICE
(for immovable properties)
See Rule 8(1)

Whereas, The Authorised Officer of **REFORM ARC LIMITED** (Formerly Known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited) acting in its capacity as **Trustee of RARC 071-TRANCHE 1 Trust vide Agreement dated 31/03/2022** under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a **demand notice dated 22/08/2022** calling upon the borrower and guarantors in **Loan Account Number - 250138000008 (Client ID-RARC9628),** to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice.

The borrower and guarantors having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and guarantors and the public in general that the undersigned has **taken Symbolic possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under section 13(4) of the said Act read with rule 8 of the said Act on **09/10/2026.**

The borrowers and guarantors in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to the charge of **REFORM ARC LIMITED (Formerly Known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited)** for the amount and interest thereon.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of Sub-Section 8 of Section-13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

S. No.	Borrowers / Guarantors	Description of the Property Mortgaged	Amount O/s
1	**1. Mr Harender Singh,S/o. Harishchandra Managharhi,** Kaipur, Mathura, Uttarpradesh-280201. **2. Mahashay Harish Chandra Shiksha Samiti.**Village- Managharhi, Khaipur, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, Pin Code-281201, **And Also At-** S.D. Public School, Village- Managharhi, Khaipur, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, Pin Code-281201, **3.Saroj W/O. Harishchandra,** Managharhi, Khaipur, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, Pin Code-281201. **4.Neelam.W/O Harendra Singh,** Managharhi, Khaipur, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, Pin Code-28120	All that piece and parcel of School comprised in on Khata No. 343, Khasra No. 550, Rakva 3.372 Hectare Mauja Managadi, Tehsil Mant, District Mathura, Uttar Pradesh	**Rs.29,55,705.75/-** (Twenty Nine Lakh Fifty Five Thousand Seven Hundred Five and Seventy Five Paise Only) **out-standing as on 21.09.2026**

Place: District Mathura, Uttar Pradesh **Sd/- Authorized Officer,**
Date: 09/10/2026 **REFORM ARC LIMITED (Formerly Known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited)**

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER,
PROJECTS JPDCL
Mohinder Mansion, Satellite Colony near Wave Mall, Bhatindi road, Jammu, J&K.
Telephone No.: 0191-2493853

No: - CE/PJ/
Date:- .10.2026

E-Notice Inviting Tender

For and on behalf of Lieutenant Governor of Jammu & Kashmir Union Territory, Chief Engineer Projects, Jammu Power Distribution Corporation Limited, Mohinder Mansion, Satellite Colony near Wave Mall, Bhatindi road, Jammu invites e-tenders/offers from eligible firms/contractors for development of Distribution Infrastructure in Electric Division-Kathua Urban (S/D Heera Nagar & Kathua) and Electric Division-Kathua Rural (S/D Billawar, Basohli & Ramkote) of JAMMU Province under the Revamped Reforms-based and Results-linked, Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS)

S. No.	Scope of Work	Completion Period	Cost of work Rs (Crs)	Cost of tender document (Rs.)	Date of opening of Techno-commercial bid
1.	e-NIT NO. CE/PJ/JPDCL/RDSS/Kathua/Urban/04 OF 2026-27 for development of Distribution Infrastructure in Electric Division-Kathua Urban (S/D Heera Nagar & Kathua) of JAMMU Province under the Revamped Reforms-based and Results-linked, Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS)	As per SBD	239.60	30,000	06.11.2026 14:00 Hours.
2.	e-NIT NO. CE/PJ/JPDCL/RDSS/Kathua/Rural/05 OF 2026-27 for development of Distribution Infrastructure in Electric Division-Kathua Rural (S/D Billawar, Basohli & Ramkote) of JAMMU Province under the Revamped Reforms-based and Results-linked, Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS)	As per SBD	159.46	30,000	06.11.2026 14:00 Hours.

The bidding document can be downloaded from the website www.jktenders.gov.in from 13/10/2026: 1700 Hours to 04/11/2026 (1400 Hours).
Date of Pre bid meeting: 19/10/2026 at 1400 Hours in the office of CE Projects-JPDCL.
Bids submission is in electronic format on the website **www.jktenders.gov.in** from 22/10/2026 (12:00 Hours) to 04/11/2026 (14:00 Hours).
Last date for submission of Hard copies of tender fee: 06/11/2026 up to 1200 Hours.

Chief Engineer
DIP NO. DIP/J-2523-P/26 DATE: 12.10.2026 **Projects JPDCL Jammu**

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-I, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

1	**Name of work**	Upgradation of Yard Loop Line work under ADEN/PNP.
2	**Approx cost of work**	Rs. 75,17,844.59 (Rupees Seventy Five lakh Seventeen Thousand eight Hundred Forty Four and Fifty Nine Paise Only)
3	**Earnest Money to be deposited**	Rs. 1,50,400.00/- (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousand Four Hundred Only)
4	**Cost of tender document**	Rs. 0.00/-
5	**Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender**	03.11.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
6	**Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen**	**www.ireps.gov.in**
7	**Allocation**	04-211-32

• The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for participating in the e-tender system.
• For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. **No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/50/2026-27/W-I Dated :- 12.10.2026** **3550/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Paras S/o Ganesh R/o WZ-326, Tihar Village, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 44/2021 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Paras** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Paras** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Paras** of case **FIR No. 44/2021 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
West, Court No. 206
DP/14503/WD/2026 (Court Matter) **Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

उ० प्र० पावर ट्रॉसमिशन कारपोरेशन लि०, विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल आगरा, जैम / ई-निविदा सूचना दिनांक 12.10.2026 निविदा संख्या एंव कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण : 1 निविदा संख्या टी-50/वि.पा.म. (आ.) / 2026-27 / जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8128920 विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल आगरा के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न 765 के०वी.,400 के0वी0, 220 के0वी0 एवं 132 के०वी० उपकेन्द्रों पर सुरक्षा प्रहरी एवं शसस्त्र सुरक्षा प्रहरी रखे जाने हेतु धरोहर धनराशि रू. 6,50,000.00 मात्र निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 17.10.2026 समय 16.00 बजे । 2. निविदा संख्या टी-51/ वि.पा.म. (आ.) / 2026-27/ जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8142488 विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल आगरा हेतु (O&M मद के तहत) 01 नग सुविधानजक स्टाफ कार मय ड्राइवर के (टेक्सी कोटे में) 12 माह के लिये उपलब्ध कराये जाने सम्बन्धी कार्य धरोहर धनराशि रू0 5140.00 मात्र निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 20.10.2026 समय 15.00 बजे । 3. निविदा संख्या टी- 52/ वि.पा.म. (आ.) / 2026-27 / जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8142486 विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल आगरा के अन्तर्गत (O&M मद के तहत) विभिन्न कार्यालय हेतु 03 नग डीजल चालित वाहन मय ड्राइवर के (टेक्सी कोटे मे) 12 माह के लिये उपलब्ध कराये जाने सम्बन्धी कार्य धरोहर धनराशि रू0 14,000,00 मात्र निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 20.10.2026 समय 15.00 बजे । 4. ई-निविदा संख्या टी-53/ वि.पा.म. (आ.) / 2026-27 विद्युत पारेषण खण्ड-द्वितीय आगरा के क्षेत्रान्तर्गत (O&M मद के तहत) 132 के.वी. फाउन्ड्रीनगर-ताज लाइन एंव 33 के.वी. यमुना बैंक फीडर पर 02 अदद न्यूमेरिकल बेकअप रिले को बदलने सम्बन्धी कार्य हेतु निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रू0 590.00 (जी.एस.टी. सहित) एंव धरोहर धनराशि रू0 3,000,00 मात्र निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 06.11.2026 समय 12.00 बजे । विस्तृत जानकारी एंव प्रपत्र जैम पोर्टल की बेबसाइट www.gem.gov.in एंव ई-टेण्डर की बेबसाइट www.etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। अग्रेतर समस्त सूचनाएँ बेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जायेगी । अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल, आगरा "राष्ट्र हित में बिजली बचायें" **पत्रांक**-3137 **विपाम (आ) / दिनांक** 12/10/2026

GOVERNMENT OF NCT OF DELHI
Delhi Subordinate Services Selection Board (D.S.S.S.B)
FC-18, INSTITUTIONAL AREA, KARKARDOOMA, DELHI-110092
Website: https://dsssb.delhi.gov.in

No.F.1(451)/P&P/DSSSB/2026/Advt./5136 **Dated: 09.10.2026**

VACANCY NOTICE
ADVERTISEMENT NO. 05/2026

Online Applications are invited from the eligible candidates for the posts of Sweeper/Safai Karamchari and Chowkidar under District & Sessions Courts as detailed below: -

Total number of Post Codes /Vacancies	**02 Post Codes/25 Vacancies**
Date of Commencement of Online Applications	**13th October, 2026**
Last date of Online Application Submission	**11th November, 2026**

The eligible candidates are advised to visit DSSSB's website **https://dsssb.delhi.gov.in/dsssb-vacancies** to check the detailed advertisement and confirm their eligibility for the above vacancies based on the Recruitment Rules of the indenting department. Candidates must apply online through the website **https://dsssbonline.nic.in/**. The closing date for submission of online application is up to 11/11/2026 (Till 11:00 PM) after which the link will be disabled.

To Download Advertisement, Scan

Sd/-
Deputy Secretary (P&P)
DIP/SHABDARTH/CLASSIFIED/0251/26-27

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER P.W.D. Division Budni Distt - SEHORE (M.P.)
Main Road Budni Distt - Sehore Tel No. 07564-235305

NIT No. 10/2026-27/SAC/Budni **Date 09.10.2026**

Notice Invite Tender

Online Tenders for below-mentioned work have been processed on E-Procurement system of Public Works Department on the Portal **https://mptenders.gov.in** Tenders details are as below :-

S. No	System Tender ID	Type of Work	Name of the work	PAC (In Rs. lacs)	Earnest money deposit (In Rs.)	Time Allowed	Call	EMD & Tender Related Other Document
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	2026_PWDR - B_542217_1	B.T. Renuwal	B.T. Renewal of Salkanpur Devi Mandir Approch Road Length 4.20 Km	100.12	100120.00	03 Month Excluding rainy season	II	All Tender related documents and E.M.D will be accepted online only
2	2026_PWDR - B_542218_1	B.T. Renuwal	B.T. Renewal of Obedullaganj Rehti (MP-MDR-32-13) Road (Length= 14.9Km)	354.42	354420.00	04 Month Excluding rainy season	I	
3	2026_PWDR - B_542219_1	Building Mainte-nance Work	Govt. Residencial and Non Residencial Building Maintenance Work under P.W.D. Sub Division Bhairunda	19.90	39800.00	09 Month Excluding rainy season	I	
			Maximum Amount 354.42 Lakhs					

The document can only be purchased online from the above website after making online payment. The last date & time for purchase of Document (Document Download/Sale End Date) on line is Dated 28.10.2026 up to (17:30.) Detailed NIT and other details can be viewed on the above mentioned portal. Amendments to NIT, if any, would be published on website only, and not in newspaper.

With Refrence to the order of Engineer-in-Chief PWD Bhopal vide Letter NO 401/sa/E-tenderring/09/1088/ Bhopal, Dated 05/11/2020 in which All Tender related documents and E.M.D will be accepted online only.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
P.W.D. Division Budni(M.P.)
G-19928/26 **07564-235305**

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

Tender Notice No. e-Tender/2026/38. For and on behalf of President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur-721301 invites e-Tender for the following works **before 15:00 hrs.** on the date mentioned against items and will be **opened at 15:30 hrs. S.No.** 1. **Tender No. E-KGP-East-63-2026, Description of Work:** Howrah-Kharagpur & Santragachi - Amta Section: Removal of Shortfall for Divyangjans facility in short term & medium-term basis under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN/East/KGP. (2nd call). **Tender Value (₹):** 29388540.05; **Earnest Money (₹):** 587800.00; **Sl. No.** 2. **Tender No. E-KGP-South-36-2026, Description of Work:** Execution of TSR(P), CTR(S),TRP(P),TBR , TFR & Renewal of TWSET and glued joints under Sr.DEN/South/KGP. **Tender Value (₹):** 103903453.35; **Earnest Money (₹):** 2078100.00; **Sl. No.** 3. **Tender No. E-KGP-South-40-2026, Description of Work:** Provision of DC track circuit in parallel with existing MSDAC for dual detection in station yard under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/South/KGP. **Tender Value (₹):** 31023534.84; **Earnest Money (₹):** 620500.00; **Sl. No.** 4. **Tender No. E-KGP-South-42-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs work and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/BLS/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 9793438.52; **Earnest Money (₹):** 195900.00; **Sl. No.** 5. **Tender No. E-KGP-South-43-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs work and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/South/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 9815419.08; **Earnest Money (₹):** 196300.00; **Sl. No.** 6. **Tender No. E-KGP-WEST-44-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous P.Way (Zonal)/Track works for the period from 01.10.2026 to 30.9.2028 in the section of SSE/P.Way/MYD, SSE/P.Way/KAF and SSE/P.Way/KGP under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 83672804.46; **Earnest Money (₹):** 1673500.00; **Sl. No.** 7. **Tender No. E-KGP-WEST-45-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous P.Way (Zonal)/Track works for the period from 01.10.2026 to 30.9.2028 in the section of SSE/P.Way/JGM, SSE/P.Way/GII and SSE/P.Way/GUD under the jurisdiction of ADEN/JGM for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 46805672.72; **Earnest Money (₹):** 936100.00; **Sl. No.** 8. **Tender No. E-KGP-WEST-42-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 12425820.64; **Earnest Money (₹):** 248500.00; **Sl.No.** 9. **Tender No. E-KGP-WEST-43-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/JGM for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 10133555.72; **Earnest Money (₹):** 202700.00; **Sl. No.** 10. **Tender No. E-KGP-HQ-52-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Tamluk for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 9709983.72; **Earnest Money (₹):** 194200.00; **Sl. No.** 11. **Tender No. E-KGP-HQ-53-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of SSE(W)/South/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 7651144.00; **Earnest Money (₹):** 153000.00; **Sl. No.** 12. **Tender No. E-KGP-HQ-54-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of SSE(W)/South-West/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 7460858.08; **Earnest Money (₹):** 149200.00; **Sl. No.** 13. **Tender No. E-KGP-HQ-55-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of SSE(W)/North-East/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 5396240.44; **Earnest Money (₹):** 107900.00; **Sl. No.** 14. **Tender No. E-KGP-HQ-56-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of SSE(W)/North-West/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 5364472.84; **Earnest Money (₹):** 107300.00; **Sl. No.** 15. **Tender No. E-KGP-HQ-57-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of SSE(W)/West/KGP for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 5332705.24; **Earnest Money (₹):** 106700.00; **Sl. No.** 16. **Tender No. E-KGP-East-65-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Panskura for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 8799037.30; **Earnest Money (₹):** 176000.00; **Sl. No.** 17. **Tender No. E-KGP-East-66-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Santragachi for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 9926468.50; **Earnest Money (₹):** 198500.00; **Sl. No.** 18. **Tender No. E-KGP-East-67-2026, Description of Work:** Miscellaneous Civil petty repairs works and addressing the quarter complaints under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Shalimar for 2 years. **Tender Value (₹):** 8469060.62; **Earnest Money (₹):** 169400.00; **Sl. No.** 19. **Tender No. E-KGP-East-61-2026, Description of Work:** Execution of P-Way works in between Howrah - Kharagpur section - 1) TTR(CS+ CMSC) 63 sets 2)TRR(P) - 23.764 Tkm 3) Improvement of Sand Hump & Dead End under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/KGP. (2nd call). **Tender Value (₹):** 46096776.57; **Earnest Money (₹):** 921900.00; **Sl. No.** 20. **Tender No. E-KGP-East-62-2026, Description of Work:** Amta - Construction of New FOB 6.00 wide with Ramp connecting the connecting the circulating area to platform No. 1 & 2 at Amta station under the jurisdiction of Sr DEN East/KGP. **Tender Value (₹):** 26527436.89; **Earnest Money (₹):** 530600.00; **Tender Document Cost (₹):** 0.00 for Sl. No. 1 to 20, **Date of Opening:** 29.10.2026 (for Sl. No. 1), 03.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 2 to 18), 05.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 19 & 20); **Completion Period of the Work:** 06 Months (for Sl.No. 1), 12 Months (for Sl.No. 2, 3, 19, 20), 24 Months (for Sl.No. 4 to 18). **Bidding Start Date** for **Sl No. 1** from **15/10/2026** and **up to 15:00 hrs.** on **29/10/2026. Bidding Start Date** for **Sl No. 2 to 18** from **20/10/2026** and **up to 15:00 hrs.** on **03/11/2026. Bidding Start Date** for **Sl No. 19 to 20** from **22/10/2026** and **up to 15:00 hrs.** on **05/11/2026.** Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/descriptions/ specifications of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted. **N.B.:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit "**www.ireps.gov.in**" to participate in all tenders. **(PR-890)**

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Rehan Khan,S/O-Hamid Ali,R/o-H NO-662,A-Block,Gali No-10,20 Futa Road,Shri Ram Colony,Rajiv Nagar,Delhi-110094,Have Changed My Name To RIHAN KHAN. Permanently. 0040883080-2

I LOBSANG TSERING RECHUNG,S/O KANG RATO DRATSANG LAMA CAMP-2 (TATTILLI MUNDGOD) TIBETAN COLONY,MUNDGOD UTTARA KANNADA KARNATAKA-581411,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO,LOBSANG TSERING 0040883072-7

I, Pradeep Bhan Bhatnagar, residing at 503, 2nd Floor, Shakti Khand -IV, Indirapuram, I.E. Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, U.P. 201010, have changed the name of my minor son, Partth Bhan, aged 15 years (Date of Birth: 15.01.2011), to PARTTH BHATNAGARR by virtue of an affidavit dated 05.10.2026 sworn before the Notary Public. Henceforth, he shall be known as PARTTH BHATNAGARR for all future purposes. 0040882998-1

I,Kamal,w/o-Sunil Kumar Jain R/o.N-102,Aditya Mega City,vaibhav khand, Indirapuram,Ghaziabad.U.P-201014 have changed my name to Kamal Jain for all future purposes. 0040883067-5

I, Heeba Hilal D/O Hilal Ahmed Rather, R/o A-24, LAJPAT NAGAR-II, New Delhi, South Delhi, Delhi, 110024, have changed my name to Heeba Hilal Rather for all future Purposes. 0071065269-1

I,Deepak,S/o-Shiv Kumar,R/o-536,Gali No.1,A-Block,Mahalaxmi Enclave,Karawal Nagar,Delhi-110094,have changed my name to Deepak Rohilla.Deepak and Deepak Rohilla is one and the same person. 0040883063-1

I, HEMLATA DEVI JAIN , W/O BIJAY KUMAR JAIN R/O H NO-O 47 S/F, BLOCK -O LAJPAT NAGAR - 2 LAJPAT NAGAR SOTH DELHI 110024 have changed my name HEMLATA JAIN for all future purposes 0071065291-1

I,SUSHEEL TYAGI,S/O-VIJAY KUMAR TYAGI,R/O-86 SF NITI KHAND 1,INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD,UP-201014,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUSHEEL KUMAR TYAGI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0040883080-11

I Aakanksha D/O, Raj Kumar R/o House No. 97, First Floor, Sector 5, Gurgaon have changed my name to Aakanksha Dhawan. 0040883034-1

I, Tavish Agarwal,S/o Manish Aggarwal, Address-J-6/115, 2nd floor,rajouri garden - 110027, have changed my name to Tavish Aggarwal. 0040883090-1

I, Fauzia, W/o Gulam Sabir, R/o 2330, Sahani Bhawan, Kucha Chelan, Darya Ganj, Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Fauzia Parveen, for all purposes. 0040882973-4

I Aashwani Tyagi S/O, Raghuraj Singh Tyagi R/o H.no -90 Village Kakra Muradnagar Dist-Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh Pin Code. 201206 have changed my name to Ashwani Kumar Tyagi for all purpose 0040883029-1

I, ARPITA BANSAL D/o VIKAS BANSAL W/o NIKHIL GUPTA R/o HOUSE NO. B-6, OBEROI APARTMENT, 2 SHAM NATH MARG, CIVIL LINES, NORTH DELHI, CIVIL LINES, DELHI, 110054 have changed my name to ARPITA GUPTA for all purposes. 0071065272-1

I, Sachin Singh S/o Surender Singh R/o A-1/36, Madhu Vihar, Uttam Nagar,Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Sachin Singh Maher. 0040883080-4

I, Sreeraj. V S/o Vasudevan Nair R/o H No-619 Sec-9 A Gurugram-122001 have changed my name to Sreeraj Vasudevan Nair 0071065308-1

I, Gulam Qadir S/O Nanhe Miya R/o,B-276/5, Inder-Enclave Phase-I, Kirari Suleman-Nagar, Delhi-110086,have changed my-name to Gulam Kadir S/o Nanhen Miya. 0040883083-1

I,Roshanajaha Khatun,W/o-Shakil Ahmad,R/o-H-38A, 4th-floor,Abul Fazal Enclave-1,Jamia Nagar,New Delhi-110025,have changed my name Roshanajaha Khatun,to given name Roshan Surname Jahan,for all purpose 0040883063-3

I Jitendra S/o Sh.Dhani ram R/o E 2, Gali no 1, Subhash Nagar, Bhajanpura, North Ghonda, Delhi 110053. That in my marksheet my mother name mention as Tulsi Devi which is incorrect. Actual name of my mother is Tulsa Devi. 0071065294-1

I,Girish Tewani,S/O-Late.Thanwar Dass Tewani,R/O-House no-368A Second floor Chirag Delhi New Delhi -110017,have changed my name to GIRISH KUMAR TEWANI Permanently 0040883072-2

I, Sarika Verma d/o Madan Chopra r/o D-6/326, First Floor, Sector-6, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name as SARIKA CHOPRA permanently. 0040882971-1

I, ANKUR S/o Samir Parcha, 1806/52, Naiwala, Karol Bagh, Delhi-05 have changed my name to ANKUR PARCHA. 0071065342-1

I, Priyanka Verma,W/o -Nishant Verma, HOUSE NO- C-12, U.G.F. CHATTARPUR, ENCLAVE PHASE-2, South Delhi, 110074, have changed my name to Priyanka. 0040883090-3

I ISRAR AHMAD,S/O-HANIF,R/O-OPPOSITE MASURI,THANA MASURI,DISTRICT GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201015,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO ISRAR ALI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040883080-6

I, PREM LAL CHAUDHRY S/O BALESHWAR CHAUDHARY, 4/391, STRRET NO-12, BHOLA NATH NAGAR, SHAHADARA, DELHI-32 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PREM LAL CHAUDHARY. 0071065335-1

I, Naseem Ahmed S/o Abdul Waheed Qureshi R/o,E-122, Abul Fazal-Enclave Part-II, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia-Nagar, Okhla,New Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Naseem Ahmad Qureshi. 0040883083-3

Drishya Shah, Madhuban Colony, Lohariyasal Talla, Behind Naman Mall, P.O. Haripur Nayak, Haldwani, Nainital,Uttarakhand - 263139. Change my name to Drishya D/o Mrs Pragita Joshi 0130070232-1

I, Daya Nand alias Bhulli S/o Amar Singh R/o 167/8-A, Sarai Jullena, New Delhi -110025, hereby declare that my name is mentioned in the LIC Policy as Bhulli. I further declare that Bhulli and Daya Nand one and the same person as per affidavit. for all future purposes. 0040882969-1

I,HIYA D/o Gagan Kumar Gaba R/o-Flat No.765, 6th-Floor Guru Apartment Rohini Sector-14 Delhi-110085 have changed my name to HIYA GABA. 0040883063-5

We Anju W/o Surender Singh and Surender Singh S/o Hardev Singh R/o 30,SFS Flats Ashok Vihar Phase-IV Delhi -110052, changed name of our minor Son Satvik to Satvik Dahiya. 0040883070-1

I, MAN MOHAN VASHISHTHA S/O SHIV CHARAN DAS R/O H.NO. 479/1450 MAIN LONI ROAD EAST JYOTI NAGAR SHAHDARA DELHI-110093 declare that my correct name is MAN MOHAN VASHISHTHA Which is wrongly printed as MAN MOHAN VASHISHT in my Passport. 0050299499-1

I,KISHOR TYAGI,S/O-JAI NARAYAN TYAGI,R/O-FLAT.NO-A-102,KDP GRAND SAVANNA,RAJ NAGAR EXTENSION, GHAZIABAD-201017,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO KISHOR KUMAR TYAGI FOR ALL PURPOSES 0040883072-4

I,SHARDA MATHEWS/SHARDA MATHEW W/O PETER METHEWS R/O C-61 VIKAS VIHAR KAKROLA MOR DWARKA DELHI-110078.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHARDA METHEWS. 0040883067-2

I, Ashok Sawhney S/o M L Sawhney R/o G-1202, Pan Oasis Society, Sector-70, Noida, UP-201301, have changed my name to ASHOK KUMAR SAWHNEY for all future purposes. 0071065265-1

I, Ajeet Singh S/o Sh. Nekiram R/o H.no 80 vill Singhola Po Narela Delhi 110040.Have changed my name from Ajit to Ajeet Singh for all purposes. 0071065282-1

I,VIDYANTI DEVI,W/O-VISHWAMITRA PANDEY,R/O-A-287,GALI.NO-6 PART-5,C.R. P. F CAMP,SONIA VIHAR NORTH EAST DELHI 110094 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO VIDHA WATI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040883080-8

I Vijayeta Chaudhary W/O Shri Pawan Kumar, Resident of E-126, Sector-9,New Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, Vijai Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201009, have changed my name from Vijayeta Chaudhary to Vijayeta. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Vijayeta for all future purposes. 0071065347-1

I Mohammad Kamil S/o Mohammad Shahid R/o Z-55-B DDA Flats, New Ranjeet-Nagar, New Delhi-110008, have changed my name to Mohd Kamil. 0040883083-5

I, Kamal Pandey, S/o N.C Pande, residing at 48, Medha Apartment, Mayur Vihar Ph I Ext, Delhi, have changed my name to Kamal Pande for all future purposes vide affidavit sworn before Notary Public Delhi on [8th October 2026]." IN-UP26195230122458Y 0050299521-1

I, Mohd Shoram, S/o Gulam Sabir, R/o 2330, Sahani Bhawan, Kucha Chelan, Darya Ganj, Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Mohammad Shorem, for all purposes. 0040882973-1

I,JASWEER KAUR @ KASHBIR KAUR W/o-Narinder Singh R/o-2162/24-Khampur main Patel-Road New Delhi-110008,both names belong to same person i.e.myself 0040883063-7

I, RITU VERMA W/o RISHIKESH VERMA R/o Tower-1/704, Panchsheel Pebbels, Sector-3, Vaishali, Ghaziabad(UP)-201010 have changed my name to RITU TRIPATHI. 0040883080-1

I Shehzad S/o Islamuddon R/o Z-41-B DDA Flats New Ranjeet Nagar New Delhi-110008, have changed name to Shahzad. 0040883083-6

I,GAGAN KUMAR S/o Madan Lal Gaba R/o Flat No.765, 6th-Floor Guru Apartment, Rohini Sector-14,Delhi-110085,have changed my name to GAGAN KUMAR GABA 0040883063-6

I SHAKUN AGGARWAL,W/o ASHOK KUMAR AGGARWAL,R/o 12/42, PUNJABI BAGH , NEW DELHI-110026,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO,SHAKUNTLA AGGARWAL 0040883072-6

I, Amit Kumar Gupta, S/o Lavkesh Kumar Gupta, R/o D-37, Second Floor, G.T. Karnal Road, Mahendru Enclave, Azadpur, Delhi-110033, have changed my name from Amit Kumar Gupta to Amit Gupta and shall hereafter be known as Amit Gupta for all purposes. 0040882990-1

I,LAKSHIKHA D/o Narender R/o 9/230, Trilok Puri, Delhi-110091 have changed my name from LAKSHIKHA to LAKSHIKA for all future purposes. 0040883067-4

I, MADAN LAL RIKHAB JAIN S/O RIKAB CHAND JAIN R/O PLOT NO-129, PARKING FLOOR, BLK-A, GT KARNAL ROAD, STATE BANK COLONY, GUJRANWALA COLONY, DELHI-110009, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MADAN LAL JAIN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071065267-1

I, Pooja Singh W/O Sachin Chauhan, R/o F.No-411 Risingh Home Gijhore, Sector-53, Noida, have changed my name to Pooja Singh Chauhan. 0071065270-1

I,SEEMA SINGH,D/O-MANGAT SINGH,R/O.B-5 PALLAVPURAM PHASE 1 ROYAL PARK EXTENSION MODIPURAM, MEERUT,UP-250110,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SEEMA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0040883080-10

I Anil Kumar Tibrewala S/o-Bhagwati Prasad Tibrewala R/o-38, Harsh Vihar, Pitampura, Delhi-110034 have changed my name to Anil Tibrewala for all purposes. 0040883018-1

I, INSHA RAIS,D/O MOHD RAIS,R/O-H.NO.2386,KUCHA CHALAN,DELHI-110006, I, inform that my name is wrongly mentioned INSHA in my-10 class marksheet, but my correct name is INSHA RAIS. 0040883060-1

I, Fozia Parveen, W/o Gulam Sabir, R/o 2330, Sahani Bhawan, Kucha Chelan, Darya Ganj, Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Fauzia Parveen, for all purposes. 0040882973-3

I,VIMLA GUPTA,W/O-Kishan Chand Aggarwal,R/o-Upper F.F. U-12,Subhash Park near Laxmi Narayan Temple Bindapur-Maitiala Road,Uttam Nagar,Delhi-110059,have changed my name to VIMLA AGGARWAL. 0040883063-9

I, V. Shiva Kumar Datta Treya alias V Shiva Kumar S/o V. Satyanarayana, R/o Q.No.-27, Kali Bari Apartments,Udyan Marg Sector-II, DIZ Area, Gole Market, G.P.O., Delhi-110001 have changed my name to V. Shivakumar Datta Treya 0071065304-1

I,Kulmeet Singh S/O Sardar Singh Kalra R/O M-01, Jalvayu Vihar, Sector-25, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have Changed my name to Kulmeet Singh Kalra Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Kulmeet Singh Kalra for all future purposes. 0040883072-10

I,MOHD SUHAIL S/o-Abrar Hussain, R/o-139, 3rd Floor, Sukhdev Vihar, New Delhi-25, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MOHAMMAD SUHAIL. 0040883027-1

I,ATHOKPAM SUMILA DEVI is wife of Service No.15425565W,Rank:-Hav,Name:-Athokpam Hemachandra Singh,Presently residing at,Leishangthem Awang Leikal, Thoubal,Manipur-795138,have changed my name from ATHOKPAM SUMILA DEVI,to YUMNAM SUMILA DEVI,for all future purpose. 0040883067-6

I,Kamala Rohilla k,W/o-Deepak Rohilla,R/o-536,Gali No.1,A-Block,Mahalaxmi Enclave,Karawal Nagar,Delhi-110094,have changed my name to Kamal. Kamala Rohilla and Kamal is one and the same person. 0040883063-2

I, RAKSEH ANAND , S/O RAMAKANT YADAV R/O FLAT NO 16, KHASRA NO. 298/1, NEELKANT APARTMENT MANDI ROAD BEHIND PREM PRAKASH SAI MANDIR MEHRAULI GADAI PUR SOUTH DELHI 110030 have changed my name RAKESH ANAND for all future purposese 0071065292-1

I,Harsha,D/O-Girish Kumar Tewani,R/O-House no-368A, Second floor Chirag Delhi New Delhi -110017 have changed my name to HARSHA TEWANI Permanently 0040883072-1

I, Payal Mangla W/o Manish Aggarwal,Address-J-6/115,2nd floor,rajouri garden 110027, have changed my name to Payal Aggarwal 0040883090-2

It is for general information that I, Alfiya Sabir, D/o Gulam Sabir, R/o 2330, Sahani Bhawan, Kucha Chelan, Darya Ganj, Delhi-110002, declare that name of my father and mother has been wrongly written as Ghulaam Sabir and Fauziya Parveen in my 10th and 12th Class Marksheet cum Certificate. The actual name of my father and mother are Gulam Sabir and Fauzia Parveen, which may be amended accordingly. 0040882973-5

I,SHEJ KAPOOR,S/O-AMIT KAPOOR/D 61,SECTOR-45,NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR,U.P.201301,Have changed My name SEHAJ KAPOOR for all future purposes. 0040883080-9

I,MAHANAZ RUHI W/O ASHRAF ALI R/OC-26 AVANTIKA SEC-1 ROHINI DELHI -110085, HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO MAHENAZ 0040883080-3

I, Vikas Rana S/o Dayanand Rana R/o House No-85, Imran Bhoran Chopal, Khera Kalan, Delhi-110082, have changed my minor Son's name from Lavitra Rana aged 15 years to Lavietra Rana forever 0071065290-1

I Karina Arora, W/o Sahil Arora R/O B75 Sector 36 Noida 201301 have changed name to Karina Chopra for all purposes. 0071065274-1

I,M TUSHAR,S/O-MARIAPPAN, R/O-C-1A/107,SANJAY AMAR COLONY TILAK BRIDGE I T O DELHI 110002 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO TUSHAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040883080-5

I, SURENDER PAL SINGH YADAV C/o MAHENDER SINGH, 4B, TOOT SARAI, MALVIYA NAGAR, DELHI-17 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SURENDER PAL SINGH. 0071065334-1

I, Zahira W/o Gulam Kadir R/o B-276/5, Inder Enclave Phase-I, Kirari Suleman Nagar, Delhi-110086, have changed my name to Jahira. 0040883083-2

I, Toshita Goel W/o Varun Gupta R/o D-20, Tulsi Appartment, Sector-14, Rohini, Delhi 110085 have changed my name to Toshita Gupta for all future purposes 0071065353-1

I,Blesari alias Rajeswari,W/o-Babu Lal,R/o-Faridpur,PO Sikandrabad,Distt.Bulandshahar,UP declare that Blesari and Rajeshwari both names are same and one person. 0040883067-8

I,MAMTA W/o Gagan Kumar Gaba R/o Flat No.765, 6th-Floor Guru Apartment Rohini Sector-14,Delhi-110085 have changed my name to MAMTA GABA. 0040883063-4

I, Ram Naresh S/O Ramvir Sharma, R/O B-15 Mahindra Park, Uttam Nagar, P/O D.K Mohan Garden, DIST: West Delhi 110059, have changed my name to Ram Naresh Sharma 0050299497-1

I,HEM CHANDRA PANDEY,S/O-KAILASH CHAND PANDEY,R/O.B-804, ATS HACIENDAS,INDIRAPURAM,GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH 201014 have changed my name to HEMCHAND PANDEY for all purposes. 0040883072-3

I,ANU GOEL W/O SUNIL GOEL R/O 11263/6, DORIWALAN, MANAK PURA,KAROL BAGH,DELHI-110005,have changed my name to ANU GUPTA for all purposes. 0040883067-1

I, DEVI PRASAD S/o PRABHTI LAL R/o H NO-A-186, J J COLONY, TIGRI, SOUTH DELHI, DELHI - 110062 have changed my name to DEVI RAM for all purposes. 0071065264-1

I, Shakil Ahmed, S/o Mohammed Haneef, R/o 2260, Gali Dakotan, Turkman Gate Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Shakeel Ahmed. My father correct name is Mohammed Haneef instead of Mohmmed Hanif. 0040882975-1

I,FARHAT SULTANA,W/O-SHEIKH FAZL UR REHMAN,R/O-1007,GALI NEEM WALI PUNJABI PHATAK BALLIMARAN CHANDNI CHOWK DELHI-110006,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO FARHAT RAJA,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040883080-7

I, Deepika W/O Sumit Khandelwal, R/o D-314, Sector-P-3, Greater Noida, Tugalpur, G.B.Nagar, UP-201310, have changed my name to Deepika Khandelwal for all future Purposes. 0071065348-1

I, Abhinav Sethumadhavan Menon S/o K.K.S Menon R/o,A-202 , Sansad-Vihar Apartments, Plot-No-2, Sector-3,Dwarka, South-West Delhi-110078,have Changed My-Name to Abhinav S Menon Permanently. 0040883083-4

I, KARSHMA LAMBA SETHI D/o SUNIL KUMAR LAMBA R/o C-4/48 SECTOR-5, ROHINI, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI - 110085 have changed my name to KARISHMA LAMBA for all purposes. 0071065351-1

I Jay Singha S/o Niranjan Singha R/o Nengtichhara, Matigara, PO- New Rangia, Dist-Darjeeling, West Bengal-734013 have changed my name to Joy Singha 0071065289-1

I,JOGINDER PAL PRUTHI S/O KHAIRATI LAL R/O HNO.780/23 OPPOSITE DLF PARK GATE NO.5,ROHTAK HARYANA-124001.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JOGINDER PAL. 0040883067-3

I, Menakshi Sawhney W/o Ashok Kumar Sawhney R/o G-1202, Pan Oasis Society, Sector-70, Noida, UP-201301, have changed my name to MEENAKSHI SAWHNEY for all future purposes. 0071065266-1

I Samridhi D/o Surender Singh R/o 30,SFS Flats, Ashok Vihar Phase -IV, Delhi -110052, have changed my name to Samridhi Dahiya. 0040883070-2

I, Mohd Fauz, S/o Gulam Sabir, R/o 2330, Sahani Bhawan, Kucha Chelan, Darya Ganj, Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Mohammad Fauz, for all purposes. 0040882973-2

I SURENDER DULGAJ,S/o BANARSI DASS,R/o B-511.PANDAV NAGAR PATEL NAGAR DELHI-110008 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO,SURENDER KUMAR 0040883072-5

I,PANKAJ KUMAR MIGLANI S/O KRISHAN LAL R/O SU-179,SECOND FLOOR BLOCK SU PITAMPURA DELHI-110034 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PANKAJ KUMAR 0040883063-8

OTHERS

JOB

Export Marketing Executive Product-Ceramic Tile export2@rangeceramic.com 0050299500-1

LOST & FOUND

I, Mukesh Kumar Jain s/o P.C Jain r/o 14, NDMC Electrical Engineers CGHS Ltd., Plot no. 112, IP Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-92 hereby inform the public that the original Share Certificate, Allotment Letter and Possession Letter relating to the aforesaid property have been lost. Finder may contact 9818227910. 0130070222-1

I,ANITA MITAL,W/o-Late Shri Hirdesh Mital,R/o.A-122 , Mangal Apartment,Plot No-16,Vasundhara Enclave,Delhi-110096,have lost my Property Document Possession Letter,& Allotment Letter of A-122 Mangal Apartment,Plot no.16,Vasundhara Enclave,Delhi-110096 Original Allotment Letter,Membership No-287,Finder Please contact 9717075167 0040883067-7

I, Satish Chand Jain s/o P.C Jain r/o 146, Surya Niketan, Delhi-110092 hereby inform the public that the original Allotment Letter and Possession Letter relating to 27, NDMC Electrical Engineers CGHS Ltd., Plot no. 112, IP Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-92 have been lost. Finder may contact the 9818298201 0130070221-1

I,Dr.MOHAMMED AZEEM,S/o-RAGHIB NASIM,R/o-Flat no.17-A,ABUL FAZAL APPARTMENT, 22 Vasundhara Enclave, Delhi-110096,have LOST my LIC Bond Policy no.115454977,115455387,115455801, 117188465, 117188466,117188482,117188483 . Finder Please Contact-9311118787. 0040883083-7

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

IT IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT **Shri Nitin Sharma,** WHO HAS APPLIED FOR A LOAN FROM ESAF Small Finance Bank Ltd. HAS REPORTED THE DEATH OF Late Shri Daya Shankar Kanoji, EXPIRED ON **10.05.1992** and his Wife Late Smt. Kamla, EXPIRED ON **20.09.2003** and also his Daughter Late Smt. Kumkum, EXPIRED ON **27.01.2012,** THE LOAN PERTAINS TO THE **Entire Built up Plot no. 31, area measuring 208 sq. yds. out of Khasra no. 29/29.** IT IS FURTHER INFORMED THAT THE SELLERS, **Shri Bhagat Singh Sharma,** DO NOT POSSESS THE **SURVIVING MEMBER CERTIFICATE** OF THE ABOVE-NAMED DECEASED PERSON'S IN RESPECT OF THE AFORESAID PROPERTY

IF ANY OTHER CLAIMENT HAS ANY RIGHT IN THE AFORESAID PROPERTY, HE/SHE SHOULD INFORM & GIVE INTIMATION TO THE UNDERSIGNED WITHIN 07 DAYS FROM THE DATE OF ISSUE OF THIS NOTICE.

Sd/-
SUBHASH GUPTA
Advocate
Enrl. No. D-446/2002
125, FIRST FLOOR, ANAND NAGAR, INDERLOK, DELHI-110035.

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरी मुवक्किला श्रीमति सोनी देवी पत्नी स्व० श्री लक्ष्मी नारायण, निवासी बी-17, जे. जे. कॉलोनी, रघुबीर नगर, टैगोर गार्डन, दिल्ली-110027 ने अपने पुत्र प्रदीप कुमार व उसकी पत्नी प्रिया को उनके गलत आचरण व दुर्व्यवहार करने के कारण अपनी समस्त चल-अचल सम्पत्ति से बेदखल कर दिया है तथा समस्त सम्बन्ध विच्छेद कर लिये है। भविष्य में कोई व्यक्ति इनके साथ किसी भी प्रकार का कोई लेन देन, दीवानी, फौजदारी मुकदमे के लिए, या फिर इनके द्वारा किये गये किसी भी कानूनी कार्यवाही के लिये मेरी मुवक्किला व उसके परिवार के अन्य सदस्यों की कोई जिम्मेदार नही होगी।

हस्ता/-
महेश कुमार (एडवोकेट)
Enroll No. D/5229/24

PUBLIC NOTICE

Sale of **Plot/Property bearing No. 8, on Road L-14, area measuring 336 Sq. Mtrs., in the residential colony known as DLF City (earlier known as DLF Qutab Enclave Complex) Phase-II, situated in the revenue estate of village Sarhaul, District Gurugram, Haryana.** (Herein after referred as the "said property").
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that **Original Allotment Letter dated 24.06.1985 & BBA dated 08.01.1986** issued by M/s. DLF Universal Ltd. in favour of Indera Prakash Jauhari, **Sale Deed dated 29.03.1994** executed in favour of Indera Prakash Jauhari, vide Registration No. 11446, SRO-Gurugram, **& Sale Deed dated 16.05.2002** executed by Indera Prakash Jauhari in favour of Inder Pal Singh, vide Registration No. 2202, SRO- Gurugram, have been lost and not traceable at the current owner's end **(i.e. Mr. Ajay Kumar).** The customer(s) is/are availing the financial facility against the security of above referred property from **Axis Bank Ltd.** If anyone finds the missing papers, may send to the undersigned. If any person including banks, financial institutions or any other person, relative, organization, company, firm or government authority having any claim, right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the above-referred property, is hereby called upon to make the same known, in writing with documentary evidence by registered AD Post to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within **7 days** of publication of this notice failing which the same shall be deemed to have been waived and/or abandoned. In the event of no response being received to this notice, the purchase/ mortgage of this property shall be completed by our client without any reference to and without in any manner being affected by any such right title, interest or claim whatsoever.
MANISHA CHAUDHARY, ADVOCATE
JUS LEGALIZ,
210, VARDHMAN STAR CITY MALL (NEAR RAMPHAL CHOWK),SECT-7,DWARKA NEW DELHI-75, 011-45606363, 9899006723

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to public at large that my clients Mr. Vinod Kumar S/o Lakhsman Singh, aged 41 yrs. and his wife Ms. Poonam both R/o H.No. J-170, Shiv Vihar, Karala, North West, Delhi-110081 have severed all relationship with their Daughter Namely Himanshi aged 19 yrs. My clients shall not be responsible for act and omission of their Daughter namely Himanshi aged 19 yrs. and (her agents, associates, relatives or anyone acting on her behalf). My clients have debarred above named person from all their movable and immovable property and she shall have no claim and right in the properties of my clients. Himanshi is hereby evicted from all property of my clients.
Rajeev Sharma (Advocate)
Enrl. No. D/6854/2021
Chamber No. 1014
Lawyers Chambers Block
Rohini Courts, Delhi-110085
Mob.: 9811602799

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to the general public that my client, Smt. Saroj W/o Late Ramesh, is the absolute owner of Property No. D-900, D-Block, New Friends Colony, New Delhi. All GPAS, SPAS, Wills, and Agreements to Sell executed in favor of Rajender Kumar Walia (A-61, Gujranwala Town, Delhi) stand permanently cancelled and revoked via Registered Deeds at Sub-Registrar Gautam Budh Nagar. He possesses no authority to represent her, transfer, or sell this property. Any person, builder, or bank dealing with him does so entirely at their own civil and criminal risk. My client Smt. Saroj is not bound by any transactions made by him.
NAVEEN KUMAR AGGARWAL (ADV)
Office: Chamber No.M-7, Near SBI, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all that I, Rajender Kumar S/O Shri Ved Prakash and Smt. Sushila Devi Mutatee of QU 256-B, Pitampura Delhi-110034, has applied for certified paper of the aforesaid flat such as original Allotment_Cum_Demand Letter has been lost. Application No.40601 under Rohini residential scheme 1981. An FIR (LR.No.693026/2026) to this effect has been lodged in the police station crime branch Delhi on dated 04/10/2026. Any person claiming any right, intrest, having any objection or found in possession of original documents may write/contact with the above named person at above address/Phone 9313980153. New Delhi, within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my clients Sh. Sushil Kumar Tiwari C/O Sh. B. N Tiwari and his Wife Smt. Sobha Tiwari both R/O C-121/2, Ground Floor, Jawahar Park near Sai Baba Mandir, Khanpur, New Delhi-110080 have severed all their relations with their son Namely Vinay Tiwari and his wife Aradhana Tiwari for all purposes and have disowned them from his/her/their all movable and immovable properties. If any person deals with them, he/she shall do so at his/her own risk and cost and my clients shall not be responsible in any manner.
Sharad Chaturvedi (Advocate)
Ch. No. 485, Saket Court, New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

My Clients Sh. Tej Pal S/o Late Sh. Bhagwan Dass and Smt. Asha Devi w/o Sh. Tej Pal R/o H. No. 4670/1 Azadpur Village, North west Delhi, Delhi-110033 hereby severed all relations immediately with their son Vishal and his wife Nancy due to their hostile behaviors and disowned all of them from all their moveable and immovable properties; as such anybody dealing with them will be at their own risks and my clients will be not responsible in any manner socially, morally, legally and financially henceforth.
Rajesh Aggarwal Advocate

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that without any undue influence or pressure, my clients **KAMAL SHARMA**, son of **Late K. C. Sharma**, and **TARUN SHARMA**, wife of Kamal Sharma, both residents of 3/67, Nehru Nagar, New Delhi-110065 have pardoned their son **ABHISHEK SHARMA** and his wife **ISHU SHARMA**, for their past irresponsive behavior towards my clients. My clients hereby WITHDRAW/CANCEL the PUBLIC NOTICE issued on behalf of my clients in The Statesman Newspaper **dated 08.06.2017** with immediate effect and henceforth the said Public Notice shall have no legal effect.
K. P. KAREER (ADVOCATE)
4/67, Nehru Nagar, New Delhi-110 065.
Mobile No.9650091819

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Mrs. Seema Suri W/o Sh. Narender Suri R/o-123, A.G.C.R Enclave, V.T.C, Delhi, Delhi-110092, hereby declares that she has severed all relations and ties with her son, Mr. Arpit Suri & his wife Mrs. Shivee Suri, and has disowned her from her family and estate. My client further declares that she shall have no responsibility or liability for any act, transaction, representation or obligation undertaken by Mr. Arpit Suri & his wife Mrs. Shivee Suri and that she shall have no right, title or interest in the properties and assets of my client merely by virtue of being her son.
ASHISH SHARMA
ADVOCATE
DELHI HIGH COURT
CH. NO. D-225, K.K.D COURTS

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Fakir Chand Ahuja S/o Govind Ram Ahuja R/o G-288/289, Shakurpur JJ Colony, Anandvas Shakurpur, Delhi-110034, have disowned and debarred his son Manav Ahuja from all his moveable and immovable properties & assets. If anybody dealing with him shall be doing so at his/her/their own risk, cost & responsibility. My client will not be responsible in any manner whatsoever.
Dalbir Singh, Advocate
Enrl. No. D/875/2022

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client, Indu (wife of the late Subhash Chand, resident of 7/82, Third Floor, Geeta Colony, Delhi-31), has disowned and severed all relation with her son, Ashish Baghel, and daughter-in-law, Sonam Chawla, due to their misconduct; neither my client nor any member of the family shall be held responsible for any of their future Actions / Act.
RAJ KUMAR (ADVOCATE)
33A, Kishan Kunj, Extn. II, Delhi-110092

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my clients Basil Martin Shawel, S/o Lt. Mr. Longinus Shawel, and his wife Mrs. Anita Shawel R/o CB 241, Naraina Ring Road, South-west, Delhi-110028, have severed their relations & have disowned & disinherited their son, Namely Deepak Benjamin Shawel S/o Mr. Basil Martin Shawel & their daughter in law, Namely Mrs. Mahima (Meeta) Shawel, and "any person claiming to be his wife or spouse, and any person allegedly involved in an extramarital relationship with him, rather than using the expressions 'legal and illegal wife' or 'illegitimate wife,' together with their children, shall stand excluded from any claim over the movable and immovable properties and assets of my clients. This exclusion is due to their absolute irresponsible behavior, failure to care for my clients in times of need, disobedience, hostile attitude, cruel acts undermining harmony and dignity, and the threat of false implication of the entire family & my clients". My clients shall not be held responsible for any of the wrong doings, illegal acts & activities of their son Deepak Benjamin Shawel or daughter-in-law Mrs. Mahima (Meeta) Shawel, & his children in past, present & future or deeds from the date of publication of this bonafide notice. Anybody dealing with them shall do so at his/her/their own risks and consequences, neither they shall be liable for his illegal contracts. Priya Mukhija (Advocate) Ch.No. 76, Civil Wing Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is notified by my client LICHFL Kaushambi Ghaziabad that Original Sale Deed dated 15.12.2016 executed by Mr. Ram Avatar Garg in favour of Smt. Saroj Rawat in respect of the Flat No. UGF-1, Upper Ground Floor Front Side measuring area 37.16 sq. mtr., Plot No. A-1/33 Situated at DLF Dilshad Extn.- II, Village Brahmpur alias Bhopura Ghaziabad, registered at S.R. III Ghaziabad vide Doc. No. 8228 Vol. No. 12397 Page No. 313 to 368, It is no longer available furthermore, it has gone missing from LICHFL. Kaushambi, Ghaziabad.My client has also lodged a FIR dated 21.08.2026 for the same if any person has any claim related to the above said Property/Sale Deed, then that person can present his claim within 15 days from the publication of the notice, after that no claim of any kind will be binding on my client.
Yogesh Kumar Advocate
Office No. 2 First Floor, Kalyan Kunj Chaudhary Farm, Near Piller No. 37, Sector-49, Noida. G. B. Nagar- 201301, Mob: No.9911004142, 9310203738

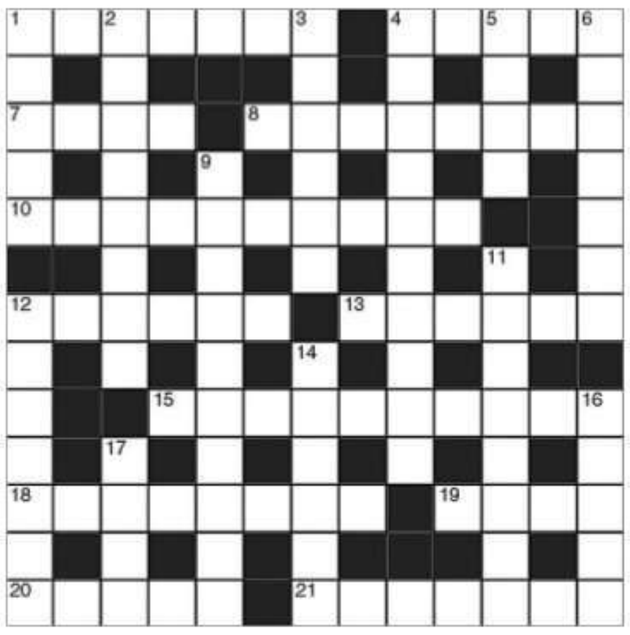
PUBLIC NOTICE

It is notified by my client LICHFL Kaushambi Ghaziabad that Original Sale Deed dated 21.02.2012 executed by Sh. Arshdeep Gupta in favour of Sh. Anil Kumar in respect of the Flat No. SF-2, Second Floor Front Side measuring area 63 sq. mtr., Built on Plot No. Niti Khand-II/716 Situated at Indirapuram Ghaziabad, registered at S.R. IV Ghaziabad vide Doc. No. 5669 Vol. No. 19954 Page No. 346 to 384, This deed has been lost somewhere at the office of the Sub-Registrar, Ghaziabad, and cannot be found. My client has also lodged a FIR dated 21.08.2026 for the same if any person has any claim related to the above said Property/Sale Deed, then that person can present his claim within 15 days from the publication of the notice, after that no claim of any kind will be binding on my client.
Yogesh Kumar Advocate
Office No. 2 First Floor, Kalyan Kunj Chaudhary Farm, Near Piller No. 37, Sector-49, Noida. G. B. Nagar- 201301, Mob: No.9911004142, 9310203738

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is

• CROSSWORD 6118



ACROSS

1 Manoeuvring this leg requires deftness of hand (7)
4 Break arranged for worker in a hot place (5)
7 Single piece of ammunition (4)
8 He has a burning desire to destroy (8)
10 A blow that is sustained (6,4)
12 Struck by hose? (6)
13 First impressions of the strengths of spirits? (6)
15 One match should last him a lifetime (10)
18 Pedestrian way of choosing candidates (8)
19 If I jive I have to leave the country (4)
20 Place for landing and take-off (5)
21 It can be made into a cupboard (7)

DOWN

1 Bullets and pellets may get rid of them (5)
2 Basis for action (8)
3 Cast from the seat of power we hear (6)
4 Kind of loaf some prefer to make toast? (5,5)
5 Work with stitches to heal (4)
6 Keeps dissolving in tears (7)
9 Groundless rumour that there's nothing doing? (4,6)
11 Party favourite to gain power (8)
12 Meetings that raise the spirits (7)
14 This drink can go a hundred years back (6)
16 Commonly said not to be a disgrace (5)
17 It sounds as though we have the time (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6117 **ACROSS:** 1 Original sin, 9 Angered, 10 Noble, 11 Iota, 12 Felonies, 14 Sampan, 16 Welter, 18 Up to date, 19 Taxi, 22 Rodeo, 23 Arrange, 24 French chalk **DOWN:** 2 Right, 3 Garb, 4 Nodded, 5 Londoner, 6 Inbuilt, 7 Magic square, 8 Tea strainer, 13 Hand down, 15 Matador, 17 Attach, 20 Annul, 21 Arch

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

We ___ ___ when we have paid the full price. - Rabindranath Tagore (4,7)

GLAEE

AESDMN

RROIP

HIRTFG

SOLUTIONS: Eagle, Prior, Amends, Fright
ANSWER: We **gain freedom** when we have paid the full price. - Rabindranath Tagore

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6470

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

3	1				7			
7		4	9		2	1		
6								3
8					5			
1	2		8		3		5	6
			7					8
9								1
		8	1		9	4		7
			4				2	9

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6469

1	3	2	5	9	8	4	6	7
9	8	7	1	4	6	3	5	2
4	6	5	3	7	2	1	9	8
6	2	4	8	3	1	5	7	9
7	5	9	6	2	4	8	1	3
3	1	8	9	5	7	6	2	4
8	7	6	2	1	3	9	4	5
2	9	1	4	8	5	7	3	6
5	4	3	7	6	9	2	8	1

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): The Moon is in your Financial House, which might encourage you to negotiate financial matters and discuss banking details and insurance issues and inheritances. However, today is a Moon alert. Postpone these discussions. Tonight: Learn and explore.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today you have to go more than halfway when dealing with others because the Moon is opposite your sign. In two weeks, people will go more than halfway when dealing with you. It's a Moon alert today. Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): You might want to get better organised today. However, there's a Moon alert in effect most of this day, which could create shortages and delays. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Most of this day is a Moon alert, which means you have fantastic opportunities to express your creative talents. Enjoy socialising and fun activities with kids. Tonight: Get organised.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): The Sun is urging you to get out, chat, travel and learn something. However, you might want to kick back and relax at home. Take it easy. It's a poor day to shop or make important decisions. Tonight: Socialise.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Indulge your eagerness to talk to others and share your ideas today. People will enjoy talking to you because you know a lot, especially trivia. That's what makes you so interesting. (Especially when you do dialects.) Tonight: Relax at home.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This is a strong time because the Sun in your sign is recharging your batteries for the rest of year. Three planets are in your Money House, making you think about buying beautiful things. Don't do it today as there is Moon alert. Just make a list. Tonight: Talk and learn.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today three planets are in your sign, which is a powerhouse. Plus, Mars is high in your chart arousing your ambition. This is the kind of day where you can go after what you want. But not today! As there's a Moon alert in effect all day. Tonight: Check your money.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today is a mixed bag. In one way, you feel sociable because you're popular right now. People want to talk to you, and your involvement in groups is stronger than usual. Another part of you wants to be low-key and keep things quiet. That might be the wise choice. Tonight: You win.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You might have a heart-to-heart discussion with a female acquaintance today. You look good to everyone right now. There's a Moon Alert all day. So keep things light. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): People notice you today. Some people will know personal details about your private life. Be aware of this in case you have to do some damage control. There's a Moon alert all day, restrict spending to food and gas. Tonight: Be friendly.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Avoid controversial subjects today. They will amount to nothing due to the Moon alert taking place all day. However, you can make progress at work or with any task you set for yourself. Tonight: You're admired.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Naseer Sheik, S/o:** Azam Sheik, **R/o:** Jhuggi No. C-60, Priyadarshini, Sadar Bazar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1359/2024 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S.: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Naseer Sheik** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Naseer Sheik** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Naseer Sheik** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 1359/2024 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S.: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Kartik Taparia
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06 (Central)
Room No. 247, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/14546/N/2026
(Court Matter)

कार्यालय कुलसचिव
नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, जबलपुर, (म.प्र.)

ई-निविदा सूचना

ई-निविदा सूचना क्र: 3727 /Reg./Tender/ET-03/2026-27. **दिनांक 12.10.2026**

नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, जबलपुर, (म.प्र.) द्वारा निम्न दर्शाये कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत फर्मों / संस्थाओं से खुली निविदा ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत निविदा ई-निविदा पोर्टल **www.mptenders.gov.in** पर देखी व भरी जा सकेगी। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरान्त निविदा में किसी भी प्रकार के संशोधन, परिवर्तन अथवा शुद्धिपत्र की जानकारी केवल उक्त ई-निविदा पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध कराई जाएगी। कार्यों का विवरण निम्नानुसार है :-

क्र.	कार्य का नाम
1.	नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय अंतर्गत जबलपुर स्थित समस्त इकाईयों हेतु किराए पर टेंट, पंडाल, फर्नीचर, लाइटिंग एवं कार्यक्रम संबंधी अस्थायी संरचनाओं की व्यवस्था हेतु वार्षिक दर अनुबंध।
2.	नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, अधिनस्थ समस्त महाविद्यालय / इकाईयों (जबलपुर,मंडला, रीवा) में फर्नीचर क्रय करने हेतु दर निर्धारण।
3.	नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय,अधीनस्थ समस्त महाविद्यालय / इकाईयों (जबलपुर,मंडला,रीवा) में हार्डवेयर आईटम (कम्प्यूटर, प्रिंटर, फोटोकॉपियर, कैमरा आदि के) क्रय करने एवं सुधार करने हेतु दर निर्धारण।
4.	नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, अधिनस्थ समस्त महाविद्यालय / इकाईयों (जबलपुर,मंडला,रीवा) में इलेक्ट्रॉनिक सामग्री क्रय करने हेतु दर निर्धारण।
5.	नानाजी देशमुख पशु चिकित्सा विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, अधीनस्थ समस्त महाविद्यालय / इकाईयों (जबलपुर,मंडला एवं रीवा) में प्रिंटर, फोटोकॉपियर क्रय करने हेतु दर निर्धारण।

निविदा ऑनलाईन भरने की प्रारंभिक तिथी 15.10.2026 से एवं अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 04.11.2026

कुलसचिव

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. & 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Rajeev Sharma S/o: Triloki Nath Sharma R/o:** H. No. 29/438, New Moti Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 148/2017, U/s: 376/377/509/354(C)/323 IPC, PS: Moti Nagar West, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Rajeev Sharma,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Rajeev Sharma,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Rajeev Sharma,** of **FIR No. 148/2017, U/s: 376/377/509/354(C)/323 IPC, PS: Moti Nagar West, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026**.

By Order
Sunil Gupta
Additional Session Judge
Fast Track Spl. Court (RC-02) (West)
Room No. 178, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/14167/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

Government of Jharkhand
Department of Mines & Geology
Directorate of Geology
Engineer's Hostel No-2, 2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi

CORRIGENDUM

Short Tender Corrigendum Notice no. 02/2026-27 was published on 07.10.2026 in different News Papers vide PR. No.- 391211. The following changes are hereby made in the said tender: -

SI. No.	Particulars	
1	Last date of submission of Bid/NIT	23.10.2026 till 5.00 P.M.
2	Bid/NIT opening date	To be notified.

All other terms and conditions of the above-mentioned NIT shall remain unchanged. All prospective bidders are advised to visit the official website of the Government of Jharkhand, www.jharkhand.gov.in, for further updates and to submit their bids accordingly.

Sd/-
Director, Geology
Directorate of Geology,
Department of Mines & Geology,
Government of Jharkhand

PR 391622 Mines and Geology(26-27).D

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, राँची।
सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना।



नाम–रूपाली सिंह, उम्र–22 वर्ष, उँचाई–5 फीट, रंग–गोरा, पहनावा–पिंक रंग का कुर्ती एवं जींस पहनी हुई है।

उपरोक्त लापता महिला रूपाली सिंह, उम्र–22 वर्ष, पिता–सुशील कुमार सिंह, पता–लाईन टैक रोड, मनोकामना हनुमार मंदिर, क्वाटर नं0–14/16 सी0, थाना–कोतवाली, जिला–राँची जो दिनांक–08.10.2026 को अपने घर से बगैर बताए कहीं चली गई जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई है। जिसके संबंध में कोतवाली थाना सनहा सं0–27/2026, दिनांक–08.10.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता महिला कहीं मिलती/दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।

Email ID(rnc-dcb@jhpolice.gov.in**)**

पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, कोतवाली, राँची। –9431706158
थाना प्रभारी, कोतवाली, राँची। –9431706188
आवेदक प्रेम कुमार सिंह। –9241187297

PR 391634 Police(26-27)D

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, राँची।

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
DIRECTORATE OF HORTICULTURE, KASHMIR
Rajbagh-Srinagar opposite Presentation Convent School -190008
TELE-FAX: 01943100919
Website: http://hortikashmir.gov.in **Email:** dhk-Kashmir@jk.gov.in

Extension of Tender Notices of:

1. e-NIT No.81 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_322990_1),
2. e-NIT No.82 of 2026 (Tender ID: 2026_HPD_323039_1),
3. e-NIT No.83 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_323071_1),

Subject: Extension of Tender Submission Date - Import of Rootstock of Different Fruit Crops, thereof:

It is hereby notified for information of all concerned that the e-NIT No.81 of 2026 (Tender ID: 2026_HPD_322990_1) dated 01-09-2026 (Pear), e-NIT No.82 of 2026 (Tender ID: 2026_HPD_323039_1) dated 01-09-2026-2026 (Cherry) and e-NIT No.83 of 2026 (Tender ID:2026_HPD_323071_1) dated 01-09-2026 (Almond), issued by this Directorate for the **"Import of Rootstock of Different Fruit Crops"** is hereby extended by further period of 15 (Fifteen) days from the date of publication of this notice.

- **Last Date of Submission: - 22-10-2026**
- **Opening Date for Tender: -24-10-2026**

(All other terms and conditions of the said tender shall remain unchanged).

The prospective bidders are advised to visit the JK Tenders Portal **https://jktenders.gov.in)** regularly for updated details, dates, and any further information.

Sd/-
(Vikas Anand)
DIP NO. DIPK-6631/26 DATE 12.10.2026 **DIRECTOR**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Aslam @ Ganja, S/o Lt. Ashid Ahmad R/o Farukh ka Makan Old Village, Garhi Mendu, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.724/2021 u/s 25 Arms Act, P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Aslam @ Ganja** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Aslam @ Ganja** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Aslam @ Ganja** of **FIR No.724/2021 u/s 25 Arms Act, P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.02.2027.**

By Order,
Ms. Norma Jain
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North-East District, Room No.22, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14470/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Saurabh @ Babu** S/o Devender Kumar R/o H. No. 4/2243, Gali No. 2, Bihari Colony, Shahdara, Delhi-32 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 36028/2023 u/s 379/411 IPC** at **P.S. Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Saurabh @ Babu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Saurabh @ Babu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Saurabh @ Babu** accused of **FIR No. 36028/2023 u/s 379/411 IPC** at **P.S. Krishna Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.01.2027.**

By Order: Shri P. Bhargav Rao,
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-05,
Room No. 03, Second Floor, East Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts Delhi.

DP/14446/SHD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Deepak @ Soni @ Mota, S/o Veerpal, R/o H.No. 345, Phase-III, J.J. Colony, Madanpur Khadar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 223/2020, U/s 397/394/411/34 IPC, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Deepak @ Soni @ Mota** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Deepak @ Soni @ Mota** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Deepak @ Soni @ Mota** accused of **FIR No. 223/2020, U/s 397/394/411/34 IPC, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.11.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Sachin Jain
Additional Sessions Judge-02
South East District, Room No. 314
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/14552/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mahesh, S/o Badri Prashad, R/o G-14, G-218, Near Gurudwara, New Seelampur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 239/2021, U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mahesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mahesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mahesh** accused of **FIR No. 239/2021, U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.02.2027.**

By Order - Ms. Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North East District, Room No. 22
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14217/NE/2026

झारखण्ड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, धनबाद
मोबाईल नं0 : 7061981397 Email : rdsd.dhanbad@rediffmail.com

पत्रांक:–1140 **शुद्धि पत्र** धनबाद/दिनांक–10.10.2026

इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 1069 दिनांक 29.09.2026 के द्वारा आमंत्रित अति अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0– **41/2026-27/RDSD/EE/Dhanbad** जिसका **PR No. 390834 REO(26-27)_D** में प्रकाशित निविदा की तिथि में निम्नवत् संशोधन किया जाता है।

क्र0	विवरणी	पूर्व में प्रकाशित तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
1.	वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	दिनांक 07.10.2026	दिनांक 15.10.2026
2.	ई0 निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 07.10.2026 से दिनांक 14.10.2026 को अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक।	दिनांक 15.10.2026 से दिनांक 22.10.2026को अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक।
3.	ई0 निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 16.10.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे।	दिनांक 24.10.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे।

अतः अन्य शर्तों यथावत रहेगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,धनबाद

PR 391608 (Rural Development)26-27*D

RailTel
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
CIN No. L64202DL2000GOI107905

e-Tender No.RailTel/Tender/OT/WR/RO/2026-27/VSS/001 Date: 09.10.2026

RailTel /Western Region invites open E-Tender for "Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning, Integration with Existing VSS Infra, Operation and Maintenance of IP based Video Surveillance System (VSS) at Railway Stations under Western Region of RailTel for and on behalf of Indian Railways" Tender Notice and Tender Document are available on https://www.railtel.in/ and can be downloaded from the e-tendering portal https://www.ireps.gov.in/ . All future Addendum/Corrigendum will be uploaded on RailTel website and e-tendering portal only.

Western Railway Microwave Complex, Senapati Bapat Marg, Mahalaxmi, Mumbai-400013, Phone: 91 (22) 24923907 Fax: 91 (22) 24923913

Kushagra takes Pant's place in India A squad for NZ tour



Rishabh Pant is ruled out of the first 2 matches of the tour. CREIMAS

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 12

RISHABH PANT was on Monday ruled out of the India A squad for the first 2 matches in the New Zealand tour due to injury, the BCCI said in a statement. Wicketkeeper-batter Kumar Kushagra will replace him while a decision on Pant's availability for the third match will be taken at a later stage, the board said in a statement.

Pant, who was leading the Rest of India squad in the Irani Cup, sustained a left-side strain and has been ruled out of the first two matches. The wicketkeeper-batter, whose availability for the tour was subject to fitness, remains under the care of the BCCI medical team and is recovering well.

This is another blow for Pant after his snub from India's ODI team which recently played against West Indies. Even with several regulars unavailable for the three-match series, the wicketkeeper-batsman had been overlooked again.

Shreyas Iyer, Ishan Kishan and Axar Patel were all unavailable for the ODIs, leaving India without several players who'd normally make their ODI XI. Their absence still did not open a way back for Pant in the 50-over format, where he has been out of contention for close to 2 years.

Pant last played an ODI against Sri Lanka in August 2024, his only chance that series, with KL Rahul preferred as wicketkeeper. Since then, he's remained central to India's Test side, but has slipped down the 50-over pecking order.

India A will be led by Dhruv Jurel, who will also take up the wicketkeeping duties. The squad includes senior players Yashasvi Jaiswal, KL Rahul and Washington Sundar, along with Devdutt Padikkal and Sai Sudharsan.

INDIA A SQUAD: Yashasvi Jaiswal, KL Rahul, Devdutt Padikkal, Ravichandran Smaran, Dhruv Jurel (captain and wicketkeeper), Washington Sundar, Auqib Nabi, Akash Deep, Anshul Kamboj, Manav Suthar, Mukesh Choudhary, Sai Sudharsan, Yash Rathod, Mukesh Kumar and Kumar Kushagra (first two matches).

PACE WATCH

Clocking 150kmph, Yadav offers India a missing link in T20Is

With team looking to build pace attack beyond Bumrah, Mayank & Prince offer options

Shankar Narayan
Indore, October 12



In the absence of Jasprit Bumrah due to load management, Mayank Yadav's deliveries reaching 150kmph is a good sign for India. CREIMAS

INDIA'S T20I era under Shreyas Iyer is gathering momentum. After losing 2-0 in Ireland and 4-0 in England, they have won 10 of their last 11 T20Is, with Sunday's 14-run win over West Indies in Indore the latest. This run has come without Jasprit Bumrah, whose workload is managed with the ODI World Cup in mind. In his absence, Mayank Yadav has been the most exciting quick to step up.

In six spells against Zimbabwe and West Indies, Mayank has taken nine wickets for 182 runs in 22 overs at an economy rate of 8.27.

He gives India something different: an out-and-out quick who can touch 150 kmph. India have had fast bowlers, but rarely a regular, fit option with the raw pace of Jofra Archer, Mark Wood or Anrich Nortje. At that speed, batsmen have less time to settle or commit to a stroke. If Mayank stays fit and works on his control, his pace could give India a weapon they have lacked.

Encouraging signs

In Indore, Mayank went wicketless for 34, but his first two overs were threatening. He found movement away from right-handers, beat the edges and drew one from Shimron Hetmyer's bat that was dropped. Later, Hetmyer pulled a slower short ball for four, and Sherfane Rutherford hit a missed yorker for six. Mayank's pace troubled the batsmen.

He showed his real attributes in the second game at Ranchi. His 3/36 included wickets of Kamil Pooran and Hetmyer, both against short balls, before he bowled Rovman Powell with a 149.5 kmph delivery that hit off stump. Rutherford then struck two fours and a six.

In Lucknow, Shai Hope attacked his fast and slower balls, while Rutherford picked changes of pace when they landed short or within his reach, hitting boundaries off deliveries at 112-119 kmph. His slower balls proved ineffective when the length gave the batsman time to adjust.

On his return against Zimbabwe after nearly two years away, Mayank took 2/18, dismissing Bennett with his first ball, which moved away, and Myers after beating him at around 145 kmph. He went wicketless in the second match, then took 3/29 in the third.

No time to settle

At 150 kmph, Mayank gives batsmen little time to settle. If the ball moves late or climbs from a good length, even a defensive shot can produce an edge. But batsmen can use that pace against him if they anticipate the line and length.

The comeback was also a struggle off the field. Mayank's coach, Devendra Sharma, said recurring injuries eventually led to a diagnosis of a back injury, leaving him to decide whether to have surgery.

"The comeback was a huge struggle. It was very tough because injuries kept recurring, and later it was discovered that he had a back injury," he told *The Indian Express*.

Rehabilitation took four to five months. Sharma said Mayank had self-doubts every day. "Every single day there was that question - 'Will I be able to play again?' - because strengthening takes a lot of time." He had to rebuild gradually.

Sharma said Mayank kept visiting his club in Delhi to discuss his progress, but the specialised machines he needed were at the NCA in Bengaluru. By the time his IPL team assessed him for retention, he was bowling 10 to 15 overs a day at the NCA. "Once he got back to about 125 kmph, the confidence slowly returned," Sharma said.

Sharma believed Mayank's pace was natural, but the challenge was trusting his body again. "His pace is purely natural and god-gifted. It is always bound to come back to him; the challenge was just to avoid the psychological block." Before Mayank returned to India duty, Sharma advised him to put IPL setbacks behind him, read batsmen's footwork and scoring areas, avoid predictable short balls and use variations. He must sharpen his yorker and cut down on extras.

Like Kagiso Rabada, Mayank needs to develop well-disguised slower balls and deadlier yorkers so that his pace does not become the only part of his repertoire.

At the other end of the spectrum is Prince Yadav. Brought into the XI for Kuldeep Yadav in Indore, he went wicketless, conceding 37 in four overs. Hetmyer pulled a short ball for four, while Springer launched a missed yorker for six. Prince deceived Roston Chase with a slower short ball, but his yorkers and control at the death remain a work in progress.

His Zimbabwe spells were better. He dismissed Ben Curran in both matches, inducing a mistimed pull and then a leading edge. Fuller balls swinging into left-hander Ryan Burl kept beating his inside edge. Prince took four wickets for 29 runs in 5.2 overs. Where Mayank relies on raw pace, Prince uses movement and accurate lengths.

With the 2028 T20 World Cup in Australia and New Zealand ahead, India have time to build options beyond Bumrah. Mayank brings pace; Prince offers movement and control. Both must stay fit, limit extras and deliver under pressure.

India don't need to find another Bumrah, but quicks they can trust for four overs.

(With inputs from Shuvaditya Bose)

I want my practice to make me uncomfortable: Sharma

Shankar Narayan
Indore, October 12



Sharma reached 50 runs in 18 balls in the 3rd T20I. CREIMAS

MORE THAN two years into his India career, Abhishek Sharma remains an instinctive aggressor, but he is also learning to think like the bowlers trying to stop him. The left-hander studies their plans, prepares for their challenges and looks for ways to counter them before he walks out to bat.

That thinking was on display in Indore, where Abhishek made 69 off 30 balls against West Indies, reaching his half-century in 18 deliveries. After scoring 108 against Afghanistan in Delhi, his next five T20I scores were 0, 7, 61, 21 and 20. His latest innings showed what he can do when he gets going, while his comments afterwards offered a glimpse of the work behind his attacking game.

"Preparation is really important. If I want to continue playing like this and utilise the powerplay, as the team wants me to, preparation really matters. I always believe it depends on which team I'm going to play against and which bowlers I'm going to face. Whenever I have time, whether it's a week, a few days or two or three days, the preparation is very specific: which bowler is going to plan for me, and how I'm going to execute my plan and dominate. That's always there," he said in the post-match press conference.

For Abhishek, that also meant preparing for situations in which bowlers tried to take away his usual scoring options. He wanted to face those challenges in practice rather than encounter them for the first time in a match.

"It's very personal for me because, as an attacking batter, if you have to face world-class bowlers, you have to be ready for all the plans. That comes down to my preparation. I always want my preparation in practice to make me a bit uncomfortable so that I wouldn't be surprised in a match. I always allow myself to be in that position during practice and training, so that I won't be surprised when bowlers and teams actually have that plan in a match," he added.

That preparation also came into play when he looked at the field on Sunday. Fifty of his 69 runs in Indore came on the off side. He was able to find gaps outside off stump rather than relying only on his power through the leg side.

"It depends more on the field placement. I don't play those shots deliberately. It happens when I see the field placement. Whenever the field allows me to give myself room and play those shots, that's it," he said.

Abhishek was not concerned only with how many sixes he hit. He wanted to target one over in which he can put the opposition under pressure.

"It's not about hitting sixes. It's about getting that big over whenever you can. If you get that start, I feel it doesn't matter if you hit a four or a six," he said.

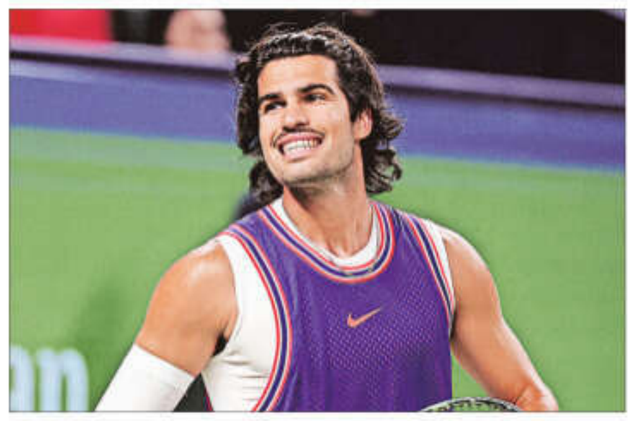
Rutherford and Powell cautioned

WEST INDIES cricketers Rovman Powell and Sherfane Rutherford have been reprimanded for breaching the ICC Code of Conduct during the second men's T20 International against India on Friday.

Both were also awarded one demerit point each, with the offences being their first in a 24-month period.

Powell was found guilty of breaching Article 2.2 of the ICC Code of Conduct, relating to abuse of cricket equipment, after he struck the ball away with his bat following his dismissal in the sixth over. Rutherford, meanwhile, breached Article 2.8, which relates to showing dissent at an umpire's decision, after aggressively shouting at the umpire. PTI

• BRIEFLY



Carlos Alcaraz lost to Zizou Bergs in straight sets. REUTERS

Bergs stuns Alcaraz in Shanghai as Zverev claims year-end top ranking

SEVEN-TIMES Grand Slam champion Carlos Alcaraz suffered a shock 7-5 7-6(4) defeat by unseeded Belgian Zizou Bergs in the Shanghai Masters round of 32 on Monday, a result that also confirmed Alexander Zverev as the ATP's year-end world number one. Fresh from defending his Japan Open title and building momentum after a wrist injury that sidelined him for nearly five months, Alcaraz never found his rhythm in a scrappy two-hour, two-minute contest. The second-seeded Spaniard joined Novak Djokovic and US Open runner-up Ben Shelton among the high-profile casualties at the ATP Masters 1000 event. Bergs produced a composed all-court performance, thriving in the quick conditions as the 27-year-old broke Alcaraz's serve three times to clinch the biggest victory of his career. Bergs had lost their only previous meeting, but showed no signs of intimidation as he outplayed the 23-year-old in key moments. REUTERS

Mighty Marathas win third straight match in APL

MIGHTY MARATHAS came from behind to script a thrilling shoot-off victory over in-form Chero Archers in the Archery Premier League on Monday. Aman Saini and Dhiraj Bommadevara hit the yellow ring in the APL's signature hit-or-miss shoot-off, while compound world No. 1 Mathias Fullerton was the only Chero archer to score a hit. The Marathas won the tie-breaker 2-1 after the teams were locked 4-4 in regulation time. Chero started strongly to take the opening set, however the second and third sets were split between the two sides. The high-scoring fourth set went down to the wire, but after a few tense moments it went the Marathas' way. PTI

Harmeet, Yashaswini out of nat'l ranking

FOURTH SEED Harmeet Desai and second seed Yashaswini Ghorpade suffered shock exits from the men's and women's singles events respectively at the second National Ranking Table Tennis Championships at the Tau Devi Lal Indoor Hall on Monday. Unseeded Manika Batra also crashed out of the tournament after losing her Round of 32. Harmeet, who received a first-round bye, bowed out in the Round of 128 after losing 1-3 to qualifier Rusikesh Jagtap. Yashaswini, meanwhile, suffered a similar fate in the women's Round of 32, going down 2-3 to Tamil Nadu's Ananya Muralidharan in a closely contested five-game match. PTI

Asiad review by Ministry, NSF, moved to Oct 15

THE SPORTS Ministry's one-day meet with National Sports Federations to review the country's performance in the recently concluded Asian Games has been rescheduled by a couple of days to October 15. The meeting was originally planned for October 13 but Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, who will chair the proceedings, is currently in Ahmedabad for the BRICS Traditional and Indigenous Sports Demonstration Games. "The meeting will be on October 15 now," a Ministry source told PTI. The focus of the session will be on the underwhelming show of "experienced" athletes, especially in badminton, shooting and athletics. PTI

Sindhu faces An Se-young in Denmark Open

INDIAN SHUTTLERS have been handed a tricky draw for the Denmark Open Super 750 tournament starting tomorrow. The likes of PV Sindhu, Lakshya Sen, and Ayush Shetty will face the top seeds in their opening games. In the women's singles, Sindhu will start her campaign against World no 1 An Se-young after finishing in the quarterfinal of the Arctic Open last week. Unnati Hooda will face Han Qian Xi of China while Tanvi Sharma will take on Japan's Natsuki Nidaira. Lakshya Sen will be up against World championships medallist Chou Tien-chen and Ayush will face a familiar foe in Alwi Farhan. Kidambi Srikanth faces Arnaud Merkle. ENS

• SOUTH AFRICA VS AUSTRALIA

Australia need 6 wickets on final day to win first Test

Reuters
Durban, October 12



Matt Renshaw scored 82 runs off 99 balls in the second innings. AP

AUSTRALIA'S MATT Renshaw played a leading role to leave his side needing six wickets on the last day of the first test to beat South Africa as the hosts were 102-4 at the close of play at Kingsmead on Monday.

Set 421 runs to win after Australia declared their second innings on 314-6, South Africa saw opener Ryan Rickelton, David Bedingham, captain Temba Bavuma and Tristan Stubbs all dismissed before stumps with part time spinner Renshaw weighing in with his first test wicket as his dream performance continued.

Aiden Markram (45 not out) and Wiaan Mulder, unbeaten on five, will resume on the final morning, needing to lead a stoic rearguard action if the home side are to avoid defeat.

Rickelton's place in the test side looks under threat after another early dismissal. He was out for a duck after three balls of the first innings and scored two on Monday before an attempted pull shot saw him edge Josh Hazlewood's rising delivery to wicketkeeper Alex Carey.

Bedingham was the second wicket to fall, making 46 before being trapped lbw by Hazlewood and ending a patient 66-run partnership with Markram, while Bavuma scored a single run, prodding at Renshaw's off spin and being caught bat-pad at short leg.

Stubbs also made one, getting a thick edge to captain Pat Cummins' delivery with another example of the poor shot selection that has dogged South Africa's batting.

Red-hot batting form

Earlier, Renshaw continued his red-hot batting form to allow his side to declare at tea, picking up where he left off in the first innings when he scored 190 of Australia's 390 runs.

The 30-year-old Queenslander continued to dominate the home bowlers, scoring 82 in the second innings before a controversial caught and bowled from Keshav Maharaj ended his contribution.

It was the top score for Australia, who accelerated their run accumulation in a bid to give themselves time to put South Africa into bat and chase down the 10 wickets required for victory.

They resumed on 33-0 and scored 141 runs in a fast-moving first session for the loss of four wickets and a further 140 in the afternoon.

Cummins hits 4 sixes

Opener Nic Maddinson, who made a duck in the first innings on his return after a decade out of test cricket, played some expansive shots before Anrich Nortje clean bowled him for 48, and there were useful contributions from Beau Webster, 39 not out, and Cummins, who bludgeoned four sixes in his whirlwind 12-ball 32.

Travis Head's 11 runs at the top of the Australia innings and 37 again from Marnus Labuschagne did not help their individual causes, although Labuschagne's 53-run partnership with Steve Smith (27) for the third wicket did accelerate the run rate and put Australia into an advantageous position.

Smith was struck on the helmet by Nortje and is being assessed under concussion protocols. He batted on after the hit but did not join the rest of the Australian team on the field at the start of South Africa's chase and could be a doubt for the second test, which starts in Gqeberha on Sunday.

BRIEF SCORES: Australia 390 and 314/6d (Matt Renshaw 82; Keshav Maharaj 2/56) vs South Africa 284 and 102/4 (Aiden Markram 45 not out; Josh Hazlewood 2/20). SA trail by 319 runs.

Simons and Foster leave CSK, team up with Fleming in Eng role

Express News Service
Chennai, October 12



Eric Simons. X/@CHENNAIIPL

The South African (Simons) was also part of Gary Kirsten's team when he coached India to 2011 World Cup success

ENGLAND'S NEWLY appointed Test coach Stephen Fleming will reunite with two of his trusted support staff from Chennai Super Kings. Fleming, who stepped aside as the head coach of the IPL giants after a 17-year tenure, has since taken the plunge into red-ball cricket, where he will focus all his attention on the England Test team beginning with the tour to South Africa later this year. Joining him in England would be fast bowling coach Eric Simons and fielding coach James Foster.

Soon after Fleming took over as the head coach, he had reached out to Mike Hussey, who again had been with CSK as a batting coach. But the former Australian player declined the offer. *The Indian Express* understands that CSK have also informed Hussey that he isn't part of their plans going forward with Fleming's successor Zaheer Khan given the go-ahead to pick his own staff. It is understood that one former CSK overseas player is being considered for the role that Hussey has held since he hung up his boots. The details are expected in the coming week or later, when Zaheer flies down to Chennai.

While changes were expected on that front, on Monday, while confirming the central contracts, the England Cricket Board also confirmed Fleming's support staff. Fleming, who prefers familiar working model, has roped in Simons, a successful bowling coach with plenty of experience. The South African was also part of Gary Kirsten's team when he coached India to 2011 World Cup success. Later on he was head coach of Delhi Capitals before joining CSK as a bowling coach eight years ago. Fleming will also have Richard Dawson (spin bowling) and Marcus Trescothick (batting) as part of his support staff.

Under the new setup there won't be any crossovers into the white-ball with Brendon McCullum (coach of ODI and T20I side) having the likes of Kevin Pietersen, Tim Southee, Jeetan Patel and Sarah Taylor as his support staff.

Ranji Day 2: Jadeja's ton, J'khand's run pile, MP's lead

J&K BOWLED OUT



Madhya Pradesh shut defending champions Jammu & Kashmir out for 120 at the Sher-i-Kashmir Cricket Stadium in Srinagar, taking a first-innings lead of 76. The hosts had dismissed MP for 196 on a green top on Day 1, and then crumbled in no time themselves. Qamran Iqbal and Kanhaiya Wadhawan got starts, but none built an innings that would have troubled MP. Seamer Avesh Khan, who had taken out opener Shubham Khajuria late on Day 1, started the slide on the second morning with two more wickets before Aryan Pandey and Akshay Sharma chipped in. With the pitch still having plenty of juice, J&K's seamers ensured their opponents did not run away with the game, reducing them to 56/4.

BRIEF SCORES: MP 196 & 56/4 vs J&K 120 (Aryan Pandey 3/29, Avesh Khan 3/44) lead by 135 runs.

CENTURY FOR JADEJA



India all-rounder **Ravindra Jadeja**, one of the main Test regulars featuring in the first round as preparation for the New Zealand tour, warmed up with a 209-ball 102 against Chhattisgarh before his ex-Saurashtra teammate Dharmendrasinh Jadeja dismissed him. Unbeaten on 72 overnight alongside Prerak Mankad, who was on 92, both completed their centuries in the first session of Day 2 at Rajkot. Once the 205-run stand between the two was broken, Chhattisgarh restricted the hosts to 392. From 356/4 it was a collapse, with seamer Dev Aditya Singh returning 6/67, and it gave Chhattisgarh a chance to fight for a first-innings lead. In reply, both their openers went early, but skipper Anuj Tiwary's unbeaten 72 and Mayank Verma's 32 off 117 meant another long grind, which they have been good at lately.

BRIEF SCORES: Saurashtra 392 (Prerak Mankad 129, Ravindra Jadeja 102; Dev Aditya Singh 6/67) vs Chhattisgarh 122/3 (Anuj Tiwary 72).

ANDHRA FIGHT BACK

Seeram Rahul's unbeaten 108 and Revanth Reddy's 97 not only took Andhra out of trouble but also gave them a first-innings lead against Karnataka at Vijayawada. Overnight at 16/2 in reply to Karnataka's 274, Andhra were tottering at 116/5 when Shaik Rasheed fell for 54. An inexperienced Karnataka attack, without Vijaykumar Vyshak, Vidwath Kaverappa and Vidhyadhar Patil, had done the hard work. Once the ball got soft, with no seasoned spinner in their ranks, Rahul and Reddy patiently took Andhra out of the hole and laid a solid platform. The 202-run stand for the sixth wicket ensured the hosts took the lead, which now stands at 57 with four wickets left.

BRIEF SCORES: Karnataka 274 vs Andhra 331/6 (Seeram Rahul 108, Revanth Reddy 97; Shikhar Shetty 3/72).

JHARKHAND SCORE BIG



Jharkhand continued to show their batting might at Jamshedpur against Kerala, where they were bowled out for 587 when stumps were called. **Shikhar Mohan** had laid a strong platform with 143 at the top. On the second day it was the turn of captain Virat Singh, standing in for Ishan Kishan, and Aditya Singh to build on it. Virat made 108 off 264 and Aditya 147 off 278. Neither hit a six. Kerala were made to toil for a second consecutive day.

BRIEF SCORES: Jharkhand 587 (Aditya Singh 147, Vriat Singh 108; Vaishak Chandran 5/166).

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE

RANJI TROPHY: BENGAL VS DELHI

Gharami: Mason's son is building a run mountain

27-year-old hits third Ranji Trophy ton in as many matches; 'We did not even have a *pucca* house'

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, October 12



Sudip Gharami picked up from where he left off last season. PTI

299 AGAINST Andhra, 146 against Jammu & Kashmir last season. Now, unbeaten on 122 against Delhi — such are Sudip Gharami's last three Ranji Trophy scores. 567 runs in all, with a 146 in the Duleep Trophy quarter-final thrown in for good measure. Figures to satisfy even the most exacting of cricketers.

Not Gharami, though. The standard he has set himself is so high that the briefest of lean patches — of merely three matches — was enough to rekindle his need to prove himself. "I worked tirelessly during the off-season. I manifested starting the season with a century in the first Duleep Trophy match. I managed to do that, but after that, things didn't go well," he tells *The Indian Express* from Kalyani, where Bengal are playing their red-ball opener. "There was only one thing running in my mind before this match — that, I have to prove myself in the first innings itself. I had to show everyone that *main kisise kam nahin* (I am second to none)."

The impulse to prove his worth is hardly new. Gharami has spent the better part of two decades answering those who doubted him, since the days when people told his father his son would never make a professional cricketer — not for want of talent, but for want of means.

"My father used to work as a mason," says Gharami. "When I started playing cricket, we did not have enough money to buy bats and other cricket equipment. My father had to take loans from his friends to buy me kits. At the time, people used to tell him 'Have you lost your mind? How will a mason's son become a cricketer? *Bete ke upar faaltu ka paisa kharch kar raha hai* (You are wasting money on your son). Just give him some education so that he can get a regular job and make ends meet'."

Hard resolve

With every taunt, the resolve of Sushanta Gharami was forged a little harder.

"We did not even have a *pucca* house at the time. We used to live in a kuccha house. It was only when I played the Under-19 level that I bought a brick and mortar house for my family. So, you can tell how difficult it was. Everyone discouraged my father, but he was determined to make me a cricketer. *Unko ek zid chadh gaya tha* (he was determined). Actually, he was really passionate about cricket as well, but given the financial restraints, he never had the means to pursue the sport. So, he wanted his son to do what he could not. He would take me to the academy early in the morning every day, and wait there till I was done. Then in the evenings, we would go together to a ground behind our house, where my father used to throw balls at me. At night, I did shadow drills at the house, under his watchful eyes. He dedicated everything to make me."

The previous Ranji Trophy season saw him scoring 797 runs at 53.77 — highest for Bengal, and fourth-highest overall. Yet, it did not stop him from probing for flaws and mending them. "I was facing a few issues, such as my bat lift drifting outward. During the off-season, I worked specifically on my grip, stance, and bat lift. Since I am currently part of the BCCI's targeted players group, I got to work with coaches at the Centre of Excellence. Before the Duleep Trophy, I spent around two weeks at a camp in Bangalore, which helped improve my batting."

The Irani Cup might not have matched his personal expectations — scores of 8 & 33 — but Gharami considers it to be a useful learning curve.

"I got to speak with Sarfaraz (Khan) bhai. He gave me a simple advice: *'Har din start nahin milega, but jis din milega, us din lamba khelna hai.* (not everyday will you get a start, but when you do, make sure you play long). It was a very valuable advice. Today, I was up against a very strong pace attack of Delhi, but I was determined that once I am set on the crease, I will make it big."

With Duleep and Irani behind him, another prolific Ranji campaign could open fresh avenues for Gharami, avenues that lead towards the Indian dressing room. The 27-year-old knows it, but his focus rests on being Bengal's crisis man.

"My goal is to take things match by match. Whenever my team needs me, I want to step up and deliver. For many years, Anustup Majumdar was the crisis man of Bengal. Whenever the team was in trouble, Anustup da stepped up. I have learned a lot from him about how to handle crunch situations."

Gharami was also a regular feature for Bengal in white-ball tournaments last season, scoring a couple of half-centuries in the Vijay Hazare trophy. His love for the red leather, though, remains unrivalled.

"My inspiration has always been Sachin Tendulkar — the kind of knocks he played in Test cricket. Moreover, my childhood coach, Debesh Chakraborty is a huge Sunil Gavaskar fan, and instilled in me at a very young age that red-ball cricket is ultimate cricket."

BRIEF SCORES: Delhi 240 vs **Bengal** 304/3 (**Sudip Kumar Gharami 122 n.o, Abhishek Porel 114 n.o**).

Deepesh, 18, takes 3 in 8 balls as Rajasthan lose last six for 60

Bhuvan Gupta
Jaipur, October 12

ON SUNDAY, Deepesh Devendran paid for his lack of control. On Monday, the 18-year-old showed what he can do on a flat pitch when he gets it right.

After straying in line and length for 18-plus overs, he turned to the bouncer. His bouncers were not well directed, and he kept leaking runs. The Ranji debutant kept at it anyway.

Then he corrected his radar. His pace accounted for the well-set Mahipal Lomror. Ajay Singh Kukna and Manav Suthar followed. Rajasthan, who had looked like scoring in excess of 450, were suddenly vulnerable to a first-innings deficit. They were all out for 363.

At stumps, Tamil Nadu (TN) were 167 for four, 196 runs adrift with six wickets in hand. Pradosh Ranjan Paul and Narayan Jagadeesan had made fifties before part-timer Rohan Rajbhar dismissed Baba Indrajith in the last over of the day.

Deepesh said his poor finish on Day 1 did not discourage him. "I bowled the last 4-5 overs very badly (on Day 1). Even then, the coaches backed me, saying you bowl giving your full effort, don't feel bad about leaking runs. Captain Sai Kishore also helped a lot, saying the runs conceded were not a problem at all. "So I gave full effort to see what happens. One (wicket) came, and then two more were gained in that same effort," Deepesh said.

Mahipal had been pulling Deepesh well, but the same shot became his undoing. He hit a boundary off a short ball, but could not keep his pull off the next delivery down. Substitute Ajith Ram took a running catch at deep backward square leg. It was the teenager's maiden first-class wicket.

He soon had another as Kukna miscued a hook to Nidhish Rajagopal at deep fine leg. Deepesh then produced a ball outside off stump that took Manav Suthar's outside edge. It was his third wicket in 8 balls.

Washington Sundar and Sai Kishore sent back tail-enders Chetan Sharma and Hemant Kumar, respectively, to wrap up the innings. Rajasthan were 303 for four in the 91st over, and 363 all out by lunch.

"It wasn't like everyone could leave the bouncer easily, everyone went for the shots. So we thought it would be very useful for the areas (in which) they were hitting and we used the bouncer a lot," Deepesh said about his short-ball ploy. On Mahipal's dismissal he said: "I knew when he hits a couple of fours, he won't leave it anymore. We figured that's when we have a chance to take a wicket, so I bowled another one and he hit it exactly like that."

Deepesh added that toiling long and hard with scant rewards on batting-friendly pitches was not new to him. "In first division matches, this is what we do regularly. I'm used to it. If we bowl ten overs, getting a single wicket or two maidens is a big thing on that wicket. Since first division mostly involves spin-friendly or flat tracks, playing there has been very helpful."

He said pace and control are equally important and he can't sacrifice one for the other. "We cannot just keep the speed and keep bowling short. I focus on both. It doesn't mean I should reduce my speed and bowl slowly on line and length. I must give full effort and bowl on that line and length."

Sai Sudharsan survived an injury scare early on Day 2. He was hit on the knee by a drive from centurion Karan Lamba at covers and slumped to the ground. The left-hander was hobbling and had to be helped off the field by a member of the support staff. He did not return during Rajasthan's innings, but recovered well enough to open the batting for TN. His stay was short, as he played on to debutant seamer Chetan for 3.

The new ball did its thing, and the home team were enthused. Pradosh and Jagadeesan negotiated the period watchfully. They compiled a 104-run partnership before Rajasthan bounced back through spinners Kukna and Rohan. Andre Siddarth and Sonu Yadav are the overnight TN batters. With the fall of 26 wickets in the next two days highly unlikely, it is about the first-innings lead from here on.

BRIEF SCORES: Tamil Nadu 167 for four in 50 overs (Pradosh Ranjan Paul 58, N Jagadeesan 55; Ajay Singh Kukna 2/31) vs Rajasthan 363 all out in 115.3 overs (Karan Lamba 113, Mahipal Lomror 66; Deepesh Devendran 3/89).

Deshpande's hat-trick puts Mumbai in command vs Chandigarh

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, October 12

TUSHAR DESHPANDE took 5 for 17, including a hat-trick, to give Mumbai complete command on Day 2 of their Ranji Trophy match against Chandigarh at the Wankhede Stadium.

Chandigarh were 6 for 29 at one stage before they were bundled out for 78. Mohit Avasthi took 3 for 9. At stumps they had lost opener Vishu Kashyap and ended their second innings at 0 for 1, 351 runs behind. It will take some gritty effort from them to avoid defeat.

Mumbai had resumed at 249 for 5 and were all out for 429. Their long batting depth carried them there, with number eight Tanush Kotian (58), Deshpande (44) and Avasthi (56 not out) making key contributions at the end. Rohit Danda took 4 for 78 and Raj Bawa 4 for 73 for Chandigarh.

Over the years, Mumbai have been reluctant to play at their home ground, the Wankhede, and have instead chosen the MCA-BKC ground in the suburbs, which has given them more wins.

Playing his 50th first-class game, Deshpande wanted to make it special for himself.

"It's my 50th first class match today. So it was just in my mind that I want to make it special, but it wasn't like a hat-trick and all that, but I was going to give my 100% today. And when I was batting, there were some patches on the wicket where the ball was seeming a bit. So my only focus was to bowl maximum balls in the right area and it paid dividends today," he said after the game.



Tushar Deshpande (C) took a hat-trick against Chandigarh. PTI

He bowled with intensity and consistent pace throughout. He has worked on his fitness and has at times bowled at 140 kmph.

"Recently when I was playing for India, I was bowling about 140s in every style with the red ball. And I think it's not always the speed with the red ball. It's about the situation which you come to bowl in. And it's not like T20 cricket where I have to bowl just 4 overs. I have to bowl throughout the day. So, whatever the situation is, I look at what I can do the best. And accordingly increase or modify my speeds," he adds.

The performance came as the national selectors left him out of India A's tour of New Zealand. Asked whether the omission crossed his mind, he said: "I have always said that I want to chase performance, not selection."

BRIEF SCORES: Mumbai 429 (**Tanush Kotian 58, T Deshpande 44, Mohit Avasthi 56 not out, Rohit Danda 4 for 78, Raj Bawa 4 for 73**) vs **Chandigarh** 78 all out & 0/1 (**T Deshpande 5 for 17, Mohit Avasthi 3 for 9**).



Deepesh Devendran picked up three wickets on Day 2 after previously going wicketless on Sunday. EXPRESS PHOTO

REAL MADRID'S PROBLEM

Mourinho's puzzle to solve: Getting Vinicius and Mbappe to click

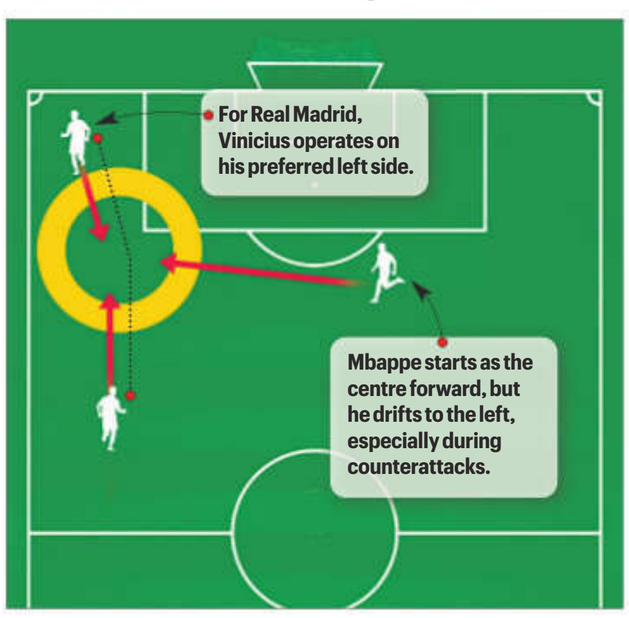
Sandip G
New Delhi, October 12

IN FLEETING seconds, Vinicius Junior redemption spiralled into rage and expletives. He was certain he ended his seven-match goal drought with a delightful strike against Villarreal on Saturday; he celebrated feverishly, manager Jose Mourinho rolled back his vintage with a touchline sprint. But the VAR not only revoked the goal, but also instructed the referee to brandish a straight red card for pulling Nathan Saliba's hair. Vinicius protested, pleaded, cried, and finally staggered to the tunnel. He would miss the El Clasico next week; his shot at revival would drag on.

In a tactical sense, Mourinho would heave a sigh of relief, even a feeling of liberation. At the heart of his team's stuttering start, has been the incompatibility of Vinicius and Kylian Mbappe. Both are indispensable, yet both have struggled to reprise their off-field rapport on the field. The Frenchman, who has carried his World Cup touch into the La Liga with seven goals in eight games, starts functionally as the centre forward, but he invariably veers to the left when Madrid attacks, especially when they are launching a quick counterattack. Their heatmap in the 2-1 surrender to Atletico Madrid before the international break shows their undesired stickability. Both almost hug each other, like vehicles stuck in Monday morning office rush hour, almost playing in the same position. They have tried to distance themselves from each other's shadows, like estranged lovers, but something pulls them back together.

Both are naturally left-sided wingers. Mbappe has been repurposed into a centre forward on his own insistence, but the inclinations surface frequently and they find each other in the way, eating their preferred space. The ramifications ripple onto other areas of the field, where they end up destabilising the structure, stretching the legs and lungs of colleagues who end up covering the vast expanse of space they have left behind. At times, the vaunted pair has seemed stuck at their overlapping shadows, caught in a strategic freeze, their vision suddenly blurred. Mourinho imploring them to move apart has been a common sight this season. That they are not the keenest to drop back and defend has complicated their misery.

Such tactical puzzles fascinate the Portuguese manager — his major strength as a tactician is his ability to switch seamlessly to a Plan B and C. He once blended Frank Lampard, John Obi Mikel and Claude Makelele into an unsurpassable midfield block in his first Chelsea stint; he laid the foundations of Real Madrid's double pivot of Luka Modric and Xabi Alonso, as two deep-lying playmakers able to hit intelligent passes into the attacking quarter. Madrid claimed the league in only his second season, hitting a record 100 points. Even though he did not survive the third season, the structure he installed and the players he purchased stood Madrid in good stead for several years.



He did tweak the system to nullify their defensive lethargy. Madrid defend in a 4-4-2, whereby the pair is not required to run as hard as they would have been in a more dynamic 4-2-3-1. It obviously compromises their vigour, but it's a risk he doesn't bother taking for the creative flourishes of Mbappe and Vinicius. The other spill-on effect has been that the twin-axis upfront has forced Jude Bellingham to a deeper role, making him a less creative but more defensive force. Tuchel deployed Bellingham primarily as a number 10 behind Harry Kane, and he duly provided startling returns.

"[Carlo] Ancelotti found the perfect role for Vini with Brazil, [Didier] Deschamps found the perfect role for Kylian, and [Thomas] Tuchel found the perfect role for Jude [at the World Cup]. But it's harder to find the perfect role for all three," Mourinho admitted. "We will find a solution, definitely, and we are all on the same page," he added.

Three of them are good friends, and egos have not yet flared up. But Mourinho, a master of handling mega egos, knows that it would often take a nudge for best pals to turn sworn enemies. Especially in the club fixated with star culture as Madrid, which clandestinely kept Gareth Bale's higher transfer fee so that it doesn't incense Cristiano Ronaldo. Seemingly trivial things like whose shirt is the club pushing more has led to feuds. Not to mention the club's open campaign for a Ballon d'or for Mbappe.

He already has navigated Madrid past the storied dressing room showdown between midfielders Aurelien Tchouameni and Federico Valverde, who was taken to hospital with a head injury. The pair has since waved the olive flag. "What I've seen isn't about peace - it's about normality, friendship, and cooperation. It's as if nothing ever happened," he brushed rumours of a fractious dressing room.

The coming week, though, is decisive for Madrid and Mourinho. Midweek, they meet Bayern Munich in Champions League, where the Vinicius-Mbappe mismatch could prove match-defining. Turn to the weekend, they encounter Barcelona, unbeaten this season and six points already ahead of them. "Ending a season without a trophy is a failure in Madrid," he once said. Not just another trophy.

The league or the Champions League. And the key to Mourinho turning the season around is unlocking the full potential of Mbappe and Vinicius, elite forwards of the world, but locked in an instinctive battle for space.

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